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Pitching his UP govt's reputation for 'bulldozer action' against criminals, CM Yogi Adityanath invites heavy machinery co to make bulldozers in state, **P 13**

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Mohali police have filed a case following a complaint filed by Delhi AAP MLA Jarnail Singh, who says he **received a call from Lawrence Bishnoi gang, threatening to kill ex-CM Arvind Kejriwal and his daughter unless Kejriwal paid up ₹7cr**, P 13

Four oil tankers have been hit by explosions in the Strait of Hormuz, Iran's military says, adding the vessels ignored warnings and entered what it considers restricted areas

FLIPPED IT by THE TIMES OF INDIA

A 60-SECOND DAILY WORD CHALLENGE. Crack the word, build your streak, share your score. Top scorers get featured in **TOI**

US envoys meet Russian President Vladimir Putin in Kremlin and then leave for Ireland to talk with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky as Washington seeks new momentum in its peace efforts, P 18

AFP

A doctor **shot one person dead and wounded four others in an upscale neighbourhood of Washington DC** on Thursday before barricading himself in his apartment and killing himself, police said. The shooting, which occurred about a mile north of White House, sparked a massive police response | P 18

Huang out to dry: Jensen steps down as Nvidia chief

CFO Colette Kress Named Interim CEO

Chidanand Rajghatta | TNN

Washington: For 33 years, Jensen Huang held all the chips. He proved less adept at keeping his private life under wraps. On Thursday, the man who powered the AI revolution resigned as CEO of Nvidia, the company he founded and catapulted to global No. 1, after a second extramarital affair, this one with a company associate, surfaced in the media even as the first one with an alleged Chinese spy was roiling the tech and geopolitical world.

"Nvidia board of directors announced today that Jensen Huang has resigned as president, CEO, and a member of the board, effective immediately," the company said, adding that Colette Kress, current executive vice-president and chief financial officer of Nvidia, has agreed to serve as interim CEO until a permanent successor has been named. It said the board is initiating a search for a permanent CEO and will consider internal and external candidates.

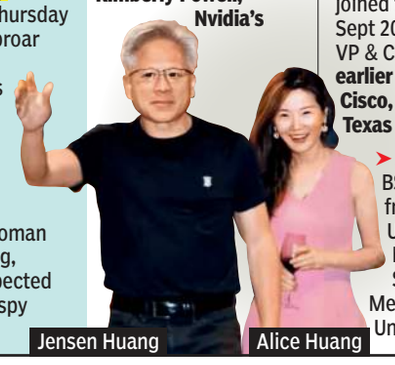
"Jensen's contributions to Nvidia are profound. Nvidia is one of the most consequential technology companies in the world... " the statement said. Nvidia's 10-member board includes Indian-American Aarti Shah, formerly of Eli Lilly.

Indeed, Huang, Nvidia's only CEO since its founding in 1993, was synonymous with the company he built into the world's most valuable semiconductor business, in the process becoming the impresario of the AI revolution.

▶'Spy Alice' in Beijing, P 18

TWO TOO MANY: REPORT OF ANOTHER AFFAIR SEALED FATE

Jensen Huang, who co-founded Nvidia in 1993 and turned it into the premier supplier of AI chips, resigned Thursday amid an uproar following revelations that he was having an affair with Chinese businesswoman Alice Huang, who's suspected of being a spy for Beijing



Jensen Huang | Alice Huang

FRESH SCANDAL | Apart from Alice, Jensen Huang also had an extramarital relationship with **Kimberly Powell, Nvidia's vice-president of health care**, according to an NYT report

WHO'S KRESS? | Nvidia's interim CEO joined the company in Sept 2013 as executive VP & CFO. She had **earlier worked with Cisco, Microsoft and Texas Instruments**

➤ She holds a BSc finance from Arizona University and MBA from Southern Methodist University

STOCK DIVES | Nvidia m-cap fell below $4tn, **1st time since July 2025**

➤ Shares fell 13% after Huang's resignation before recovering somewhat. **Nvidia has lost about $300bn in mkt value** since the board announced a probe on Sunday

TRUMP WANTS TIM | US prez Donald Trump posted, "There is only one man to take his (Huang's) place - **TIM COOK of Apple...** A Legend replaces a Legend!"

8 killed as bldg collapses in New York, 17 injured

Eight people were killed and at least 17 others were injured when a three-story apartment building in Brooklyn collapsed, New York City mayor Zohran Mamdani said. Three firefighters were among the injured, according to a city official. The collapse — in central Brooklyn — brought down part of the structure and trapped people inside the rubble. P 18

Anti-conversion law rollback: K'taka Cong

Karnataka Congress chief B K Hariprasad has said the state govt would restore the anti-conversion law to its pre-2022 form, signalling Congress's intent to fulfil its poll promise of rolling back the amendments by previous BJP govt. P 7

Jewellery heists in Tamil Nadu, MP

In two large jewellery thefts, burglars stole 23kg of gold and diamond items in Tamil Nadu's Madurai and jewellery worth Rs 15 crore in Madhya Pradesh's Katni Thursday. In Madurai burglars targeted a newly opened Tanishq outlet. P 14

Shah reviews plans to curb crime in city

Home minister Amit Shah Thursday reviewed policing arrangements for the upcoming festive season at the Delhi Police HQ. Focus was given on curbing organised crime and drug trafficking, at the second such meet held in quick succession. P 3

2 historic boxing golds at Youth Oly

Lairenlakpam Ambekar Meetei became India's first Youth Olympic boxing champion and Gunjan became the first Indian female boxer to win a gold medal on Thursday. Ambekar won in the 50kg category, Gunjan won women's 48kg title. P 19

2 killed in city as dumper rams auto

Two people were killed, while a six-month pregnant woman suffered a miscarriage, after a dumper truck collided with an autorickshaw carrying eight passengers in northeast Delhi's Sonia Vihar early Thursday. Six others were injured. P 2

Woman working in field killed in Naga-Kuki firing

Guwahati: A Kuki woman, 41, working in a paddy field along Manipur's Senapati-Kangpokpi border was killed Thursday in the crossfire between gunmen from her community and suspected Naga militants, **reports Prabin Kalita**. Two young Kuki men were wounded in the firing, although it wasn't immediately clear if they were directly involved in the confrontation.

▶Confident of Manipur polls on time: Govt, P 14

Hours later, in Ukhrul, a Naga man was wounded in allegedly unprovoked firing by suspected Kuki assailants on a group harvesting paddy. Gunmen fired several rounds from Lungter Hills towards farmers at Sinakeithel village, cops said.

▶Clutching sickle, P 12

He yelled 'happy Diwali' before killing IT exec

Gurgaon: "Dhankar sahab, please come out for a moment. I need to park my car," scrap dealer Mohan Sharma urged his neighbour Paramjeet Dhankar, a senior vice-president with Singapore-based FPT Software who had returned to his Faridabad home just a day earlier to attend his nephew's wedding.

Minutes later, as the two walked outside the main gate, Sharma pumped nine bullets into Dhankar, reports **reports Nikhil Sharma**. As the senior IT executive staggered towards the road, trying to escape, Sharma pursued him, continued firing and even changed his magazine as bullets ran out. He then shouted, "Happy Diwali. I will kill everyone today."

▶Past disputes, P 5

At 6.09%, retail inflation breaches RBI's upper tolerance limit after 2 yrs

New Delhi: Retail inflation based on the consumer price index (CPI) rose to 6.09% in Oct from 5.5% in Sept, breaching RBI's tolerance limit of 6% for the first time in two years. Inflation has remained above RBI's target of 4% for the fifth month in a row.

Economists now expect RBI to raise interest once again after the Monetary Policy Committee's meeting in early Dec. RBI has projected full-year inflation at 5.2%, with CPI expected to rise 6% in the current quarter before easing to 5.7% during the Jan-March period.

The surge is largely driven by food inflation, which rose to 8.9% in Oct from 7.7% in Sept. Prices of key items such as onions (up 116%), garlic (60%) and ginger (48%) spiked sharply. Inflation also became more broad-based as 11 of the 12-item food categories recorded an uptick during Oct.

However, some vegetables continued to offer relief, with prices of potatoes (-14%), cauliflower (-10.5%), brinjal (-3.3%) and cabbage (-2%) declining in Oct. TNN

SOUTH PINCHES

➤ In 6 states, retail inflation crossed **7% inflation, led by the southern states**

➤ Food inflation to stay high in Nov **amid rising milk, sugar and onion prices**, and deficient rains

➤ NSO data shows fuel cost pressures s**pilling over to transport (5.8%) and restaurants** (10.1%), which are seeing rise in costs

▶Six states, P 17

Owaisi, Azad's parties join hands, to contest all 403 UP seats as alliance

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Lucknow: Hyderabad MP Asaduddin Owaisi-led All India Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen (AIMIM) and Chandrashekhar Azad's Azad Samaj Party-Kanshi Ram (ASPKR) entered an alliance Thursday for the 2027 Uttar Pradesh assembly elections and announced that they would contest all 403 seats.

The new front will be called Samajik Parivartan Morcha (SPM), targeting 40% of UP's voting population — 21% Dalits and 19% Muslims.

At a joint press conference in Lucknow, Owaisi declared Azad, MP from Nagina in western UP, as the chief ministerial face of the new front.

▶May hurt INDIA bloc, P 12

In Pjb, BJP-SAD tie-up revival on the cards

Six years after they broke off ties, BJP and Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) are set to strike an alliance in Punjab, sources said Thursday, with the former expected to seek a substantially higher share of seats than it did before. P 13

7 AAP MLAs out of 2nd list for Pjb polls

AAP Thursday announced its second list of 31 names for the Punjab assembly elections, dropping 7 MLAs. The surprise drops are two giant-slayers from 2022 polls, minister Gurmeet Singh Khudian and Charanjit Singh. P 13

Spl Parl session likely for women's quota, more seats

New Delhi: BJP Thursday gave strong indications of Parliament likely being summoned for a short duration to take up the bill to implement women's reservation law from 2029 and increase the number of Lok Sabha seats by nearly 50%, with a senior functionary saying the governing alliance will prove the required two-thirds majority comfortably.

He claimed in an interaction with reporters that BJP-led NDA will have nearly 15-18 MPs above the two-thirds majority needed for the Constitution amendment bill's passage, but declined to give a breakdown of the additional support the alliance hopes to draw to get over the line, something it had failed to achieve in the budget session of Parliament. TNN

▶50% extra seats, P 12

₹10 lakh fine on Ola for 'tip to ride' nudge

New Delhi: Central consumer protection authority has imposed a penalty of Rs 10 lakh on ANI Technologies, which operates ride-hailing platform Ola, for misleading consumers into paying an additional fare to improve chances of getting a faster ride, **reports Dipak Dash**.

It directed the platform to discontinue display of all prompts, messages, interface designs, pre-set amounts, or any other dark pattern elements that "solicit, nudge, coerce or psychologically pressure consumers into paying any amount, whether described as a tip, add-on, additional fare or by any other name, over and above the upfront fare displayed at the time of booking, prior to the completion of the journey".

▶Another probe on, P12

Raj spl summary draft counts 11L more voters than SIR list

State Rolls Now Show 3 Different Numbers In 1 Yr

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Jaipur: Rajasthan's latest draft electoral roll, published Thursday under the Special Summary Revision (SSR) 2027, has produced a fresh numbers puzzle. It records about 5.26 crore voters — about 11 lakh more than the 5.15 crore in the final Special Intensive Revision (SIR) roll published in Feb.

▶Bihar adds 13L voters to SIR tally; 2L deletions, 4L additions in Assam rolls, P 14

But the number is still far below another official figure in circulation: State Election Commission's final electoral roll, which stood at 5.45 crore voters in early Oct.

That leaves Rajasthan with three voter counts in less than a year — 5.15 crore in the final SIR roll, 5.45 crore in the SEC roll, and now 5.26 crore in the ECI-linked SSR draft. The latest figure sits between the two, but does not settle the central question: why official rolls for the same state show such wide variation.

According to CEO Naveen Mahajan, the SSR draft has 2,75,24,780 male voters, 2,51,42,052 female voters and 584 transgender voters. The qualifying date for the revision is Jan 1, 2027. EC has opened claims and objections from Nov 12 to Dec 11. The final roll will be published on Jan 4, 2027. The difference between SIR and SSR is critical to understanding the numbers. SIR is a deeper verification exercise in which booth-level officers conduct house-to-house enumeration. Existing voters are given pre-filled forms and are required to submit them for their names to be considered in the revised roll.

SSR begins with the last published final roll. Existing voters are generally carried forward and not required to prove eligibility afresh merely to retain their names. The exercise is meant to update the roll through additions, deletions and corrections.

▶Changes till Jan, P 10

BLOs in Gzb to go door to door again

Ghaziabad district administration has launched an extensive door-to-door campaign, akin to the first phase of SIR, this time to identify and bring left-out voters back into the rolls. Under the drive, booth-level officers will be dispatched, with each of the 3,073 being assigned 350 households in a bid to ensure no eligible voters are excluded. P 3

Delhi SIR likely to be extended again

The ongoing SIR in Delhi is likely to get another extension to allow room for re-verification of nearly 47.6 lakh voters whose names were deleted from the draft electoral rolls published on Aug 31. The window for claims and objections is scheduled to end on Nov 25, but at least two officials told **TOI** the schedule is likely to be extended. P 3

Bodies of 2 missing SPOs found with bullet wounds in J&K's Kishtwar forest

Sanjay Khajuria & Naseer Ganai

Jammu/Srinagar: Bodies of two special police officers were found with bullet wounds in remote forests of Kishtwar Thursday, with their service rifles missing, triggering a search for the attackers and renewed concerns over a possible revival of terrorism in Chenab valley.

Rashpal Kumar, 45, and Bobby Chand, 57, both residents of Kiyar Dachhan and posted with SOG Kiyar sector, had gone missing on Nov 10 while travelling to an Army post at Dharna-Marwah for rotation duty. A search was launched after they failed to reach the post. Their mobile phones were initially reachable but later switched off. One SPO had a bullet wound to his head and the other to his back. Their bodies were shifted for autopsy. Their INSAS and .303 rifles were missing. Sources said it was too early to link the killings to terrorism. However, Hizbul Mujahideen commander Jahangir Saroori, believed to be the longest-surviving terrorist in Chenab valley, was suspected to have been hiding in the area for decades. Mudassar, Riaj and south Kashmir terrorist Latif Bhat were also trying to revive terrorism in the region, the sources added.

SPOs Bobby Chand (57) and Rashpal Kumar (45)

▶Out of danger, P 10

Smog blankets Delhi, air flirts with severe

Delhi was shrouded in a layer of smog on Thursday as its air quality deteriorated to the mid-range of the 'very poor' category, recording an air quality index (AQI) of 350 at 4pm.

The AQI spiked to 387 in the higher end of the 'very poor' range at 10pm, the highest this season. A higher AQI than this was last recorded on Jan 19 when it touched 410 ('severe' category). At least 18 monitoring stations in the city had 'severe' air quality Thursday, according CPCB.

IIT-Delhi was the most polluted area at 466, followed by Chandni Chowk at 463, on a scale of zero to 500. The air quality is likely to stay within the 'very poor' category for the next two days, according to Air Quality Early Warning System for Delhi. P 3

Norwegian journalist claims MHA cancelled her visa for Hyd event

Manvi.Vyas@timesofindia.com

Hyderabad: Norwegian commentator Helle Lyng Svendsen Wednesday said her Indian visa was cancelled just a day after it was issued and barely 10 minutes before she was to leave for the airport to board a flight to Hyderabad for the Bharat Summit.

Svendsen was invited to speak at a panel on 'The Future of Media' at the summit on Nov 14. This was to be her first visit to India. The development comes months after Svendsen aimed a question at PM Modi during his visit to Oslo on May 18, asking why he was not taking questions from journalists. This was after Modi and Norwegian PM Jonas Gahr Støre had finished making a joint appearance before the media and were walking away.

> "The Indian embassy called me 10 minutes before I was leaving for the airport to tell me that my visa would not be valid upon entry to India... It is very **unfortunate how much of a hassle it is to host a political conference in the world's largest democracy**
>
> —Helle Lyng Svendsen

In a post on X, Svendsen said the cancellation had come on "orders from above" in the home ministry. In a video message, she questioned the Union home minister why her visa was cancelled.

▶'Before departure', P 12

Ex-Naxal chief Deoji eyes entry into politics

Hyderabad: Surrendered CPI (Maoist) member Thippiri Thirupathi, alias Deoji, who was the outfit's de-facto chief when armed Naxalism was 'eliminated', has decided to embrace party-based democratic politics and raise people-centric issues in a legal manner. But electoral politics is not on the cards yet, **reports Bharti Jain.**

Currently studying law in Hyderabad, Deoji wants to repurpose CPI (Maoist) into a lawful party vehicle. He has demanded that the ban on the outfit be lifted and even agreed on the need to rewrite its political document to revise its strategy from "seizing power through armed struggle" to "people's politics".

FULL INTERVIEW: P 10

Refreshing our entire set of satellites: Mittal

Saurabh Sinha & Sidhartha | TNN

New Delhi: Sunil Bharti Mittal-backed Eutelsat OneWeb will next week begin the process of replacing its ageing satellites to continue providing satcom services globally and start the same in India also when the country allows that. OneWeb has about 650 low Earth orbit (LEO) satellites in orbit, many of which will be reaching end of life soon.

FULL INTERVIEW: P 9

"One batch (LEO satellites) is going next week. A satellite has a life of 7-8 years. Some of them are coming to their end of life in a year or two. That's why new ones are going up. We are putting up 600 odd satellites and refreshing the entire (set) with an investment of a few billion dollars," Mittal told **TOI**. In India, to begin with, the telecom baron sees satcom services providing a "complementary service" for places that have no coverage including dark spots, oil rigs, jungles and remote farmhouses where no fibres have been laid yet.

> Three pvt players (Jio, Airtel, Vodafone) plus BSNL is the right mix. China, UK, US, have three each... France right now is going from four to three... The world is recognising that you need larger players
>
> —Sunil Mittal

Usha re-enters IOA fray via ice hockey route

PT Usha has refused to leave the IOA presidential race without waging one last fight.

After losing out on a direct entry into the IOA General Assembly by finishing fifth in Monday's contentious Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit elections and missing the four women's places, Usha has found an unlikely ally in Ice Hockey Association of India.

She will be their women's nominee in the provisional electoral college for the IOA Executive Council (EC) elections on Dec 5, released by electoral officer Sanjay K Srivastava on Thursday. P 19

Mississippi's Masala moment: A historic Black win in deep south

Chidanand Rajghatta | TNN

Washington: Thirty-five years after Mira Nair, then pregnant with Zohran Mamdani, brought 'Mississippi Masala' to screen, exploring the unlikely romance between an Indian woman and a Black man in America's deep south, America's poorest state has scripted a plot twist that Hollywood might have considered improbable: electing its first Black US senator in more than 150 years.

In a remarkable real-life sequel, Democrat Scott Colom, a civil rights attorney, has defeated Republican incumbent Cindy Hyde-Smith by a narrow 4,600 votes margin to become Mississippi's first Black American senator since Reconstruction, when the beaten Confederacy was briefly undergoing a democratic transformation.

The symbolism is difficult to overstate: Mississippi has the highest proportion of Black residents of any American state, approaching 40%. Yet the state has not had a Black senator since Blanche Bruce, who entered the Senate in 1875 and served until 1881. Hiram Revels, the first Black American senator, had also represented Mississippi, in 1870.

Getty Images

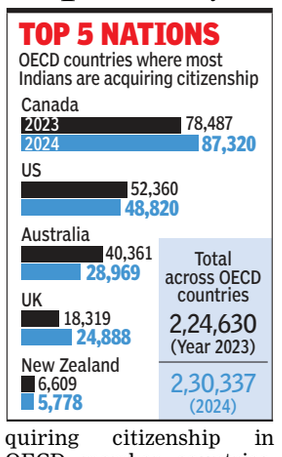
Scott Colom, posing here with his family after his win Wednesday, is Mississippi's third Black senator, but the first to be elected by people

▶Considered 'safe' GOP seat, P 18

Indians top again: 9.3L get OECD citizenships in 5 yrs

Indians continue to top the list of people acquiring citizenship in advanced economies, with around 9.25 lakh Indian citizens acquiring the nationality of an OECD member country between 2020 and 2024, according to the 'International Migration Outlook 2026' report released on Thursday by the Organisation for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD), **reports Lubna Kably.**

The figure marks a sharp increase of 41% from just over 6.5 lakh Indians who acquired citizenship of OECD member countries during 2015-2019. India remains the largest country of former nationality among those acquiring citizenship in OECD member countries, ahead of Syria and Mexico.



▶87L new citizens, P 18

How Chhath Puja has turned into vote-catching fest | 5

TIMES CITY

THE TIMES OF INDIA, NEW DELHI | FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 13, 2026

TEMP ON THURSDAY
30° MAXIMUM | 16.5° MINIMUM

FORECAST Partly cloudy sky. Max & min temperatures on Friday would be around 30°C and 18°C

MOONSET 8.26PM (FRI) MOONRISE 11.01AM (SAT)
SUNSET 5.29PM (FRI) SUNRISE 6.43AM (SAT)

*AQI at 8pm
383
AQI IN DELHI ON THURSDAY (VERY POOR)

Another SIR extension likely to reverify 47.6L deleted voters | 3

Bhalswa landfill to be flattened by April 2027 | 6

Dumper Collides With Auto, 2 Dead

SONIA VIHAR: Six Injured, Pregnant Woman Suffers Miscarriage; Efforts On To Arrest Driver

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Two people died and six were injured after a dumper truck collided with an autorickshaw carrying eight passengers near 5th Pushta in northeast Delhi's Sonia Vihar early Thursday.

The impact of the collision was so severe that the front portion of the autorickshaw was mangled, with bloodstains visible on the vehicle.

Police received information about the accident at 5.09am, following which a team rushed to the spot and found the autorickshaw and the dumper involved in the collision. All eight occupants of the three-wheeler, including five men, two women and a six-month-old girl, were taken to hospital for treatment.

Doctors declared two people, Satbir, 32, and the autorickshaw driver, Pramod, aged over 30, brought dead. The injured were identified as Satbir's wife, Moni (26); their six-month-old daughter; Rameshwar Dayal (45); Akshay Sharma (30); Raja (30); and his wife, Rakhi (26). All six are undergoing treatment. Rakhi, who was six months pregnant, suffered a miscarriage.

The forensic team collected evidence from the spot. A case under BNS sections 281 (rash driving or riding on a public way), 125 (act endangering life or personal safety of others) and 106(1) (causing death by negligence) was registered at Sonia Vihar police station and teams were deployed to identify the truck driver.

"We suspect he may have fled to Bihar, from where he hails. Raids are being conducted to apprehend him," an officer said, adding the dumper owner also travelled to Bihar and is expected to return to Delhi.

At the time of the accident, the dumper was travelling from Chauhan Patti towards Nanak Sar. The autorickshaw was heading in the opposite direction.

A senior officer said Pramod, the driver, had picked up passengers along with his friend Akshay. "We suspect that three people were sitting in the front seat and the remaining occupants were seated at the back," the officer said, adding the exact sequence of events will be clear once the victims' statements have been recorded.

Police are also probing the circumstances leading to the collision, including the dumper's speed and the possibility of the autorickshaw becoming unstable due to overloading. The accident occurred on a narrow, congested stretch where traffic moves in both directions, leaving limited space for vehicles to pass. Investigators suspect the dumper may have been travelling at high speed when it rammed the three-wheeler, though the exact cause of the accident is yet to be established.

Satbir's relative Dharmveer, meanwhile, asked, "How can eight people travel in an autorickshaw? It's not possible!"

6-MONTH-OLD GIRL AMONG INJURED

Photo: Jatin Kumar

The accident left a roadside wall damaged

When | 5.09 am (PCR call) on Nov 12

Where | Sonia Vihar, northeast Delhi

WHAT HAPPENED

- A road accident involving an autorickshaw (TSR) and a dumper took place near 5th Pushta
- Eight occupants of the autorickshaw, comprising five men, two women and a six-month-old girl, were shifted to Jag Pravesh Chandra Hospital
- Doctors declared two people brought dead; one miscarriage reported

DECEASED

- Satbir
- Pramod, driver of the autorickshaw

INJURED

- Satbir's wife Moni
- Their six-month-old daughter
- Rameshwar Dayal
- Akshay Sharma
- Raja and his wife Rakhi
- Rakhi, who was six months pregnant, suffered miscarriage

POLICE INVESTIGATION

- Forensic team inspected the accident site and collected crucial evidence
- Case registered at Sonia Vihar police station
- Teams deployed to identify and trace the dumper driver

Kin mourn loss of unborn child, claim delay in treatment

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Jatin Kumar

It was around 5am when the auto, in which a total of eight people were allegedly sitting, was rammed by the truck on a narrow elevated road near 5th Pushta

New Delhi: For the past few months, Raja (30) and Rakhi Kumar (26) had been eagerly awaiting the birth of their first child. Their dreams were crushed after a dumper truck hit the auto they were travelling in, leading to a miscarriage of the six-month-old foetus.

Inside the emergency ward at Rajiv Gandhi hospital, relatives took turns to squeeze an ambu-bag to help Rakhi breathe. After arriving at the hospital around 8am, she had to wait hours for a ventilator, according to Ajay Kumar, a relative.

Around 4.30am Thursday, Rakhi had complained of stomach pains to her husband. The two were on their way in an auto to Shastri Park to see a doctor. It was around 5am when the three-wheeler, in which a total of eight people were allegedly sitting, was rammed by the truck on a narrow elevated road in Sonia Vihar.

In the vehicle sat another family: Satbir Singh (26), his wife Moni (26) and their six-month-old infant, Kanka. They were coming back after celebrating Diwali in their native village in Uttar Pradesh's Bahora. Satbir, who worked in a polythene factory and was his family's sole breadwinner, died on the spot.

Moni was admitted to the hospital with injuries to her face and legs while Kanka sustained a fractured skull, said Dharamveer Singh, a relative. As per police, Moni and Kanka were in a stable condition. Dharamveer said the family now faces a dilemma over what to attend to first: "Should we conduct the last rites of Satvir or take care of his injured wife and kid?"

Also inside the auto were its owner, Pramod, and its driver, Akshay Sharma (30), a resident of Sonia Vihar.

"It must've been his first or second ride of the day," said Akshay's brother Deepu Sharma. "I got to know of the accident around 1pm, when some local children came running to our house and told us that Akshay's auto had crashed."

According to police, Pramod succumbed to his injuries following the crash.

The road where the accident occurred, known as the 5th Pushta, is notorious for accidents, locals said. When **TOI** visited the spot, dried blood was visible in patches, along with a stretch of broken glass. On the other side, a part of the boundary wall stood broken after the accident.

"The 10-metre-wide road is already too narrow for two-way traffic. Allow dumper trucks on them, and an accident was waiting to happen," a street vendor said.

Car at 202 kmph loses control; man dies

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: A 22-year-old man was killed after the car he was driving at a speed of 202 kmph lost control, crashed into a wall and caught fire in southwest Delhi's Vasant Kunj, police said Sunday. The accident took place on the day of Diwali

A PCR call regarding the accident was received at the police station. On reaching the spot, police personnel learnt that NHAI personnel had already shifted the injured man to Indira Gandhi Hospital in Dwarka. However, doctors declared him dead.

During the investigation, the district crime team and the Forensic Science Laboratory team inspected the accident site and collected evidence. Police also examined CCTV footage to reconstruct the sequence of events leading to the fatal crash.

The footage reportedly showed the car being driven at a very high speed before the driver lost control, rammed into a wall and jumped over to the other side. The vehicle subsequently caught fire, leaving the driver critically injured.

As per the enquiry conducted so far, the youth was travelling alone in a car with no other person accompanying him. He was returning from Ludhiana to his residence in Sector 42, Gurgaon, after meeting his friend. Police said the investigation found no information suggesting he had attended any party before the accident. "We are also probing whether the car belonged to his friend," sources added.

In another crucial development, police found a Snapchat story uploaded by the youth before the accident which reportedly showed the vehicle travelling at 202 kmph.

Following the incident, the body was sent for a post-mortem at Safdarjung Hospital. Police said inquest proceedings under Section 194 (police to enquire and report on suicide, etc.) of BNSS were being conducted to ascertain the circumstances surrounding the death.

Shah at police HQ, organised crime in focus

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Union home minister Amit Shah Thursday chaired a review meeting on the law and order situation and policing arrangements in the national capital at the Delhi Police headquarters. Lieutenant governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu was also present at the meeting, which was attended by senior Delhi Police officers.

"Union home minister @AmitShah held a review meeting on law and order and policing, along with @LtGovDelhi and senior Delhi Police officers, at the Delhi Police headquarters," PIB-ministry of home affairs later posted on X.

Shah reached the headquarters on Jai Singh Road around 3.15 pm. During the meeting, the home minister reviewed the overall law and order situation in the city, with a particular focus on measures taken to curb organised crime and drug trafficking. Discussions were also held on the police force's preparedness for the upcoming festive season, including crowd management strategies. Special CPs from ranges and units, along with Joint CPs and DCPs, were present on the occasion. The meeting further reviewed measures being undertaken to strengthen women's safety and ensure a more effective policing response.

This was the second such meeting chaired by Amit Shah in quick succession

This was the second such meeting held in quick succession. Earlier, on Oct 24, the home minister had chaired a security review meeting at the Delhi Police headquarters, which was attended by chief minister Rekha Gupta and senior Delhi Police officers. The earlier meeting had also focused on the law and order situation and the steps required to strengthen policing in the national capital.

Chanakya Rail Enclave is 10th Anupam Colony

New Delhi: New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) has declared Chanakya Rail Enclave in Chanakyapuri its 10th Anupam Colony, recognising the neighbourhood's achievement in 100% waste segregation and community-led sustainability initiatives.

Unveiling a plaque at the colony Thursday, NDMC chairman Manoj Kumar Dwivedi said the civic body aimed to develop at least five more Anupam Colonies in the coming months. Chanakya Rail Enclave is the first colony to be recognised under the new target.

Under the initiative, colonies are required to ensure complete segregation of waste at source and undertake composting. Dwivedi said residents and the RWA played an active role in helping the colony achieve 100% waste segregation. Launched in June 2025, the project has covered several residential areas, including Chanakyapuri, Jor Bagh and Golf Links. TNN

Smog Blankets Delhi, Air Flirts With Severe

18 Monitoring Stations Clock AQI Of Over 400

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New Delhi: Delhi was shrouded in a layer of smog on Thursday as its air quality deteriorated to the mid-range of the 'very poor' category, recording an air quality index (AQI) of 350 at 4 pm.

The AQI spiked to 387 in the higher end of the 'very poor' range at 10 pm, the highest this season. A higher AQI than this was last recorded on Jan 19 when it touched 410 ('severe' category).

At least 18 monitoring stations in the city had 'severe' air quality Thursday, according to Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB). IIT-Delhi was the most polluted area at 466, followed by Chandni Chowk at 463, on a scale of zero to 500.

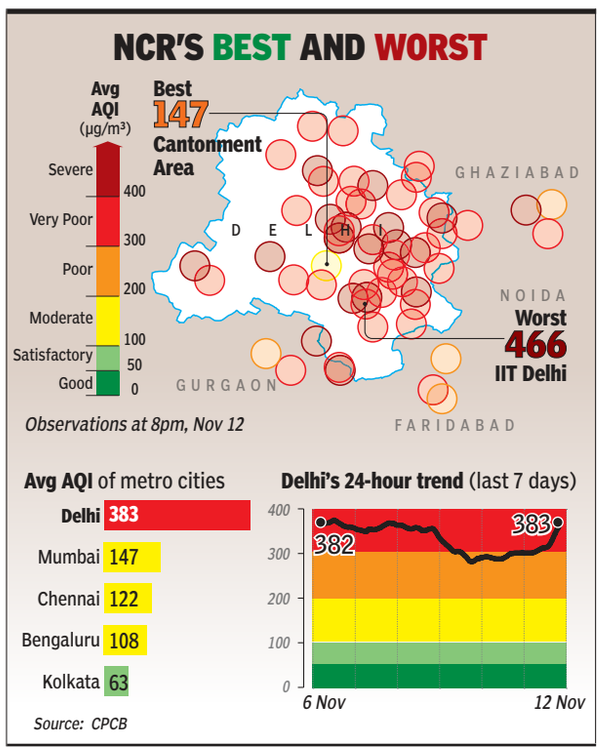
The air quality is likely to stay within the 'very poor' category for the next two days, according to Air Quality Early Warning System for Delhi.

Burning of municipal, garden and plastic waste, paddy residue, wood and coal was the dominant source of pollution at 25.4% from 1 am to 9 am, according to Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology. Secondary organic aerosols also accounted for 25.4% and vehicles for 17% of pollutants. At just over 7%, firecrackers continued to impact the city's air quality well after Diwali.

CPCB's data shows that the air quality worsened steadily during the day. The AQI was at 323 at 8 am before rising to 378 at 8 pm. The winds slowed down to an average of less than 5 kmph during daytime, hampering the process of dispersion of pollutants.

As haze blanketed Delhi, visibility dipped sharply. At Safdarjung, the city's base station, visibility at 3.30 pm fell from 2,000 metres Wednesday to 800m at the same time Thursday. Palam also recorded a drop in visibility to 1,200m, from 2,500m the previous day.

Experts said met conditions are likely to be adverse next week, which could lead to trapping of pollutants. Gufran Beig, founder of System of Air Quality and Weather Forecasting and Research and chair professor at National Institute of Advanced Studies, said temperatures are set to drop once the influence of a western disturbance passes. With no rain expected over the next few days, a likely rise in farm fire emissions is set to add heavily to Delhi's pollution load.



Can a classroom fan double as an air purifier? Two city teens put it to test

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New Delhi: Switch on the fan and the white fabric swells like a balloon. Leave it in use for a few weeks and it can turn grey, sometimes black. For two Delhi teenagers, that change in colour is the most visible sign of what their Rs 140 filter is designed to do: trap some of the fine particles that children would otherwise breathe in while sitting through lessons.

Krish Aggarwal, a Class XII student at Sanskriti School, and Samarth Meattle, a Class XI student at Vasant Valley School, started Project Vayu with a question that had as much to do with school budgets as with Delhi's air: what could classrooms that could not afford air purifiers use instead? Their answer was something many schools already had — a fan.

For Aggarwal, who has earned a place on the 2026 Diana Award Roll of Honour, the idea began at home. "I have lived all my life in Delhi and I used to have nosebleeds every single day during pollution months," he said. Concerned about other children facing similar problems, he and his cousins set out to understand why air purifiers were so expensive. They identified two major cost drivers — the fan and the filter material.

Meattle said using a table or wall fan already available in classrooms helped keep costs down. An elastic band holds the filter in place as the fan pushes room air through the fabric, which traps fine particles, including PM2.5. "As the air circulates, it passes through the filter again and again. For the project, Hollingsworth & Vose supplied the filter material free of cost in large rolls, which were then cut to size and fitted with elastic at a factory," Aggarwal said.

The students found their first opportunity through an NGO that tested the filter and helped them conduct a pilot across 295 classrooms. Meattle said the classrooms were equipped with air-quality monitors, and schools were asked to record readings every hour.

In classrooms measuring roughly 600-700 sq ft, the model can reduce PM2.5 levels by 50-55% in the first hour and around 90% after several hours of use, Aggarwal said.

In a 200 sq ft room, the team estimated a reduction of around 90% within an hour. "However, if the windows are open, you can't expect to get those results," he clarified.

The teenagers now aim to reach at least 15,000-20,000 students across Delhi. "We are looking at ways to get them tested at govt schools as well," Aggarwal said.

IITF: Expect jam on Mathura Rd from Nov 14

New Delhi: Commuters may face traffic congestion on several key roads around Pragati Maidan during the 45th India International Trade Fair (IITF), scheduled to be held from Nov 14 to 27.

Delhi Traffic Police has issued an advisory, warning of heavy traffic on Mathura Road, Bhairon Marg, Ring Road, Sher Shah Road, Purana Qila Road, Bhagwan Das Road and Tilak Marg. Commuters not visiting the fair have been advised to avoid these stretches, if possible, and use public transport.

The business visitor days will be held from Nov 14 to 18, between 9.30 am and 7.30 pm. Entry for business visitors will be allowed through Gates 3, 4, 6 and 10. Parking facilities will be available at the ITPO basement parking area, with entry and exit from Bhairon Marg and the tunnel connecting from the Ring Road side. Visitors can also use the Bhairon Mandir parking facility. Another parking facility will be available at Basement Parking No. 2, beneath Bharat Mandapam.

Pedestrian entry will be allowed through Gates 1, 4, 6 and 10, while visitors can exit through Gates 1, 4, 7, 9 and 10. TNN

▶ At trade fair, 'vikas' & 'virasat' in focus P6

Earning kin can't be denied accident compensation: HC

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New Delhi: "Married, earning or separately residing" family members cannot be automatically denied motor accident compensation merely because they were not financially dependent on the deceased, Delhi High Court observed, holding that a contrary approach would be inconsistent with the "realities of Indian family structures" and that a lack of day-to-day dependency does not mean an absence of financial loss.

Justice Anish Dayal observed that a person cannot be "straightaway shunted out as not being dependent merely because they are married and earning". "A person's lack of day-to-day dependence does not mean no compensable loss has occurred," the court said, adding that insurers, vehicle owners and drivers cannot be "completely absolved" of liability simply because the deceased's family does not fit a conventional model of dependency.

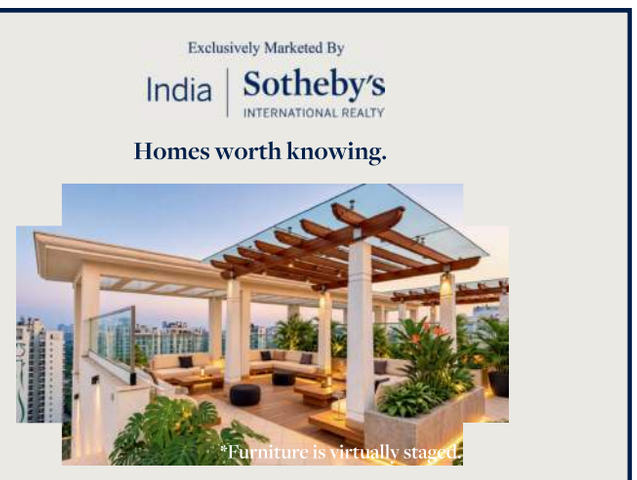
The observations came while deciding cross-appeals filed by United India Insurance Company and Savita, challenging compensation awarded for the deaths of her father, Chamanlal (56), and sister, Meenu (23), in a road accident on Aug 31, 2015.

Savita, who had married in 2002 and was living separately with her husband, was the sole surviving daughter and legal representative of the deceased. Motor Accident Claims Tribunal, treating her as a non-dependent legal representative, awarded only one-third of the notional loss of estate: Rs 9.3 lakh for Meenu's death and Rs 13.2 lakh for Chamanlal's death.

While the insurance company argued that a married daughter living separately could not claim loss of dependency, Savita sought enhancement of the compensation.

Rejecting the insurer's contention, the high court clarified that all legal representatives can maintain compensation claims even without establishing financial dependency. A married or earning daughter, son, spouse or sibling cannot be excluded "per se" merely because they are employed or reside separately.

It increased the compensation for Meenu's death by Rs 5.1 lakh to Rs 14.4 lakh and for Chamanlal's death by Rs 7.1 lakh to Rs 20.2 lakh.



Asked for papers, man torches tempo

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: A man allegedly set his tempo on fire in east Delhi's Ghazipur after being asked to produce the vehicle's ownership documents during a traffic check Thursday, police said.

A video of the incident, which surfaced online, shows the tempo engulfed in flames while the man waves a black flag and brandishes a sword, causing traffic disruption in the area.

According to police, the incident occurred around 8.30 am when traffic personnel stopped the vehicle and asked the driver to produce ownership documents. Allegedly angered by the check, the man poured a flammable substance on the tempo and set it ablaze.

Police said he then took out a sword, waved a black flag and recorded the incident on his mobile phone.

The accused, identified as Ghanender (28), allegedly obstructed traffic while brandishing the sword before being apprehended by police. Traffic movement was subsequently restored.

During questioning, Ghanender allegedly gave varying versions of the incident and claimed that traffic officials stop vehicle owners without reason and frequently ask for documents. Police said his allegations are being examined and verified.

An FIR has been registered at Ghazipur police station under provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

AMID CRITICISM, EFFORTS STEPPED UP TO ENSURE ALL ELIGIBLE VOTERS ARE INCLUDED

Another extension likely to reverify 47.6L deleted voters

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New Delhi: The ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Delhi is likely to get another extension to allow room for reverification of nearly 47.6 lakh voters whose names were deleted from the draft electoral rolls published on Aug 31.

The large number of voters up for reverification has put pressure on the existing schedule. Under this timeline, the window for claims and objections — when deleted but eligible voters and first-time applicants can apply for inclusion in the rolls — is set to end on Nov 25.

At least two officials said that the existing SIR schedule is likely to be extended, but the revised timetable has not yet been finalised. "The issue will be taken up for discussion in the next meeting and finalised," said one of the officials, adding that the extension could be for about two weeks to provide sufficient time to process reverification of absent, shifted, dead and duplicate (ASDD) voters.

In a significant relief to those left out of the draft rolls, the office of Delhi chief electoral officer (CEO) last week announced that all 47.6 lakh voters marked as ASDD during the enumeration exercise will be given another opportunity to submit their forms.

The move seeks to allow voters who failed to submit their forms during the house-to-house enumeration phase between June 30 and Aug 17 to seek inclusion in the rolls. They will be required to submit fresh enumeration forms, prescribed declarations and supporting documents to establish their eligibility. Nearly 15,000 BLOs of Delhi are likely to soon start distributing fresh forms at the registered addresses of the ASDD voters to facilitate them in filling them out. The ASDD voters who fill out enumeration forms will not have to fill forms for inclusion because these will be sufficient for their inclusion in the final rolls.

"Voters who have already submitted Form 6 for fresh enrolment during the SIR need not submit the enumeration form again. Their applications will be processed by the respective EROs," said an official.

Since the draft electoral rolls were published on Aug 31, over 3 lakh Form 6 applications for inclusion were received as of Nov 11. West district recorded the highest number of applications at 37,140, followed by North East (29,470), South East (29,407) and North West (29,175). New Delhi recorded the lowest number at 5,487. The numbers include both ASDD and first-time voters.

Delhi's draft SIR rolls had around 97.5 lakh electors against nearly 1.45 crore who were on the electoral rolls on June 30 when the SIR began in Delhi.

Out of over 33 lakh electors issued SIR notices for no-mapping and logical discrepancies like spelling mismatch, 32.5 lakh or 98.2% have been verified and earmarked for inclusion in the final rolls scheduled to be published on Dec 22, a deadline extended from Dec 4. Of the 33 lakh, 13.8 lakh had been served notices for no-mapping with previous SIR rolls and 19.3 lakh had been flagged for logical discrepancies.

BLOs to go door to door in Gzb, again

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Ghaziabad: The district administration has launched an extensive door-to-door campaign, akin to the first phase of special intensive revision (SIR), this time to identify and bring left-out voters back into the rolls. Under the drive, booth-level officers (BLOs) will be dispatched, with each of the 3,073 being assigned 350 households. RWAs have been urged to identify eligible residents for enrolment.

The move follows CM Yogi Adityanath himself questioning the absence of more than a crore voters who were on the roll in the panchayat poll but were omitted from the final roll published earlier this year after SIR in UP.

The Opposition too has been accusing the NDA of "vote theft" over large-scale deletion of names and seeking the resignation of chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

On Thursday, district magistrate and district election officer Ravindra Kumar Mandar said during the exercise, BLOs will verify existing voter registrations, identify eligible residents whose names are missing from the electoral roll and assist them in filling out Form 6. Those seeking to shift their voter registration from another constituency or state to Ghaziabad would be guided to submit Form 8.

The district administration has deployed five electoral registration officers (EROs), 26 assistant electoral registration officers (AEROs) and 865 supervisors to oversee the exercise.

Ghaziabad saw the second-highest deletions in the final electoral rolls published on April 10 after the SIR exercise in the state in percentage terms after capital Lucknow (22.9%). While 5.7 lakh names (20.2%) were removed from Ghaziabad's list, Lucknow saw 9.1 lakh deletions. UP's electorate was itself downsized by a little over 2 crore voters, a shade less than the population of Sri Lanka.

Departmental heads have been directed to relieve employees assigned BLO and supervisory responsibilities from their regular duties to ensure effective implementation of the exercise.

20.11.1937 - 06.11.2026

Our beloved

Dr. O. P. SHARMA (O.P.)

(Proponent of World Photography Day)
Founder and Chairman Emeritus,
India International Photographic Council,

peacefully left for his heavenly abode on 06.11.2026

The Prayer meeting will be held on

Friday, 20th November, 2026 | 5 PM to 6 PM

At Chinmaya Mission Auditorium, Chinmaya Mission,
89 - Lodhi Estate, Lodhi Road, New Delhi – 110003

In Grief:
Aseem Sharma (Son),
Dr. Mohita Junnarkar (Daughter in law),
Camera Art Institute
9811028879, 9819312983

Scan QR to upload testimonial / memory and photograph.
Form closes on 17th November 2026 at 6.00 pm

CORPORATE BUZZ

www.toi.in/psu

Delhi ki Diwali

Diwali is being celebrated with great fervour across India. Everywhere, the glow of decorative lights marks the joyous anticipation of Lord Ram's return. In Delhi, the Delhi Tourism Department and the Government of Delhi organised an event titled "Delhi ki Diwali – Sabse Nirali, Milkar Manane Wali" (Delhi's Diwali – Truly Unique, Celebrated Together) at

Central Park, Connaught Place, New Delhi. The event was graced by the Chief Minister, Rekha Gupta, as the chief guest, alongside the Tourism Minister, Kapil Mishra, and the Managing Director of Delhi Tourism, Suneel Anchipakka, IAS among other distinguished guests.

A shared vision

BSES recently hosted the MDs' Conference on Best Practices of Private DISCOMs at BSES Bhawan, New Delhi, bringing together senior policymakers and power sector leaders to exchange ideas, share successful practices and

explore innovations transforming electricity distribution in India. Organised under the direction of the Ministry of Power, Government of India, the conference brought together over 35 delegates from the Ministry, Power Finance Corporation (PFC), and more than 15 DISCOMs and power departments across the country. Participants included senior government functionaries, Executive Director (RDSS) of PFC, CMDs, MDs, Directors, and other senior power sector officials.

Arpan Kendra inaugurated

The Delhi Skill and Entrepreneurship University (DSEU), in collaboration with the Office of the District Magistrate, Central North, hosted the inauguration of Arpan Kendra at Kasturba Campus, Pitampura, by Rekha Gupta, CM, Delhi. The initiative aims to promote environmental sustainability, women's empowerment and livelihood generation by transforming discarded clothes into reusable and marketable products. The

event started with the formal welcome address by the Prof Ashok K Nagavat, Vice Chancellor DSEU. The initiative seeks to create sustainable livelihood opportunities through the collection, sorting, cleaning, repair and upcycling of discarded clothes into useful products such as handbags, tote bags, home décor items and accessories for sale in the market.

Blue Flag Certification

In a significant boost to sustainable tourism in the Andaman & Nicobar Islands, three additional beaches in the Union Territory have been awarded the prestigious international Blue Flag Certification for 2026-27. The Blue Flag Certification of the iconic Radhanagar Beach at Swaraj Dweep has also been successfully renewed for the same period. The three newly certified beaches are Ramanagar Beach in Diglipur, Karmatang Beach in Mayabunder and Raman Bagicha Beach in Rangat, all located in North and Middle Andaman District. With this achievement, the Islands have further strengthened their position as an emerging destination for sustainable, responsible and environmentally conscious coastal tourism.

Keeping growth on track

Housing and Urban Development Corporation Limited (HUDCO), a Navratna CPSE and an NBFC–IFC (Infrastructure Financing Company) under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, Government of India, has continued its strong growth trajectory in the second quarter of FY 2026–27. Sanjay Kulshrestha, Chairman & Managing Director, HUDCO, reaffirmed that HUDCO remains committed to financing India's urban infrastructure development and supporting the vision of Viksit Bharat.

APPOINTMENT

Sanjay Singhal, IPS (UP:1993), assumes additional charge as Director General of the Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP): Sanjay Singhal, IPS (UP:1993), assumed additional charge as Director General of the Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP) in accordance with the orders of the Government of India. On assuming charge at Force Headquarters, New Delhi, Singhal took the salute and inspected the ceremonial Guard of Honour. Sanjay Gunjyal, IPS, Additional Director General (HQ), and other senior officers were present on the occasion.

34001/1155/2627

E-mail ID:cebuildings_orissa@yahoo.co.in
cebuildings@rediffmail.com
Tel. (0674)-2391523

OFFICE OF THE ENGINEER-IN-CHIEF (CIVIL), ODISHA
NIRMAN SOUDHA, UNIT-V, BHUBANESWAR
INVITATIONS FOR BIDS (IFB)

File No.-B-I-Sports-43/2026 41824 / Bhubaneswar, the 12th Nov., 2026

Invitation for Bids
1st Corrigendum

Tender Reference No. **CE-Bldg-I-45/2026-27**

Name of the Works:
(1) **"Construction of Sports Complex at Burla, Sambalpur"**
(2) **"Construction of Sports Complex at Hirakud, Sambalpur"**
(3) **"Construction of Block Level Stadium in Simulia Block (with Indoor Hall) in Baleshwar District"**
(4) **"Construction of Block Level Stadium in Naugaon Block (with Indoor Hall) in Jagatsinghpur District"**
(5) **"Construction of Block Level Stadium with Indoor Hall in Kutra Block, Sundargada"**
(6) **"Construction of Block Level Stadium with Indoor Hall in Balisankara Block, Sundargada"**

The following changes have been made in Bid Identification No. **CE-Bldg-I-45/2026-27**

1. Bid documents such as DTCN BOQ etc. can be seen / downloaded from the Govt. Website i.e. **www.tendersorissa.gov.in**, during the period from **dt.26.11.2026 to 17.00 hours of dt.11.12.2026** instead of dt.11.11.2026 to dt.26.11.2026 for ONLINE BIDDING respectively.
2. **Online** bids shall be received till **17.00 Hours of dt.11.12.2026** instead of dt.26.11.2026.
3. The technical bids will be opened at **11.30 A.M. of dt.14.12.2026** instead of dt.27.11.2026.

All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.

Sd/-
Engineer-in-Chief (Civil),
(I/c) Chief Engineer, Buildings-I,
Odisha, Bhubaneswar

OIPR-34001/34117/1/26-27/0094

भारतीय अंतरिक्ष विज्ञान एवं प्रौद्योगिकी संस्थान
Indian Institute of Space Science and Technology
(वि. अ. आयोग अधिनियम 1956 की धारा 3 के अधीन मानित विश्वविद्यालय घोषित)
(Declared as Deemed to be University under Section 3 of the UGC Act, 1956)
भारत सरकार, अंतरिक्ष विभाग के तहत स्वायत संस्थान
(An Autonomous Institute under Department of Space, Govt. of India)
वलियमला, तिरुवनंतपुरम 695 547, केरल
Valiamala, Thiruvananthapuram 695 547, Kerala
NAAC द्वारा 'A++' मान्यता प्राप्त / NAAC 'A++' Accredited

पीएचडी कार्यक्रम में प्रवेश जनवरी सत्र - 2027
ADMISSION TO Ph.D. PROGRAMME JANUARY SESSION - 2027

आवेदन प्रक्रिया केवल ऑनलाइन रूप से ही की जाएगी
Application process will be done ONLINE only

पीएचडी कार्यक्रम में प्रवेश के लिए सूचना नीचे दी गई वेबसाइट पर उपलब्ध है।
Notification for admission to Ph.D.programme is available at:
https://admission.iist.ac.in

स्कैन करें/ Scan Here

आवेदन भरने की अंतिम तिथि
Last date to apply: 01st Dec 2026

जानकारी के लिए / **For Queries:** admissions@iist.ac.in
संपर्क सूत्र / **Contact 0471- 2568477/ 618 (on working days 0900 - 1700 hrs)**

डीन (शैक्षिकी) / Dean (Academics)

KARNATAKA STATE WAREHOUSING CORPORATION
Ugrana Bhavan, No.43, Primrose Road, Bangalore-560025.
Fax: 080-29533673, Phone No: 080-29533679 Email : kswc.eng@gmail.com

E-TENDER NOTIFICATION

No: KSWC/ENG/F-03/241/2026-27 **Date: 11.11.2026**

1. The Managing Director, Karnataka State Warehousing Corporation, Bangalore invites e-tender for Selection of Development of Cold Storage and Temperature Control Warehouses at 19 Centres in Karnataka on Design, Build, Finance, Operate and Transfer (DBFOT) Mode of PPP.
2. Prescribed EMD should be paid through online while submitting the tender.

Sl No	Name of the Centers	Name of the Taluk	Name of the District	Amount put to Tender in Crores	EMD (In Rs.)
01	Akki Alur	Hanagal	Haveri	6.07	61,000
02	Badami	Badami	Bagalakot	6.03	61,000
03	Ballary	Ballary	Ballary	15.01	1,51,000
04	Byadagi	Byadagi	Haveri	4.65	47,000
05	Channapatna	Channapatna	Ramanagar	6.18	62,000
06	Gangavathi	Gangavathi	Koppal	27.88	2,79,000
07	Haveri	Haveri	Haveri	15.36	1,54,000
08	Hirekerur	Hirekerur	Haveri	16.21	1,63,000
09	Hiriyur	Hiriyur	Chitradurga	9.78	98,000
10	Hospete	Hospete	Vijayanagar	28.10	2,81,000
11	Indi	Indi	Vijayapur	8.08	81,000
12	Jamakandi	Jamakandi	Bagalakot	5.88	59,000
13	Karatagi	Karatagi	Koppal	2.55	26,000
14	Kundhagol	Kundhagol	Dharwad	17.41	1,75,000
15	Sagara	Sagara	Shivamogga	13.32	1,34,000
16	Sedam	Sedam	Kalaburagi	27.29	2,73,000
17	Shahabad	Shahabad	Kalaburagi	6.07	61,000
18	Shikaripura	Shikaripura	Shivamogga	11.74	1,74,000
19	Sindagi	Sindagi	Vijayapur	11.45	1,45,000

3. E-Tendering should be submitted in two cover system containing "Technical Bid and Financial Bid". Financial bids of the bidder those who qualify in Technical bid will he opened.

CALENEDR OF EVENTS ARE AS FOLLOWS:

1.	Pre-Bid Meeting	23.11.2026 at 15.00 Hours
2.	Date of Uploading Queries Clarifications	30.11.2026 up to 17.00 Hours
3.	Last date for receipt of Tender	10.12.2026 up to 17.30 Hours
4.	Opening of Technical Bid	11.12.2026 up to 15.00 Hours
5.	Opening of Financial Bid	Will be intimated to the Qualified Bidders

4. The responses prepared by the Bidder and all correspondence and documents relating to the bids exchanged by the Bidder/ Developer will be in English.
5. Managing Director reserves the right to accept/reject any or all tenders without assigning any reasons.
6. Interested bidders may obtain further information at Employer's address indicated in the invitation of tender during office hours.

Sd/-
MANAGING DIRECTOR

DIPR/CP/3645/AKAR/2026-27

1001/222/2627

ODISHA STATE SEEDS CORPORATION LIMITED
(A GOVERNMENT UNDERTAKING)
SANTARAPUR, BHUBANESWAR - 751002.
Tel-MD 0674-2340573, E-mail- mdosscltd456@gmail.com
NIT NO. OSSC/Mktg (Hort)-32/2026

Short e-Tender Call Notice for Procurement of Certified Chilli Seeds for Rabi-2026-27

OSSC Ltd. invites short e-Tender only from PSUs of GOI/PSUs of State Govt. and National level Agencies recognized by Ministry of Agriculture & FW, GOI as a producer or through their authorized agencies/ICAR institutes and State Agriculture University on item wise rate contract basis **for Procurement of Certified Chilli Seeds for Rabi-2026-27** in double cover system through online mode only for the work below.

Name of the work	Purchase of Certified Chilli Seeds for Rabi-2026-27.
No of work	One
Availability of bid documents in portal	15.00 hours on dt.13.11.2026 to 17.00 hrs of dt.19.11.2026
Last date of receipt of tender in portal	17.00 hrs of dt.19.11.2026
Date and time opening of Bid	10.30 hrs of dt.20.11.2026

The detailed descriptions of crops, varieties, quantity, parameters, terms and conditions and other details of tender specified in the tender schedule would be made available in the e-Tender portal **www.tendersodisha.gov.in.** Any addendum/ corrigendum/ cancellation can also be seen in the said website. The Managing Director OSSC Ltd reserves the right to accept or reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason thereof.

Sd/-
Managing Director
OSSC Ltd.

OIPR-1001/1045/1/26-27/0038

12001/205/2627

ODISHA POLICE
STATE HEADQUARTERS
KATAKA

Odisha Police
Office of the D.G & I.G. of Police, Odisha, Kataka
Tel.: 0671-2304001, Website : police.odisha.gov.in, Email : igops.orpol@od.gov.in
RFP No. 28-RFP-Solar System-2026-2027 Date: 12.11.2026

Online Bids through e-Tender Portal **https://tendersodisha.gov.in** are invited from the eligible bidders for Supply of Complete Solar System (200 KW) for Odisha Police, Odisha, Kataka, during the current financial year 2026-27 as per the schedule mentioned below.

Sl. No.	Name of Item	Approximate quantity
1.	Complete Solar System (200 KW)	**1 set**

Events	Date
RFP Issue Date	12.11.2026
Date & Time of Pre Bid meeting Queries to be submit on Mail ID: **igops.orpol@od.gov.in** by Date : 16.11.2026 by 05.00 PM.	In this connection a pre-proposal meeting will be held in virtual mode based on the request receive from bidder and the link will be sent through mail for the meeting. The pre-bid date is tentatively nature and subjected to postponement which be duly informed through mail intimated through Mail-**igops.orpol@od.gov.in** Venue - Commandant, SOG, At/Po/Ps- Chandaka, Dist-Khurda, BBSR, PIN-754005
RFP Submission Due Date and time	03.12.2026
Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bids	04.12.2026
Bid to RA enabled	Yes
Tender Document fee {(Non-refundable Rs. 590/- {Rs.500/- + 18% GST (Rs. 90/-)}	In favour of A.I.G. of Police (Prov.), Odisha, Kataka payable at Kataka. (Demand Draft)
EMD (Earnest Money Deposit) Rs. 2,38,000/- (Two lakh thirty-eight thousand only)	In favour of A.I.G. of Police (Prov.), Odisha, Kataka payable at Kataka. (Demand Draft)

The bid document with all information relating to the bidding process including cost of bid document, Prequalification criteria and terms & conditions are available in the websites: https://tendersodisha.gov.in. The Authority reserves the right to accept / reject any part thereof or all the bids without assigning any reason thereof.

Sd/-
A.I.G. of Police (Provisioning)
Odisha, Kataka
(Tender Calling Authority)

Website- police.odisha.gov.in
Email - sphqrs.odpol@od.gov.in

Buxi Bazar, Kataka-753001
Tel./Fax No. 0671-2304354

OIPR - 12001/12018/1/26-27/0001

10001/709/2627

NOTICE INVITING BID
Odisha State AYUSH Society
National AYUSH Mission
Directorate of AYUSH
Department of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of Odisha
Heads of Department Building, 3rd Floor (Annex), Unit-5, Bhubaneswar-751001
Tel : 0674-2394577, Email : spmu.namodisha@gmail.com Web : https://ayush.odisha.gov.in

Bid Ref. No. : NAM-PR-O-29/2026/10756/OSAS, **Dated : 12 NOV 2026**

Online Bids through **e-Tender portal (https://tendersodisha.gov.in)** are invited exclusively from M/s Indian Medicine Pharmaceutical Corporation Limited, other Central Public Sector Undertakings, Public Sector Undertakings, Pharmacies and Co-Operatives Under State/UT Governments (having valid Ayurvedic Drug Manufacturing Licence and Certificate of GMP) for supply of **Ayurvedic Drugs** for use in the Government Ayurvedic Hospitals/ Dispensaries and AYUSH Clinics co-located in the PHCs/CHCs of the State as per the particulars mentioned below:

Sl. No.	Particulars	Date & time	
1.	Date & time of release of bid	13/11/2026, 3:00 PM	
2.	Date & time for submission of queries by E-Mail id- **tenderayushodisha@gmail.com**	20/11/2026, up to 5:00 PM	
3.	Date & time of Pre-Bid meeting	23/11/2026, 11:00 AM	
4.	Date & time of Online bid submission	Start Date & Time	End Date & Time
		25/11/2026, 3:00 PM	24/12/2026, 6:00 PM
5.	Date & time for submission of Offline hard copy of Tender Documents, Tender Document Fee and EMD amount as per section-VI of tender document	Start Date & Time	End Date & Time
		29/12/2026, 10:00 AM	05/01/2027, 11:00 AM
6.	Date & time of online Technical bid opening	05/01/2027, 11:30 AM	
7.	Date of opening of Price Bid	To be informed to the qualified bidders	

The bid document with all information relating to the bidding process including cost of bid document, EMDs, Prequalification criteria and terms & conditions are available in the websites: **https://tendersodisha.gov.in** and **https://ayush.odisha.gov.in/**. The Authority reserves the right to accept/ reject any part thereof or all the bids without assigning any reason thereof. All notice will be published in the Director AYUSH website **https://ayush.odisha.gov.in** Hence the bidders are requested to visit Director AYUSH website **https://ayush.odisha.gov.in** time to time for any published notice against the tender.

Sd/-
Director AYUSH-cum-MD, NAM
Directorate of AYUSH, Odisha

NOTICE INVITING BID
Odisha State AYUSH Society
National AYUSH Mission
Directorate of AYUSH
Department of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of Odisha
Heads of Department Building, 3rd Floor (Annex), Unit-5, Bhubaneswar-751001
Tel : 0674-2394577, Email : spmu.namodisha@gmail.com Web : https://ayush.odisha.gov.in

Bid Ref. No. : NAM-PR-O-28/2026/10761/OSAS, **Dated : 12 NOV 2026**

Online Bids through **e-Tender portal (https://tendersodisha.gov.in)** are invited exclusively from M/s Indian Medicine Pharmaceutical Corporation Limited, other Central Public Sector Undertakings, Public Sector Undertakings, Pharmacies and Co-Operatives Under State/UT Governments (having valid Homoeopathic Drug Manufacturing Licence and Certificate of GMP) for supply of **Homoeopathic Drugs** for use in the Government Homoeopathic Hospitals/ Dispensaries and AYUSH Clinics co-located in the PHCs/CHCs of the State as per the particulars mentioned below:

Sl. No.	Particulars	Date & time	
1.	Date & time of release of bid	13/11/2026, 3:00 PM	
2.	Date & time for submission of queries by E-Mail id- **tenderayushodisha@gmail.com**	20/11/2026, up to 5:00 PM	
3.	Date & time of Pre-Bid meeting	23/11/2026, 3:30 PM	
4.	Date & time of Online bid submission	Start Date & Time	End Date & Time
		25/11/2026, 3:00 PM	24/12/2026, 6:00 PM
5.	Date & time for submission of Offline hard copy of Tender Documents, Tender Document Fee and EMD amount as per section-VI of tender document	Start Date & Time	End Date & Time
		29/12/2026, 10:00 AM	05/01/2027, 11:00 AM
6.	Date & time of online Technical bid opening	07/01/2027, 11:30 AM	
7.	Date of opening of Price Bid	To be informed to the qualified bidders	

The bid document with all information relating to the bidding process including cost of bid document, EMDs, Prequalification criteria and terms & conditions are available in the websites: **https://tendersodisha.gov.in** and **https://ayush.odisha.gov.in/**. The Authority reserves the right to accept/ reject any part thereof or all the bids without assigning any reason thereof. All notice will be published in the Director AYUSH website **https://ayush.odisha.gov.in** Hence the bidders are requested to visit Director AYUSH website **https://ayush.odisha.gov.in** time to time for any published notice against the tender.

Sd/-
Director AYUSH-cum-MD, NAM
Directorate of AYUSH, Odisha

OIPR-10001/10056/1/26-27/0010

13001/2448/2627

BHUBANESWAR DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
AKASH SHOVA BUILDING,
SACHIVALAYA MARG, BHUBANESWAR - 751001
PABX No.0674-2392801/0998/6437, FAX No.0674-2390633 / 085
Visit us at: http://www.bda.gov.in/
Invitation for Bids

Bid Identification No.663/EM/BDA/2026-27 Date. 10/11/2026

The Chief Engineer-cum-Engineer Member, B.D.A, Bhubaneswar on behalf of Bhubaneswar Development Authority, Bhubaneswar invites percentage rate bids in Double Cover system in **ONLINE MODE** only from the eligible bidders for Electrical works as mentioned below:

1	Name of the work	:	**Development of External Electrification and Permanent Power Supply to TP-3 Project under BDA, Bhubaneswar**
2	Total No. of electrical work	:	**01 (One) No**
3	Amount put to tender	:	**Rs.5203.53 Lakh**
4	Class of Contractor	:	**HT or above**
5	Period of Completion	:	**11 (Eleven) Calendar Months**
6	Cost of Bid Documents	:	**Rs. 10,000.00 + 18% GST = Rs.11,800.00 (Through online transfer by the last date & time for receipt of bids)**
7	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	:	**1% of estimated cost put to tender. (Through online transfer by the last date & time for receipt of bids)**
8	Availability of Tender	:	**From 16.11.2026 up to 5.30 PM of 30.11.2026 https://tendersodisha.gov.in**
9	Date of opening of Tender	:	**Dt. 01.12.2026 at 11.30 AM**
10	Place of opening of Tender	:	**O/o-Chief Engineer-cum-Engineer Member, BDA, Bhubaneswar**

Further details can be seen from the website: **https://tendersodisha.gov.in**. Any addendum / corrigendum/cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website.

Sd/-
Chief Engineer-cum-Engineer Member,
BDA, Bhubaneswar

OIPR-13001/13033/1/26-27/0183

UP STATE DISASTER MANAGEMENT AUTHORITY
UP SDMA Bhawan, Sector 07, Gomti Nagar Extension
Amar Shaheed Path, Lucknow - 226002

Advt No.- 1166/UPSDMA/Internship/2026-27 Dated: 12.11.2026

Advertisement for Internship Program in Uttar Pradesh State Disaster Management Authority/ Relief Commissioner Office for Graduate and Post Graduate Students

1. Applications are invited for **27 seats of Internship Program in Uttar Pradesh State Disaster Management Authority/ Relief Commissioner Office** for Graduate and Post Graduate students from renowned universities and colleges as per to Internship guidelines through e-mail id: **hr.upsdma@gmail.com** till **13 December, 2026** by 23:59 hrs.
2. Fix stipend of **Rs. 10,000/- per month** will be paid to interns during **06 months** Internship period.
3. Preference will be given to students of **NAAC accredited A++ and A+** Universities/Colleges/Institutes.
4. The detailed Internship guideline and application format can be downloaded from UP SDMA website: **sdma.up.gov.in.** Enrolment on Internship seat will be strictly done as per to Internship guideline. Before applying for Internship Programme please read Internship Guideline.

Addl. Chief Executive Officer,
UP State Disaster Management Authority

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HPGCL	NIT NO. CH-20/MP-7094/PRESSURE PARTS/2026 SUB:- OVERHAULING OF BOILER FURNACE PRESSURE PARTS AND HP VALVES FOR 250 MW, UNIT- 7, PANIPAT	10.11.2026 26.11.2026	Rs. 1,81,56,124/-	www.hpgcl.org.in	01802566015 xenmtcplg1@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in Ro No. 50975

34001/1153/2627

E-mail ID:cebuildings_orissa@yahoo.co.in
cebuildings@rediffmail.com
Tel. (0674)-2391523

OFFICE OF THE ENGINEER-IN-CHIEF (CIVIL), ODISHA
NIRMAN SOUDHA, UNIT-V, BHUBANESWAR
INVITATIONS FOR BIDS (IFB)

File No.-B-I-SD&TE-(ITI)-11/2023 41737 / Bhubaneswar, the 12th Nov., 2026

Invitation for Bids
2nd Corrigendum

Tender Reference No. CE-Bldg-I-43/2026-27

Name of the Works:
(1) **Construction of CHC Building at Banarpal, Angul, Odisha**
(2) **Construction of New Community Health Centre Building at Badachana in the district of Jajpur.**
(3) **Construction of OPD and 50 Bedded IPD Building at SDH Talcher, Angul under Health Action Plan 2023-24.**
(4) **Construction of New Science and Arts Block at Vyasanagar (Autonomous) College, Vyasanagar, Jajpur"**

The following changes have been made in Bid Identification No. **CE-Bldg-I-43/2026-27**

1. Bid documents such as DTCN BOQ etc. can be seen / downloaded from the Govt. Website i.e. **www.tendersorissa.gov.in**, during the period from **dt.20.11.2026 to 17.00 hours of dt.04.12.2026** instead of dt.11.11.2026 to dt.26.11.2026 for ONLINE BIDDING respectively.
2. **Online** bids shall be received till **17.00 Hours of dt.04.12.2026** instead of dt.26.11.2026.
3. The technical bids will be opened at **11.30 A.M. of dt.05.12.2026** instead of dt.27.11.2026.

All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.

Sd/-
Engineer-in-Chief (Civil),
(I/c) Chief Engineer, Buildings-I,
Odisha, Bhubaneswar

OIPR-34001/34117/1/26-27/0093

SPECIAL BRANCH
POLICE HEADQUARTER, M.P., BHOPAL

NO. SB / Store/2026-25 (812) **Bhopal, Dated 30-10-2026**

"ONLINE E-TENDER NOTICE "

E-tender are invited by Assistant Inspector General of Police, Special Branch (G) M.P., Bhopal on behalf of DGP MP Bhopal for the following item on website https://mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app.-

S. No.	Name of Item(s)	Qty.	Tender Fees(Rs.)	EMD (Rs.)	Tender No.
			Paid Online Through mptenders.gov.in		
1	B,P. Patka	100	3,000/-	75,000/-	2nd Tender

1. Cost of tender document (Tender Fee) is non refundable and cannot be exempted in any condition & **must submit online through website** https://mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app.
2. Tender document can be download from the website of MP Police (www.mppolice. gov.in)
3. Bids shall be submitted online only at MP Tenders website: https://mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app
4. **Tender Schedule** :

No.	Tender Activity	Date & Time
i	E-Tender Publish Date	31/10/2026 at 1700 hrs.
ii	Tender document download Start Date	31/10/2026 up to 1730 hrs.
iii	Submission of written queries -through e-mail: aigg-sb@mppolice.gov.in	**05/11/2026 up to 1700 hrs.**
iv	Pre Bid Meeting along with written queries	06/11/2026 at 1200 hrs.
v	Bid Submission Start Date	10/11/2026 at 1000 hrs.
vi	Last date of online e-Tender submission	20/11/2026 up to 1600 hrs.
vii	Bid will be opened on	23/11/2026 up to 1200 hrs.
viii	Demonstration from	Demo date will be announced seperately

5. Intending Bidders are advised to visit this website regularly till closing date of submission to keep themselves updated as any change/ modification in the tender will be intimated through this website only by corrigendum /addendum/ amendment.
6. Bids will be opened as per date/time as mentioned in the Tender Critical Date Sheet. After online opening of Technical-Bid the results of their qualification as well Price-Bid opening will be intimated later.

Sd/-
D.I.G. of Police
Intelligence (G) M.P. Bhopal
Tel. No. 0755-2443654

G-21345/26

''पॉक्सो है सुरक्षा का हथियार, बच्चों पर न करें अत्याचार''

How Chhath Puja Has Turned Into A Vote-Catching Festival

Yamuna In Focus As Parties Fall Over Each Other To Woo Poorvanchalis

Abhinav.Rajput
@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: A cruise ride on the Yamuna, a minister riding a jetty along its banks, a BJP MP swimming in it and AAP MLAs floating his effigy at another stretch. In the run-up to Chhath this year, Yamuna cleaning has taken centrestage in Delhi.

This week, CM Rekha Gupta took the inaugural ride on a cruise launched on the Sonia Vihar-Jagatpur stretch while minister Parvesh Verma rode a jetty. A week earlier, BJP MP from North East Delhi Manoj Tiwari swam in the Yamuna to demonstrate its water was clean. Days later, AAP MLAs floated an effigy of Tiwari at Kalindi Kunj, challenging him to take a dip there instead — a stretch they claimed was far more polluted.

The political contest over the river is not new. In Oct 2025, a controversy erupted over a temporary artificial pool or water channel constructed at Vasudev Ghat, with AAP alleging it was meant to create an impression of a clean Yamuna ahead of PM Modi's scheduled visit for Chhath, which eventually did not happen.

These episodes, unfolding in just over a year since BJP assumed office in Delhi, underline how the river and the festival have become intertwined with the capital's political messaging.

But the script was not very different when AAP was in power. From Jat leader Parvesh Verma defying DDMA restrictions to gather at the Yamuna for Chhath during Covid, to then CM Atishi, who's from the Punjabi community, performing Chhath and leaders from the Bania community such as Arvind Kejriwal and Vijay Goel making appearances at ghats, the festival has long offered politicians an opportunity to connect with voters.

Chhath's growing political significance has much to do with Delhi's changing demography. The Poorvanchali community, a broad term commonly used for people from Bihar, eastern UP and non-tribal parts of Jharkhand, is estimated to account for over 30% of Delhi's population and electorate.

Sidharth Mishra, author of Delhi Political 1947–2013, said the festival's character in Delhi has acquired a distinctly political dimension. "If you see the way Chhath is celebrated in Bihar and Jharkhand, it is very different from Delhi. The essence of the festival has been simplicity and cleaning of the river or ghat. But in Delhi, it has also become a reach-out occasion for politicians. For instance, you will hardly see politicians' banners at ghats in Poorvanchal, but in Delhi you will see large hoardings of them," he said.

Over the years, the festival's institutional recognition has grown. Delhi govt declared Chhath Puja a public holiday for the first time in 2014. This year, with the evening arghya falling on Sunday, govt has declared Monday a holiday for the morning arghya. Sources said this was done to appease the Poorvanchal community. Delhi govt is also setting up

TIMES Special

1,482 Chhath ghats across 996 locations, the scale of the arrangements reflecting how the festival has become part of the city's civic calendar.

Pavan Chaurasia, assistant professor at DU's Shivaji College, said the capital's political transformation over the past couple of decades is closely linked to demographic and economic changes.

"People from the eastern part of India, especially Bihar and eastern UP, have settled in Delhi in huge numbers, thereby making them a significant vote bank. Secondly, the community itself has witnessed a massive economic transition in past two decades. From being categorised as lower middle class or working class, they have now joined elite groups like diplomats, bureaucrats, professors, doctors and lawyers, making them both a social and economic force," he said, adding that the community's growing influence is often reflected in its cultural celebrations.

Beyond the political symbolism, Chhath has emerged as an annual public audit of Yamuna's condition. The river may be viewed from bridges and embankments through much of the year, but the festival brings thousands of devotees directly into contact with its water. Froth on the Yamuna is a recurring sight, but its political impact becomes far greater when photographs show devotees performing rituals amid the foam.

Former MP Mahabal Mishra of Congress was the first to speak of Poorvanchalis in Delhi and had demanded a Chhath holiday. Later, when AAP entered the fray in 2013, it gave tickets to a large number of people from the community. In 2016, BJP made Manoj Tiwari its state president. The current BJP govt has given Pankaj Singh, who comes from Buxar, a place in its cabinet.

In the 2025 general elections, BJP had changed all candidates in Delhi except Tiwari, with sources attributing the move to his Poorvanchali background.

Chief minister Rekha Gupta, minister Parvesh Verma and others took part in the launch of the city's first cruise service a few days before Chhath

File photos

For ex-CM Arvind Kejriwal, Chhath was an occasion to connect with Poorvanchalis

Ahead of the festival, BJP MP Manoj Tiwari took a dip in Yamuna last month

Delhi, Bihar roll out 77 buses with subsidised fares

To ease travel for people heading home for Chhath Puja, Delhi and Bihar govts have started an initial fleet of 77 buses between the two states, with subsidised fares to make festival travel more affordable, Delhi govt said in a statement.

The services, operating from Anand Vihar Bus Terminal, will connect Delhi with five divisions in Bihar. Muzaffarpur has been allocated the highest number of buses at 36, followed by Patna (13), Purnia (12), Gaya (10) and Darbhanga (6).

Passengers travelling in non-AC seater, non-AC sleeper, AC seater and AC sleeper buses will benefit from reduced fares ranging from Rs 134 to Rs 1,028, depending on the route and category. Transport minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said the initiative was aimed at providing safe and affordable travel to lakhs of people from Bihar and Poorvanchal living in Delhi during the festival. TNN

Photos: **Anindya Chattopadhyay**

FAITH FINDS A WAY

Anindya.Chattopadhyay@timesofindia.com

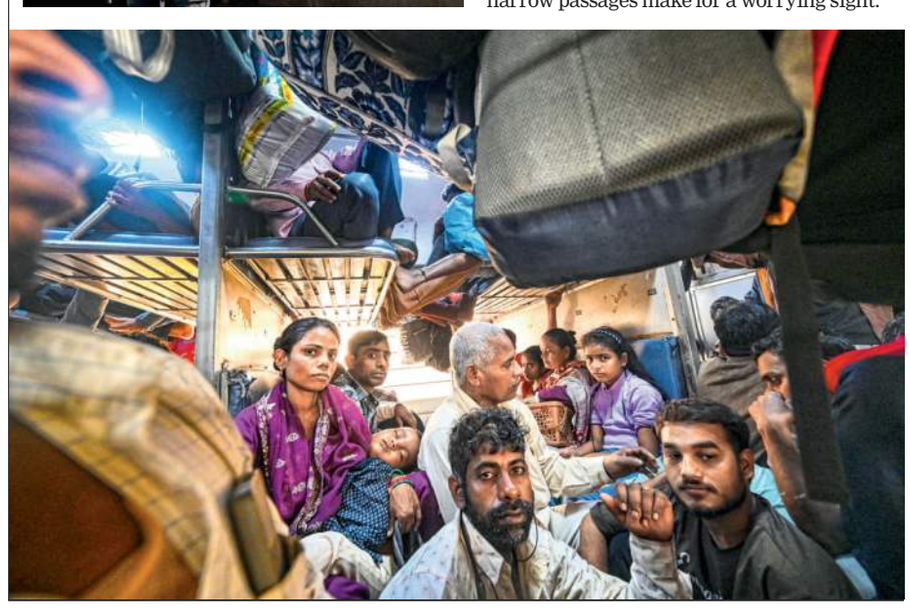
New Delhi: At Anand Vihar railway terminal, the Chhath rush has exposed a harsh reality: there may be more space for passengers outside the station, but barely any room inside trains.

Thousands are heading to Bihar, Jharkhand and eastern UP, with even special trains struggling to meet demand.

"Bhai, train ke andar saans lene ki jagah nahin, kaise jaoge?" an RPF personnel warned one passenger, Abhigyan, who was trying to reach Bhagalpur. Fearing a similar crush on a Danapur-bound train, Jagdish and his sister decided to wait for a special train.

Outside the terminal, permanent and temporary holding areas, food stalls and Chhath folk songs offer some relief. But the moment a train arrives, the scramble begins, with passengers jostling to get in through doors and windows.

The foot overbridge linking the Metro, ISBT and railway terminal is another trouble spot. Crowds hauling heavy luggage through the narrow passages make for a worrying sight.



Mind the gap: DPCC fines STPs and CETPs ₹50 crore in 6 years, but recovers just ₹3 lakh

Kushagra.Dixit
@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: Even as untreated sewage continues to choke Yamuna, Delhi's treatment plants, some operated by private organisations and most by Delhi Jal Board (DJB), seem to be getting away lightly as penalties imposed on them remain largely unrecovered.

An RTI disclosure has revealed that Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC) imposed nearly Rs 49.7 crore in environmental compensation on sewage treatment plants (STPs) and common effluent treatment plants (CETPs) in the past six years, but managed to recover just Rs 3 lakh.

This exposes a troubling disconnect between pollution-control efforts and ground realities, raising questions as to whether the penalties are serving as a deterrent at all, even as Yamuna continues to suffer from the city's burgeoning burden of sewage.

Information obtained under RTI Act by Punjab-based advocate and environmentalist Kamal Anand shows that DPCC imposed over Rs 23.2 crore in environmental compensation on 18 STPs across Delhi between Nov 2011 and May 2026, but recovered only Rs 3 lakh. The RTI also disclosed that another Rs 25.5 crore was imposed on 13 CETPs, with no recovery recorded in the April 2026 disclosure.

"The imposition of penalties running into crores is a clear admission that the vast majority of these plants are failing to meet environmental norms, leading to widespread water pollution across the city. What is truly alarming is that the actual realisation is negligible," Anand said.

Pointing out that most of these plants are run by govt, he said, "If the fines remain confined to paper with no real financial accountability or tangible improvement on the ground, the entire purpose of deterrence is defeated."

A second RTI, filed by Delhi-based environmentalist and RTI activist Amit Gupta, reveals that DPCC imposed more than Rs 5.3 crore in environmental compensation on CETPs over three financial years from 2023-24. The amount shot up from Rs 5 lakh in 2024-25 to Rs 4.4 crore in 2025-26 — an 88-fold increase.

The same disclosure lists nearly Rs 23 crore in separate penalties against domestic STPs and Delhi Jal Board (DJB), including Rs 18.5 crore imposed on the latter in Feb 2025 for failing to provide a sewerage network, and Rs 1.5 crore for the DSTP at Smriti Van, Vasant Kunj.

Significantly, DPCC confirmed in the RTI response that no funds had been allocated to it for cleaning Yamuna.

"STPs and CETPs are supposed to be Delhi's primary line of defence to clean wastewater and industrial effluent before they enter the river. Yet these RTI figures show how deep and systemic the crisis is," Gupta said, adding that merely imposing fines on paper will not revive Yamuna unless those running these treatment plants are held strictly accountable.

The figures acquire significance against the backdrop of findings submitted by NGT-appointed amici curiae, about which **TOI** reported earlier. The 16-page findings in Sept flagged 249 million litres per day (MLD) of sewage remaining outside Delhi's treatment system, 12 of 22 sewage drains remaining untapped and 16.5 lakh households still lacking sewer connections.

It also questioned DJB's claim of 91.5% STP utilisation, noting that a water-quality analysis showed high biochemical oxygen demand, zero dissolved oxygen and alarmingly high faecal coliform levels. The report suggested that underperformance of commissioned STPs, illegal discharge bypassing treatment systems and untapped drains could explain the continuing riverine pollution.

₹25 CRORE FINE IMPOSED ON CETPS, NIL RECOVERED

File photo

Penalties imposed since 2020 on STPs
₹23.2crore
Recovered
₹3 lakh

CETP
₹25.5crore
Recovered
Nil

88.5-fold increase in CETP penalties over last two years

Zero funds allocated to DPCC for Yamuna cleaning, according to the RTI response

Yamuna sewage crisis

- 249 MLD sewage outside the treatment system
- 12 of 22 sewage drains untapped
- 16.5 lakh households without sewer connections
- Seven STPs reported non-compliant
- High BOD, nil dissolved oxygen and alarming faecal coliform in water-quality analysis

Delhi govt and AAP spar as dead fish surface in Yamuna

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New Delhi: Yamuna's pollution woes have resurfaced with visuals of dead fish floating along the Sonia Vihar stretch. The sightings came just a day after the official launch of Delhi's first recreational river cruise service, the Namo Yamuna River Safari.

The incident has triggered a political row, with Delhi environment minister Parvesh Verma alleging that the dead fish were deliberately dumped into the river to discredit govt. Opposition AAP questioned, "If this water is not safe for fish, is it safe for humans?"

Verma alleged that officials informed him of people dumping dead fish into the river soon after the ferry service began operating. He accused AAP workers of attempting to spoil the atmosphere ahead of Chhath, when devotees enter the river to offer prayers. The minister said he directed officials to file an FIR and identify those responsible.

Countering the claim, AAP posted a video on X and wrote, "Local residents allege that chemicals were dumped into Yamuna to prepare for CM Rekha Gupta's cruise programme, killing hundreds of thousands of fish."

SOMETHING FISHY?

Regardless of the war of words, the latest incident has brought renewed attention to recurring fish mortality episodes in Yamuna, which experts have previously linked to pollution spikes and deteriorating water quality.

In Oct, **TOI** reported the death of hundreds of fish in Burari, upstream of Wazirabad barrage, a stretch often considered Yamuna's cleanest section in Delhi. The deaths were concerning as they occurred soon after monsoon, when the river is expected to have adequate water and cleaner upstream inflows. Fishermen had reported a rising stink from the river before the fish were found floating in its main channel.

At the time, environmental experts called for an investigation into the possible causes, including industrial pollution, untreated sewage discharges and restricted environmental flows. Bhim Singh Rawat of South Asia Network on Dams, Rivers and People had warned that if pollution was responsible for the death of the fish, the adverse effects could extend to Delhi's drinking water source.

An earlier analysis of the river's water quality by Delhi Pollution Control Committee recorded elevated pollution levels across several stretches, including high biochemical oxygen demand and faecal coliform at ISBT Bridge.

The latest incident along Sonia Vihar comes amid continuing concerns over the river's health, with experts calling for scientific investigation rather than assumptions. Following the Oct incident, environmental group Earth Warrior had sought immediate water testing for dissolved oxygen, biochemical oxygen demand, faecal coliform, heavy metals and toxic substances.

Delhi Jal Board tweeted Thursday, "The ammonia level in Yamuna in Wazirabad pond is currently recorded at approximately 0.5 ppm, which is within the manageable range. There is no significant impact on water treatment operations. There's no curtailment of water production."

Video shows assault on flower seller, six held

New Delhi: Six people, including four minors, were apprehended after a video showing a flower seller being beaten up near Yusuf Sarai bus stand surfaced on social media.

Police said the assailants were allegedly relatives of the woman and had attacked her over a previous dispute on the intervening night of Diwali.

The accused were identified as Soni (35) and Usman (22), both residents of Jaitpur, along with four children in conflict with the law. Police said both Soni and Usman have two previous criminal involvements.

The case came to light after a video circulated online showing Radha (37) being assaulted by a group of men. Two of her relatives, who intervened to rescue her, were also assaulted. The injured were taken to a hospital. Police said a case was subsequently registered. TNN

How past disputes culminated in Faridabad shooting

▸Continued from P1

Sharma did not stop even after Dhankar slumped to the ground. He fired at his son, who escaped behind parked cars. The incident took place just 500m from the police commissioner's office.

CCTV footage shows the sequence of events that led to the cold-blooded murder on Nov 7. According to police, Sharma, a scrap dealer, fired 14 rounds from his licensed pistol. Dhankar, an ex-Asia Pacific head of Tech Mahindra, died before he could be wheeled into hospital.

The killing followed weeks of friction between the two families, who lived in the same building in Sector 21C and shared its parking area. Dhankar's family occupied the ground floor, Sharma lived on the second, and two other families occupied the first and top floors. With four households competing for space, parking had repeatedly triggered arguments, a relative told **TOI**.

According to police, there was also tension between the two families over Sharma's pet dog. Dhankar's son had objected to the dog defecating in the common parking area.

An earlier confrontation on Oct 22 had further soured relations. Sharma allegedly damaged the gate of Dhankar's house, an incident captured on the family's CCTV cameras. The family gave the footage to police, who called Sharma to the station and allegedly reprimanded him.

But another confrontation took place at the local police station on the day of the murder. Sources said Dhankar's friends and aides confronted Sharma, abused and manhandled him. Both sides returned home at 6pm. But the humiliation is likely to have fuelled his anger.

Later that evening, Sharma rang the bell at Dhankar's house and repeatedly urged him to come downstairs and move his car. Dhankar came down with his son, Shaurya. In the footage, Sharma is heard addressing him as "Dhankar sahab" and repeatedly saying, "Brother, brother, brother, please."

The exchange turned hostile. When Dhankar suggested he did not want to continue the conversation, Shaurya began moving towards the staircase. Sharma allegedly stopped him and asked him to return. He then pulled out his licensed .45 ACP pistol, fitted with an extended magazine, and fired.

Dhankar tried to get away, staggering from the garage towards the road. Sharma dashed towards him, firing as he went. As Dhankar fell outside the building, his wife rushed out. But Sharma continued firing and changed the magazine. He then threatened the family and called out to them to come outside.

Dhankar returned from Singapore on Nov 5 for his nephew's wedding in Meerut.

Police arrested Sharma near DLF Chowk in Ballabhgarh the next day and seized the weapon. A case was registered against him under BNS sections 103 (murder), 109 (attempt to murder) and 61(2) (criminal conspiracy).

A MURDER MOST FOUL

Screengrabs of Sharma (wearing cap) and Dhankar arguing in the garage. Dhankar's killing followed weeks of friction between the two families, who lived in the same building in Sector 21C and shared its parking area

SUV kills 3 fixing puncture on Delhi-Mum e-way

Jaipur: Three people were killed after a speeding SUV hit them while they were changing a punctured tyre on the Delhi-Mumbai Expressway in Alwar around 1.30 am Thursday.

The deceased were identified as Manisha Gupta (26), an event manager from Trilokpuri in Delhi, NHAI employee Jagmohan (25) of Sheetal village in Alwar, and cab driver Azad (30) from Ajmer. Manisha, along with another woman, was on her way to Jaipur when the cab tyre got punctured.

"Since the cab developed a tyre puncture near Gurjar Khora culvert, the driver contacted the NHAI helpline. Jagmohan reached the spot along with his colleagues. While Jagmohan was gathering details, a speeding MG Hector coming from the Delhi side rammed them," a cop at Lachhmangarh police station said. TNN

New Promise: Bhalswa Landfill To Be Flattened By April Next Year

Deadline Extended For Seventh Time; 21 Lakh MT Of Waste Remains At Site

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New Delhi: Delhi's much-promised dream of getting rid of its three landfill sites remains elusive.

Even as MCD races against time to clear legacy waste, the target for flattening the Bhalswa landfill has been pushed back yet again — for the seventh time. After missing the Dec 2026 target, the civic body on Nov 8 set April 2027 as the new deadline.

On Thursday, mayor Pravesh Wahi and MCD commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar visited the site to review the progress of biomining work under Phase III. The work had been suspended last month after the agency engaged for Phase II completed its target. The new agency took time to set up machinery and begin operations, resulting in a disruption in the biomining process, said officials.

The Bhalswa landfill was adopted by Union housing and urban affairs minister ML Khattar in Sept 2025. He had assured it would be flattened within a year. However, 21 lakh metric tonnes of waste remains at the site.

Wahi said over 1 crore metric tonnes of legacy waste had been cleared but the remaining will take time to be processed, adding, "Officials have been instructed to accelerate the pace of the waste disposal process."

Progress reports on waste disposal will be reviewed daily, Wahi said, adding, "Around 30% of land at Bhalswa and 60% at Okhla have been reclaimed through legacy waste disposal."

Wahi said disposal of fresh waste had also been accelerated. The number of machines deployed will be increased and a state-of-the-art machine, 'Vajra', was being installed for the purpose, he added.

Before the latest timeline revision, MCD had in mid-Oct extended the deadline to Feb 2027. Officials attributed the delay to several reasons, including a change of contractor responsible for processing and removing the legacy waste. The previous contractor had been assigned the task of removing 30 lakh metric tonnes. Following the completion of phase II, MCD floated a fresh tender and another agency took over at revised rates, resulting in a gap in operations, said officials. "Factors like rain and dumping of fresh waste also led to delay," said an official.

Clearing of the Okhla landfill has also seen repeated extensions. MCD revised its deadline in May, shifting it to Oct, marking the fifth extension since biomining began at the site in 2019. It then pushed the target to Dec 2026, and then Jan 2027.

Meanwhile, dumping of fresh waste at all three landfills remains a major challenge. About 3,000-3,500 metric tonnes land at each site daily, adding to the existing waste burden.

"MCD is aggressively working on establishing five fresh waste processing plants so that fresh dumping can be stopped," said the official.

Together, the five plants will have a processing capacity of 5,900 metric tonnes per day. These include facilities at Bhalswa (1,800 tonnes per day), Okhla (1,400 TPD), Narela-Bawana (1,200 TPD), Ghazipur (800 TPD) and Singhola (700 TPD). The Singhola plant will also process drain silt.

An MCD official said construction of the fresh waste processing plants at Okhla and Singhola had begun, with a target to complete the work by Nov-end.

Dhaula Kuan metro station finally gets direct link to FOB

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EASIER ACCESS FOR PASSENGERS

New Delhi: Commuters using Dhaula Kuan metro station from the other side of NH-8 will no longer have to climb up and down two separate staircases and walk around 200 metres to reach the station. Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) has now connected the PWD foot overbridge (FOB) directly to the station's concourse level, easing access for passengers and addressing a long-standing inconvenience raised by commuters.

"DMRC has connected the existing PWD FOB on National Highway-8 situated outside its Dhaula Kuan metro station of Airport Express Line with its concourse level to provide direct and convenient access for passengers approaching from the opposite side of NH-8," said a DMRC official.

The extension was opened for commuters last week. It is around 16.9 metres long, 2.9 metres wide and stands at a height of about 6.4 metres from the road level.

Earlier, passengers standing on the other side of the highway were required to climb the stairs of the PWD FOB, cross it, descend, walk around 200 metres, and then take another flight of stairs to reach the concourse level of the station, causing significant inconvenience to daily commuters.

"In line with its commitment to making metro travel a delightful and hassle-free experience, DMRC took cognisance of the requirement and connected this FOB... to the concourse level of the station. This eliminates the need for multiple-level changes and the intermediate walk, removing the hardships earlier faced by passengers," said the official, adding that this initiative strengthens last-mile connectivity.

Dhaula Kuan is an interchange station with Airport Express and Pink lines. In 2018, the Pink Line stretch at Dhaula Kuan attained a rail-level height of 23.6 metres, becoming the highest point on the Delhi Metro network at that time. Operational from Aug 6, 2018, this section crosses above Airport Express Line, major arterial roads and multiple flyovers, creating a complex multi-layered transport intersection.

Dhaula Kuan retained this distinction for nearly eight years, until Delhi Metro climbed to its new highest point, rising over 28 metres above the ground, near the new Haiderpur Badli Mor station on the Magenta Line extension.

DDA plans its 2nd convention centre, at Shalimar Bagh

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New Delhi: Delhi Development Authority (DDA) is developing a convention centre on a 2.44-acre plot in Shalimar Bagh, marking its first major convention facility offered under a long-term, annual licence-fee land monetisation model.

The authority has invited expressions of interest from private firms to build the facility under a 55-year allotment, including construction. Officials said the public-private partnership project will be a major development under DDA's new model.

DDA currently has a convention centre at Shastri Park, and the proposed facility at Shalimar Bagh is expected to be a significant addition to the city's infrastructure.

"Located in C and D Blocks of the District Centre near Haiderpur Badli Mor metro station, the site permits a 15,944.6 sqm floor area ratio (FAR) and 50% ground coverage. Parking will follow the District Centre's comprehensive scheme with three equivalent car spaces," DDA said.

According to DDA, the project will follow the development control norms under Master Plan for Delhi 2047 and the Unified Building Bye-Laws, 2016, on a tentative basis.

The site connects to the Outer Ring Road and Karnal Bypass via Chaudhary Meher Chand Yadav Marg. It is a 10-minute drive from Samaypur Badli Railway Station, and roughly 30 and 45 minutes from Old Delhi and New Delhi stations, respectively, an official said.

Court flags police failure in certifying CCTV footage in 2020 riots case

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New Delhi: A court, while acquitting all surviving accused in a 2020 northeast Delhi riots case, observed that it was "a sad situation" when failure to produce a valid certificate led to the exclusion of crucial electronic evidence.

Flagging that investigating officers are often "not conversant" with the mandatory requirements of Section 65B of Indian Evidence Act, additional sessions judge Parveen Kumar Singh directed that the Delhi Police commissioner be apprised of the lapses to "ensure electronic evidence was collected, authenticated and placed on record in accordance with the law" by investigators.

"More often than not, certificates under Section 65B of IE Act as furnished by the prosecution do not satisfy the statutory requirements," the judge observed, noting that similar shortcomings had surfaced in other riots cases. Section 65B governs the admissibility of electronic records, including CCTV footage, as evidence. It requires a certificate identifying the record, detailing the device used to produce it and certifying that the computer system was functioning properly.

"Investigating officers are... often unable to scrutinise the certificates furnished to them to ascertain whether these certificates meet the requirements... and they do not insist upon submission of a proper and legally complete certificate," Singh noted.

An FIR was registered on Feb 25, 2020, over vandalism and firing in Brahmpuri. The prosecution claimed that CCTV footage of the riots was shown to the injured and other witnesses, following which three people were identified as rioters. The judge held the CCTV footage was inadmissible because its accompanying certificate failed to meet statutory requirements.

Since the witness's identification of the accused was based on it, his testimony could not be treated as that of an eyewitness, entitling the accused to the "benefit of doubt".

Lengthy wait: 800 teacher candidates await school posting

Times News Network

New Delhi: Nearly three years after recruitment was announced for English teachers in Delhi govt schools, candidates say they are still waiting for school allotments.

They allege that delays first at Delhi Subordinate Services Selection Board and later at Directorate of Education (DoE) have prolonged the process, leaving them without a firm timeline for postings.

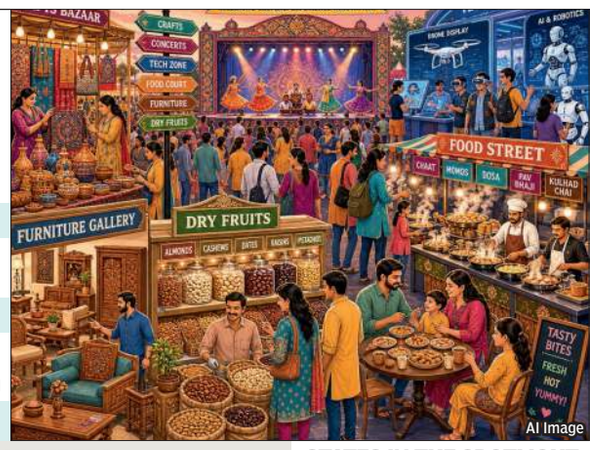
The board advertised the trained graduate teacher posts in Jan 2024 as part of a combined recruitment for DoE and New Delhi Municipal Council. The schedule listed the exam on Aug 24, 30 and 31, 2025. The board issued the result on July 28, 2026, and a corrigendum on Aug 5. Candidates said DoE conducted document verification in Sept 2026 and alleged that school allotments had since been pending.

Candidates said they had sought updates through Right to Information applications, emails, letters and visits to the department, but officials repeatedly told them verbally to expect progress the following week and that they were still waiting for a written schedule. With CBSE's board exams approaching, the candidates questioned why the department had yet to complete the postings.

They claimed that the prolonged wait had affected nearly 800 candidates, leaving them uncertain about their careers and causing distress to them and their families. The candidates described the delay as bureaucratic inaction and alleged that officials had failed to discharge their duties promptly. They urged DoE to complete the procedure.

TOI did not get any response from the education department.

Halls of fame: At trade fair, 'vikas' & 'virasat' in focus



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New Delhi: The trade fair is back, and a day at Bharat Mandapam could take you from regional craft stalls and spice counters to pavilions featuring exhibitors from Ghana, Thailand and Nepal. The 45th India International Trade Fair will be inaugurated Friday and run from Nov 14 to 27.

Organised by India Trade Promotion Organisation (ITPO), this year's edition is themed 'vikas aur virasat' (development and heritage). More than 3,500 exhibitors from India and abroad will occupy 17 halls spread over more than 1 lakh sqm. The first five days are reserved for business visitors. The fair opens to the general public on Nov 19 and will continue till Nov 27.

The fair will bring together 32 states and Union territories and 51 central ministries, govt departments, public sector undertakings and public sector banks. Bihar, Maharashtra, Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh are the partner states, while Assam, Delhi, Jharkhand and West Bengal are the focus states. Their displays will range from regional products and traditional crafts to tourism and development initiatives.

"IITF is a platform that celebrates the progress, diversity, and heritage of India, and this year's theme captures exactly that. Our effort is to make the fair a reflection of the policy changes and new developments in the country and in the states, where visitors can see the vibrancy and transformation taking place in India while also experiencing our unmatched cultural, culinary, and linguistic diversity," said Jawed Ashraf, chairman of ITPO.

Hall 1 will house the international pavilions, with exhibitors from 11 countries, including Ghana, Nepal, Thailand and UAE. The partner and focus states will be in Halls 2 to 5 alongside central ministries, PSUs and public sector banks. Shoppers can head to Halls 8 to 14 for textiles, spices, handicrafts, electronics, furniture and jewellery.

"This year, we have placed a particular focus on the youth. The Hall of Inspiration will showcase about 600 startups from deep tech to agri-tech, drones, space, healthcare, and edtech, and we hope it will inspire the youth of India. The ODOP pavilion will bring district-level craft, cuisine, and culture to a national platform," he added.

The startups will be in Hall 14, where young enterprises can meet potential buyers and explore new markets. At the One District One Product pavilion, 21 states will showcase the crafts, foods and other products their districts are known for. Families can try Playverse@Mandapam, an interactive digital experience, while more than 90 food outlets will serve Indian and international cuisines. ITPO said nearly 18 lakh people visited last year and more are expected this time.

The cultural programme will stretch across seven venues, with 87 performances, recitals and shows. The lineup includes Tal Fry, Hariharan & Prithvi Gandharva, Shahzad Ali and Ruhaniyat, which will feature performers from Nigeria. Tickets for selected shows will be available online. Performances by 19 states and organisations will be free with fair entry.

ITPO is also helping Indian startups take their products to international events such as VivaTech in Paris and Singapore FinTech Festival.

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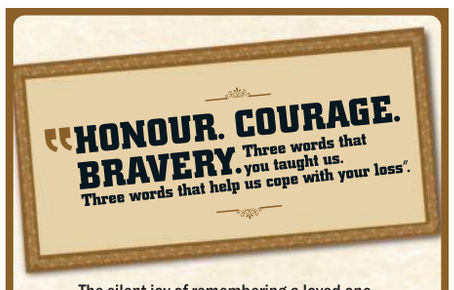
In Loving Memory of
Mr. L. V. Kumar
15th April 1932 to 11 November 2026
Saturday, 14 November 2026
11:00am - 1:00pm at Chinmaya Mission, Lodhi Estate, New Delhi
Brilliant and compassionate, he met life with resilience and determination. A visionary leader, he loved his family deeply and was a mentor to all.
Forever cherished by the family of Mr. L. V. Kumar
Children
Rohit Kumar
Shalini Kumar
Punita Kumar - Sinha
Jayant Sinha
And loving grandchildren, nieces, nephews and their families

REMEMBRANCE
SHARING MEMORIES

In Loving Memory of
VEENA GOEL
23.11.1948 - 13.11.2023
You filled our lives with warmth and love. Your presence is missed every single day, but your spirit lives on in all of us.
Remembered with deep love:
Lalit Mohan Goel
Amit Goel & Ritu Goel
Ankur Goel & Charu Goel
Kartik, Vrinda and Viren



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The moments you shared together.
Little moments that make life beautiful.
Share them. With Friends. Relatives. Neighbours. Colleagues. With all those whose lives the departed Soul has touched. Because while life goes on, when you share memories, they stay on forever.

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LG to open Yamuna Dialogues on Nov 20

Times News Network

New Delhi: With over 1,700 hectares of the Yamuna floodplain under active restoration, Delhi Development Authority (DDA) will convene experts, govt agencies, urban planners, and civil society on Nov 20 to draft a roadmap for the river's long-term rejuvenation.

LG TS Sandhu will inaugurate the one-day 'Yamuna Dialogues' at Baansera, Birsa Munda Chowk. Focusing on the 52-km stretch of the river, the roundtable will cover floodplain restoration, water quality, drainage, ecological conservation and public access.

"The discussions aim to shift from isolated restoration projects to an integrated, science-based river management approach. DDA will compile recommendations from six thematic sessions into a proposed 'Delhi Yamuna Report' identifying priority interventions, responsibilities, partnerships and implementation strategies," the authority stated.

The sessions will focus on governance mechanisms; floodplain planning and ecological measures; water quality and drainage; river-people connect and ghat development; sustainable models; and emerging technology, research and innovation.

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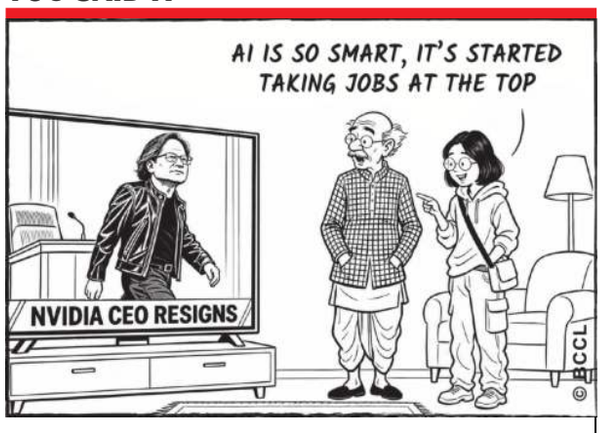
TMC NETA ABHISHEK DRAWS HIGH COURT FIRE FOR ALLEGING 'SOME' JUDGES OWE ALLEGIANCE TO BJP

WANGCHUK CLAIMS 'ARMED GUARDS SURROUNDING' HIS HOUSE AS LADAKH PROTESTS WINTER POLLS

YOU SAID IT



7ft python found at Taj washroom

A nearly seven-foot-long Indian rock python was rescued from a washroom used by CISF personnel near Taj Mahal's eastern gate, triggering an emergency rescue operation amid heavy festive tourist crowds. A jawan spotted the non-venomous reptile and alerted ASI officials, who called in Wildlife SOS. A two-member Rapid Response Unit cordoned off the area and kept visitors at a safe distance before extracting the snake from the Unesco World Heritage Site. Following a few hours of observation, the python was released into a suitable natural habitat.

— **Mohammad Dilshad**

6 years on, 'dead' woman resurfaces

A woman in Karnataka's Mandya presumed murdered six years ago has resurfaced alive, exposing serious lapses in the investigation that led to a man being charged with her 'murder' and jailed for two and a half years. The man, Rajesh, now 36, who secured bail in 2024, has alleged that police tortured him into confessing to a crime he did not commit.
Police officers registered a murder case and arrested Rajesh, relying primarily on the fact that Manju had made her last call borrowing the phone from Rajesh, a stranger, while at a bus stop shortly before she went missing.

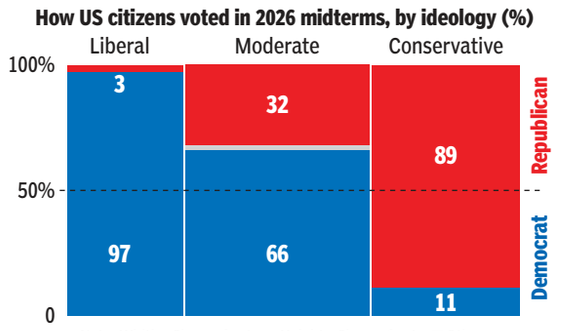
— **R Uday Kumar**

STATISTICS A slice of life in numbers

How fence-sitters in the US drove the Democrat landslide

Liberals and conservatives largely maintained their expected loyalties, but it was among the moderates that the Blue party found its winning edge

How US citizens voted in 2026 midterms, by ideology (%)



Note: Width= Share of voters; Height= Share of vote; Others
Source: Data scientist Karim Douïeb (based on preliminary exit poll data as of Nov 8)

20-yr-old objects to molestation, pushed off platform, loses arm

53-Yr-Old Nabbed From Mumbai Suburb, Faces Bid-To-Kill Case

Suhas Birahde

Vasai: A 20-year-old woman lost a part of her arm under a moving train after she was pushed onto the tracks from a platform at Naigaon railway station while fighting off her molester last week. The 53-year-old suspect was tracked down and arrested five days later.

A case of molestation and attempt to murder has been registered against the man, Jitendra Hirmukhe.

He is currently in judicial custody. The woman is undergoing treatment at a civic hospital in Mumbai.

According to a police complaint lodged by the woman, who got married five months ago, she went to Malad on Nov 4 to buy a phone.

She reached Malad station in the evening, but after seeing that trains were already packed, she travelled to Borivli station and took a slow Virar-bound local train.

The woman said this train, too, was crowded, though, and she mistakenly entered the compartment reserved for persons with disabilities.

"A man kept pushing me repeatedly. I initially ignored him. However, when the train reached Bhayander station, he started touching me inappropriately," she told police.

Around 7.15pm, the woman and Hirmukhe got down at Naigaon station, where she confronted him for molesting her. However, the man doubled down, allegedly touched her inappropriately again and defiantly asked her: "What difference does it make?"

Angered by his response, the woman took off a slipper and threw it at him.

Hirmukhe allegedly abused her, removed his own slipper and hit her with it.

CONFRONTED MAN

- The **woman** and **Jitendra Hirmukhe** got off at Naigaon where **she confronted him over being molested**
- Angered by his reply, **she threw a slipper at him; he abused her & hit her with his footwear before pushing her,** causing her to fall on the tracks
- The **train began moving,** and **crushed** part of her left arm

The train was still standing at the platform and many passengers gathered to intervene. Suddenly, Hirmukhe allegedly pushed the woman, causing her to fall on the tracks, into the gap between two coaches. As she tried to climb back onto the platform, the train started moving.

She fell into the platform gap. Her left arm came under the train's wheels and was cut off below the elbow.

Hirmukhe fled from the spot. The woman was initially taken to a Vasai hospital and later shifted to the Mumbai facility for further treatment.

Bhayander railway police examined CCTV footage from the station and traced the man to his residence in Wakipada, Naigaon East. He was arrested on Nov 9. Hirmukhe hails from Dharashiv district.

"He has stomach cancer and was travelling in the compartment reserved for persons with disabilities. We traced him with the help of CCTV footage and arrested him from Naigaon," said Ganpat Tumbada, senior inspector, Bhayander railway police.

Initially, police registered a case under sections 74 (molestation), 117(2) (voluntarily causing hurt) and 352 (intentional insult) of BNS. Section 109 (attempt to murder) was subsequently added.

The woman demanded the strictest punishment for Hirmukhe. "Despite having done nothing wrong, I had to go through this ordeal. I have permanently lost one of my arms... I want justice," she said in her statement.

Curtains drawn on merger after Ajit death, no fresh proposal: Sule

Anurag.Bende
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Pune: NCP-SP working president **Supriya Sule** Thursday ruled out any merger between the Sharad Pawar-led NCP and the rival party that was headed by the late Ajit Pawar, saying she had decided to "draw the curtains" on the issue following her cousin's death and had received no fresh merger proposal.

Sule's remarks come amid renewed efforts by netas of Ajit Pawar's NCP to revive merger talks and speculation about a possible rapprochement. On Wednesday, Ajit's wife, Sunetra, had declined to clarify possibility of a merger, saying matters would be clear at the appropriate time.

"Discussions on the merger were on when Ajit Pawar was alive, and the entire world knew about them. A video of one such meeting held on Jan 17 was also circulated," Sule said. She added she had decided the issue was closed "following the developments that unfolded a few days after his (Ajit Pawar's) death."

After Ajit's death in a plane crash on Jan 28, senior netas of his party had denied holding any meetings with the Sharad Pawar-led party. However, state NCP president Sunil Tatkare recently said he was aware of the talks and claimed that a merger would have taken place had Ajit Pawar been alive. Tatkare and state minister Hasan Mushrif Thursday said they would meet Sharad Pawar in Mumbai.

"He is our mentor. I do not think there's anything wrong with any member of our party meeting him for personal reasons," Tatkare said. Regarding Sena neta Sanjay Shirsat's suggestion a third NCP faction could emerge, Mushrif said attempts were being made to weaken the party.

2 ships attacked, 22 Indians on board safe: Govt

New Delhi: Two oil tankers with 22 Indian seafarers on board were involved in two attacks on Wednesday, but all the crew members were safe.

In an X post, shipping minister Sarbananda Sonowal said, "On Nov 11, Saudi Arabia-flagged oil tanker NCC FAJR, carrying three Indian seafarers, was involved in a possible attack while transiting the Strait of Hormuz. All three Indian nationals are safe."

Another Liberia-flagged tanker, carrying 19 Indian seafarers, was targeted in a projectile attack while drifting off Mina Saqr in the UAE. The entire 22-member crew was safely evacuated, he said. TNN

Karnataka to roll back BJP govt's tweaks to anti-conversion law

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Karnataka Congress chief B K Hariprasad Thursday said the state govt would restore the anti-conversion law to its pre-2022 form, signalling Congress's intent to fulfil its poll promise of rolling back the amendments made by the previous BJP govt. The state govt is yet to make any official announcement on the issue.

Hariprasad's assurance came in response to Dalit and minority groups accusing the Congress govt of reneging on its promise to withdraw the amended law. Congress was not founded on caste or religion, he said, adding that the party "represents entire India and we listen to all views".

"Unlike BJP, we do not peddle lies or engage in communalism. It is they who harbour religious hatred."

The Karnataka Protection of Right to Freedom of Religion Act has faced opposition from minority groups since its introduction. Bengaluru archbishop Peter Machado and several forums have sought its repeal. On Oct 30, the Archdiocese of Bangalore and Karnataka Rajya Muslim Okkoota convener Mohammad Yahya Damudi issued a statement demanding that the law be revoked.

However, VHP had urged CM **D K Shivakumar** not to withdraw the legislation.

On Thursday, Muslim and Christian community members staged a demonstration at Bengaluru's Freedom Park, demanding repeal of the anti-conversion and anti-cattle slaughter laws. They said the former infringed on religious freedom, while the latter affected their right to livelihood.

Led by Machado under the banner 'Voice of Minorities and the Oppressed Sections of Karnataka', the protesters submitted a memorandum to the CM's office, reminding govt of Congress's promise before the 2023 election to withdraw the two laws introduced by the previous BJP dispensation, protect minority rights and restore social justice measures. "Yet, several important commitments remain unfulfilled."

Ties under strain, India-B'desh consular dialogue postponed

Ahsan Tasnim

Dhaka: The fifth Bangladesh-India consular dialogue — scheduled to be held in Dhaka on Nov 17-18 — has been postponed, indicating that bilateral mechanisms between the two countries appear to have stalled, with little tangible progress on key areas of cooperation.

The dialogue was supposed to discuss former PM Sheikh Hasina's extradition, border management, streamlining visa processes, repatriating citizens detained in either country, securing the release and repatriation of fishermen, and fostering mutual legal cooperation.

On Nov 3, an inter-ministerial meeting was held at the ministry of foreign affairs in Dhaka as part of preparation for the consular dialogue between the two countries.

The Bangladesh-India consular dialogue mechanism was instituted in 2017 with a purpose to strengthen people-to-people contacts.

The fourth round of consular dialogue was held on 29 May, 2024, in New Delhi.

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CONTRAPUNTO

My hobby of not attending meetings about recycling saves more energy than your hobby of recycling

– JOHN MCCARTHY

After The Huangover

The man who made Nvidia had to leave. But the board should introspect. And what now of AI boom?

Jensen Huang has joined a growing list of rockstar CEOs who've met an Icarus-like fate this century. Helming a $5tn company – the highest valuation ever – until recently, he's had to bow out of Nvidia, not for incompetence or underperformance, but mistakes in his private life that may have helped China narrow the AI gap with US, despite curbs on chip sales and tech transfer. While his affair with Alice Huang – a suspected Chinese spy – had already made his position at Nvidia untenable, reports of another affair with a company V-P perhaps left him with no option but to resign.

Jensen Huang, after Travis Kalanick, Adam Neumann, Elizabeth Holmes and others, will go down as a memo on the limits of CEO hubris. It is also a reminder to managements that unbridled power usually has nasty consequences. That Nvidia's board could not prevent, or did not suspect, the misuse of Singapore-based data centres, allegedly under Alice's influence, is proof of its own inefficacy. Ignoring Jensen's relationship with Kimberly Powell – a breach of company policy – demonstrates its cravenness.

It's notable that Nvidia's interim chief Colette Kress and the board have slipped in laudatory words for Jensen in his moment of disgrace. This possibly shows that Jensen remains in charge, de facto, and the ongoing internal investigations might not be productive. But that's a matter for US authorities. What the wider world needs to worry about is the sharp decline in Nvidia's stock. This is a company whose GPUs became the default brains of AI, and while there's some competition now, their market share is overwhelming. It won't be wrong to say that, hardware-wise, Nvidia has been central to the AI boom.

Combine that with all the circular deals that Jensen struck with companies making AI models and data centres, to puff up valuations all around. For a long time it's been said that if an AI bust happens, it will start with some of the smaller players going under due to high interest rates. But if Nvidia itself isn't able to keep pumping the market anymore, last week's AI meltdown could feel like a party. We'll have to watch with fingers crossed.

Of Exports & Imports

Ban on battery scrap exports will spur recycling, but dispute over Scotch tariffs could send wrong signals

India's ban on export of lithium battery 'black mass' is a smart move. Black mass is a powdery material formed by pulverising innards of batteries past their service life. It contains precious elements – nickel, cobalt, lithium, etc – needed for making new batteries. It's a veritable mine. So far, it's been exported because India has meagre battery recycling capacity – some 60,000 tonnes annually. But now that Union cabinet has approved a $300mn incentive policy for increasing domestic processing of nickel and lithium, hoarding this resource makes sense.

We're in the middle of a major electrification drive. While installed solar capacity has multiplied, it needs storage batteries to be useful round the clock. Then there's the shift to EVs. Govt wants 30% of all vehicles sold 2030 onwards to be electric. That's going to push up battery demand, increasing dependence on China, primarily, besides suppliers like South Korea. Efforts are on to tap Russian lithium reserves, but black mass can take care of a big part of battery demand. By one estimate, up to 40% of battery materials for EVs in 2040 could come from domestic recyclers. Logic's simple: EV batteries last up to 10 years, so batteries sold in 2030 could be up for recycling in 2040.

What doesn't sound so smart is the row over Scotch tariffs. Reports say more than 80 containers of bulk Scotch – meant to be blended with IMFL – are stuck because customs is demanding 150% duty, while importers insist tariff should be 75%, as agreed under UK-India trade pact. Indian authorities labour the point that concessional tariff applies only to bottled, ready-to-drink Scotch. They might be right under one interpretation of the trade pact. Just as India's tax demands against Vodafone and Cairn were "right" under retrospective taxation law, but wrong everywhere else. They brought bad press and put off foreign investors for years. So, Indian authorities should honour trade pacts not just in letter but in spirit. When 80% of Scotch arrives in bulk packaging, it's reasonable to argue the trade pact – and celebratory headlines – weren't about the other 20%. Let's show our trade-friendly side. Other treaties are in the pipeline.

A Load of Croc

When algorithms go reptile chasing

Bikram Vohra

Leopards lurking in the neighbourhood. Panthers on the prowl. A cobra slithering past the house. Wolves at the door. All this does happen. Pretty much like the real alligator that sauntered into a North Carolina bagel shop, scaring the scales off customers, but thankfully no one was hurt. Looking for bread maybe. Much the same time in Mumbai's Ghatkopar, an AI image of a crocodile "roaming freely" went viral on WhatsApp, and sparked a major alert. Wildlife rescue teams were told to rush to the spot. Ropes, helmets, urgency, the full filmy entry. But they found…nothing. No crocodile. No footprint. No threat. Just a picture someone generated and a hundred groups that forwarded it with, "PLEASE SHARE FAST."

This is the pandemonium AI can create. It doesn't need to invent a monster. It just needs to invent a JPEG and let humans do the rest. The alligator was real and caused less drama than the fake crocodile. A real reptile shows up and people call the authorities. A fake reptile shows up, and people call everyone.

Confusion is incredible. Half the neighbourhood is still convinced the crocodile is real. Other half is convinced that govt is hiding it. Someone says, "I saw it near the drain." Someone else says, "My cousin's friend's neighbour clicked it." Nobody has the original image. Nobody knows who made it. But everybody is an expert. Worse, the rescue team now has to waste time on fiction while real problems wait. That's the actual danger. We can no longer tell which emergency deserves a response. Today it's a crocodile. Tomorrow it's a riot, a flood, a health scare, a missing person. Same forwarding finger. Same desperate "please share." Same Pavlovian response. Same chaos. No, it is not fun, it's mischief.

BNS Section 353 already covers misinformation causing public mischief. IT Act 66D gives three years for digital impersonation. We have laws. We have cyber patrolling that sounds like a constable strolling through Wi-Fi with a lathi. Hyderabad booked an 18-year-old for an AI leopard that sent rescue teams chasing a shadow. But let's be fair, AI only made the picture. We made it travel. Today the fake crocodile. Tomorrow, the uncle who saw a ghost. And somewhere, a real alligator is walking into a bagel shop, unpunished, unbothered, and frankly, the only one with clean claws. At least he physically showed up.

What They Don't Teach You At B-Schools

Two analysts argue a majority of management courses need a big reset to stay relevant. Without urgent upgrades in curriculum, teaching & research agenda, an MBA degree won't travel well

Tulsi Jayakumar

Years ago, a Harvard professor had remarked, with a touch of cynicism, "If you strip away the admissions process at the front end and campus placements at the tail end, business schools hardly need the middle, the actual teaching." I recall his words every year around this time, when India Inc. arrives on campus to recruit.

Headlines follow a set pattern, "1cr CTC" package leading all coverage. Brochures announce each school's rise on NIRF or QS charts. Together, they make up the marketing that sells MBA as a path to corporate success. In Indian higher education, MBA or PGDM from a top-tier B-school is seen as a surer route to social mobility and financial security than any other PG degree.

Numbers, however, hide a structural crisis in a majority of India's 5,000-plus B-schools. To climb rankings and raise placement averages, they're compromising two things higher education is meant to protect: what we teach in classrooms, and integrity of research we produce.

Start with teaching. Ranking frameworks heavily weight immediate employment rates, and average starting salaries. Schools have responded by behaving like expensive placement agencies. Teaching has been narrowed to what campus recruiters want. In practice, this means consulting, investment banking, and short-term financial modelling. 'Soft' courses that do not feed directly into summer internship, or final placement, struggle for space in the timetable, and students' attention.

This problem is not confined to India. Writing in *NYT*, Chris Marquis, professor at Cambridge Judge Business School, provocatively called for abolishing B-schools, arguing they help produce the flaws of modern corporate capitalism. He also criticised the Harvard-style case study, the main teaching tool for a century. A case puts the student in the position of one decision-maker, usually CEO or investor, with workers, regulators and local communities rarely entering the discussion.

These frameworks fit India even less well. During the pandemic, Byju's became India's most valuable startup. Many B-school classrooms taught it as a lesson in rapid scaling. Few discussions asked how subscriptions were sold, or whether its growth came from parental anxiety and easy credit. Once the company entered insolvency proceedings, the same classrooms turned it into a case study in failure. Hindsight made everyone wise.

Students trained to admire financial mechanics of such businesses, without questioning their broader socio-economic fallout, become good at optimising spreadsheets, but are blind to living realities of the country they will manage in.

Research has fared no better. To climb rankings like NIRF or gain global accreditation, management institutions must show high research output. However, ranking algorithms count publications and citations, paying little attention to originality, or usefulness to industry. A study earns credit for being indexed in a recognised journal, regardless whether it helps an Indian MSME or agricultural cooperative.

Generative AI has worsened this. Field research is slow and expensive. AI makes it easy to rework existing literature, generate synthetic datasets and produce formulaic statistical models. Faculty are rewarded for volume, promoted on it, so, many take the faster route. The system ends up rewarding the appearance of quality. By reducing academic excellence to algorithmically generated scores, B-schools have created a self-reinforcing cycle of superficiality. Teaching is engineered to clear placement interviews, research produced to satisfy ranking committees.

However, closing down B-schools or abandoning rankings is not realistic for a growing economy that needs managerial capacity. What is needed is change in what rankings measure as success. Curricula and research incentives can follow.

Rankings could track graduates five years after they leave campus, instead of only at graduation. A school whose alumni build lasting careers, start firms or return to strengthen family businesses, deserves credit. Media reports can't capture this.

Research assessment could similarly change. Indian rankings could borrow from UK's Research Excellence Framework and ask each faculty to put forward work for peer reading, including field studies of Indian firms, and teaching cases built on primary interview. Such work takes months of access and trust to produce. Our classrooms need more of it.

The case method can be repaired from within. A case on an edtech firm can carry an exhibit on refund complaints, and loan defaults, next to customer-acquisition metrics. Students can be asked to defend their recommendation to a parent who signed the loan contract, or to a consumer-protection regulator, as well as to the board.

The Harvard professor described B-schools that had stopped needing their middle. India's B-schools should be judged on that very middle – what their students learn and what their faculty discover.

The writer is Professor, Economics & Policy, at Bhavan's SPJIMR. Views are personal

Sandeep Das

When Nikhil Kamath questioned an MBA's value – "If you're 25 and going to an MBA college today, you must be some kind of an idiot" – he was echoing reservations expressed for years. GMAT Council, the non-profit that administers GMAT, has noted that prospective students increasingly focus on ROI of such programmes. In India, though, demand for MBA keeps rising – 2.95L registered for CAT in 2025, compared to 2.44L in 2019. However, even Tier 1 institutions are not immune to macroeconomic cycles, with some seeing softer placement seasons of late.

So, what's the future of an MBA in India? A degree from IIMs, ISB, and other top tier institutes is worth its weight in gold – median salary was ₹30L-₹35L (2025). One estimate puts IIM graduates' pay in India's top 1% – top 1% annual income in Karnataka is over ₹32L and top 1% in Maharashtra is estimated to be over ₹35L.

The power and strength of alumni networks is, of course, unparalleled. The 'pedigree effect' is strong while pursuing entrepreneurial dreams or raising VC capital. Blume Ventures reports that IIT/IIM graduates remain primary recipients of institutional VC – some estimates place them between 45% and 50% of all capital raised.

Outside Tier 1 colleges lie concerns about quality of education and MBA students' skill level. Per Unstop Talent Report 2025, nearly half of MBA graduates (from Tier 2 and 3 colleges) left college without a job or internship. A 2016 Assocham study found that only 7% of MBA graduates are employable. Most Indian B-schools produce sub-par graduates. For students, paying fees of ₹10L-₹15L in a Tier 2/3 college, and then not landing a job, or getting one with median income of ₹5L-₹10L after 2 years is a difficult pill to swallow.

Bigger question is, what happens to this model once AI starts taking away entry-level jobs. Per Burning Glass Institute, AI-driven automation now threatens over 50% of such jobs sectorwide. McKinsey says AI could automate up to 30% of work hours in US by 2030.

This is of particular concern. Many Tier 2 and 3 MBA roles are concentrated in functions like sales, operations, and basic analytics – areas increasingly exposed to automation. This is where the existing MBA model will be tested, as placement numbers determine future enrolment.

Are alternative B-schools the way forward? Last few years have seen B-schools emerge that focus on practitioner-led education. This is built on the premise that traditional education is outdated. So, industry leaders guide students on real-world problems. These B-schools are appropriately located in corporate hubs, such as Bengaluru and Gurgaon.

It'll be a decade before such institutions prove their value. One concern is their faculty is part-time and hence doesn't produce adequate peer-reviewed quality research. Without core management research, there is a risk that alternative education may be reduced to a YouTube video along the lines of '10 hacks to do this'. Media reports have questioned veracity of placement numbers and value added to students.

Across schools, MBA curriculum is stuck. WEF's Future of Jobs Report says leadership and social influence, resilience, communication and analytical thinking will be key future skills. Yet, very few B-schools have dedicated subjects on such softer skills. Ironically, while the corporate world increasingly rewards communication, influence and narrative-building, MBA programmes continue to over-index on technical frameworks.

The curriculum needs a massive upgrade, not stay stuck in 1980s-1990s. If you're a 25-year-old reading this column, go for an MBA if you get admission in the top tier – it remains a most reliable pathway to strong career outcomes in India. But if you don't, the situation becomes tricky. In that case, Nikhil Kamath's words may be (partially) correct.

The writer is visiting faculty at IIMs Bangalore & Lucknow

Divorced Overseas, But Still Married In India?

It's strange that a split formalised in a foreign country is invalid in India. This must change

Jwalika Balaji

In much of the world, a marriage can end, if it has simply broken down. But in India, divorce law remains stuck in 1950s, requiring a spouse to prove 'fault' on the other's part. A divergent approach in foreign courts can lead to legal limbo for Indian spouses.

This is what happened in *N Sridhar Reddy vs Andhra Pradesh*, when Supreme Court refused to recognise a divorce granted by an English court on the ground of irretrievable breakdown of marriage. The husband and his first wife married in Andhra in 2003, under Hindu Marriage Act, 1955 ('HMA') and moved to UK.

The wife returned to India in 2007, post which the parties lived separately. The husband filed for divorce in Andhra courts, which dismissed his petition. Six years on, he became a British citizen, and obtained a divorce from Cambridge County Court, over the wife's objection to its jurisdiction. The husband remarried. The first wife filed a case of bigamy in India, which SC refused to quash.

Under Sec 13 of Code of Civil Procedure, 1908, an order obtained abroad stands, unless it fails to satisfy certain conditions. In a 1991 divorce case, SC held a foreign divorce will be recognised if the decision was based on a ground available in the law under which the parties had married. In the Reddy case, since 'irretrievable breakdown' isn't a ground under HMA, Cambridge County Court's decree failed this test.

Indian courts often use Sec 13 to protect women disproportionately affected by foreign matrimonial decrees. *Ex parte* (unilateral) divorces have not been recognised, when women could not participate. This matters most in cases of transnational marital abandonment, where an NRI husband marries a woman in India, deserts her, obtains a divorce abroad, in a forum she cannot access, or does not know about. NCW reports two in 10 transnational marriages end in abandonment. In such cases, wives can prosecute their husbands in India, using Sec 13.

Image: AI

However, Sec 13 only determines whether a foreign judgment is conclusive in India; it does not *invalidate* the decree in the country that granted it. The result is a "limping marriage": dissolved in one country, subsisting in another.

In UK, the husband is lawfully divorced, free to remarry. In India, his first marriage remains valid, and allows prosecution for bigamy. It's an incongruous situation. The husband may move on with his life abroad, but the wife is stuck in the marriage in India.

Irretrievable breakdown is not statutory ground for divorce in India. Yet SC itself has approved the concept. In *Shilpa Sailesh vs Varun Sreenivasan* (2023), a Constitution bench held SC can grant a divorce on this ground, under Article 142 (power to do 'complete justice'). Earlier this year, in *Kishorekumar Kale vs Kashmira Kale*, SC refused to recognise a divorce obtained by the wife in US, based on irretrievable breakdown. However, as the parties were separated for 18 years, SC granted a divorce, recognising the core issue: the marriage had broken down; the parties did not wish to live together.

In *Sridhar Reddy*, parties have lived apart since 2007 with no matrimonial relations. Yet, per Indian law, the "sanctity of matrimonial status" continues to subsist almost two decades later. It's difficult to argue such a divorce is contrary to Indian law, when SC itself grants it on that basis. But this ground is available only at SC's discretion. It cannot be invoked as a matter of right, before family courts, where cases are first tried.

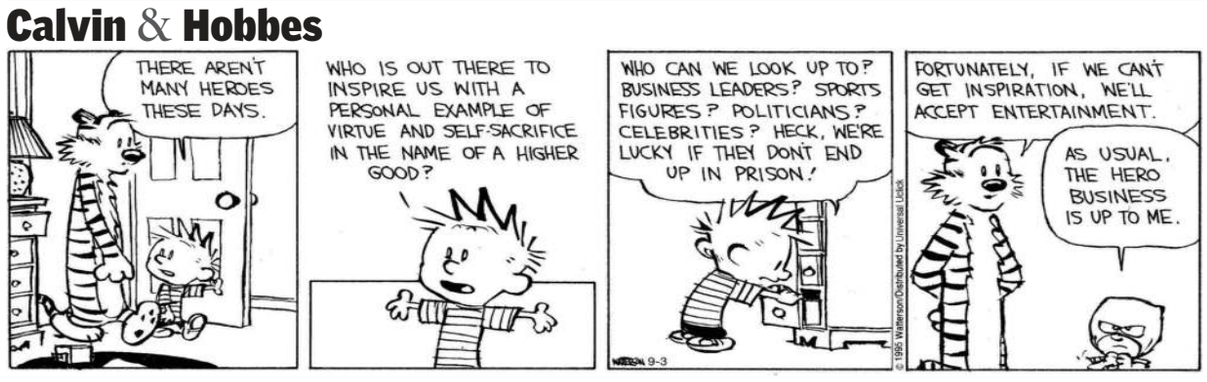
Legislature must catch up. Law Commission recommended irretrievable breakdown as a divorce ground in 1978. In 2009, it noted that forcing a marriage to continue might harm personal and public interest.

The first step could be to introduce it as a statutory ground under HMA and Special Marriage Act, 1954.

This would allow a marriage to legally end, not because one party proved adultery or cruelty (fault), but because it was simply not working and the spouse/s wished to exit. Marriage should be understood as consensual companionship between two people. It should not be a tool to tie unhappy people together merely because the law binds them so.

The writer is a Senior Resident Fellow at Vidhi Centre for Legal Policy. Views are personal

Calvin & Hobbes



Sacredspace

We live our comfortable lives in the shadow of a disaster of our own making. That disaster is being brought about by the very things that allow us to live our comfortable lives.

David Attenborough, A Life on Our Planet

Climate And Future: A Shared Responsibility

Andrew Rodrigues

El Niño and other climate phenomena are scientific processes studied through ocean temperatures, atmospheric circulation and weather patterns. Reliable forecasts must guide our understanding of their effects on rainfall, extreme heat, agriculture, and water availability. These challenges also have economic consequences, influencing energy prices, food production, household expenses and overall economic stability.

Global energy markets respond not only to supply and demand but also to expectations, geopolitical conflicts, consumer behaviour and govt policies. The economic research of 2026 Nobel laureates Robert E Hall and Michael Woodford provides a framework for understanding how energy shocks affect the wider community, individual decisions, policy choices and economic fluctuations. Their research on how households and firms make decisions, and how policy can steady the economy, offers a framework that has been applied to shocks such as energy crises.

THE SPEAKING TREE

Rising energy prices increase transportation, manufacturing, agricultural and electricity costs, placing additional pressure on households and businesses. Govts and central banks must therefore balance inflation control, economic growth, energy security and support for vulnerable communities.

Credible policies, diversified energy supplies and investment in reliable infra can help reduce the disruptive effects of energy shocks.

For people of faith, these challenges may also inspire reflection on humanity's responsibility towards creation and future generations. Religious traditions teach accountability, moral conduct, and compassion. In Bible, 2 Peter 3:7 and 3:10 describe divine judgement through imagery of fire, while Revelation 21:1 speaks of a new heaven and a new earth. These passages have different interpretations across Christian traditions and should not be treated as predictions of climate change or El Niño.

The biblical account in Genesis 41 offers a practical lesson in preparedness. Joseph interpreted Pharaoh's dreams as foretelling seven years of abundance followed by seven years of famine. His advice to store grain during prosperous years helped Egypt prepare for scarcity. Similarly, the story of Noah in Genesis 6-9 highlights the importance of heeding warnings. People of all faiths can work together to conserve water, protect nature, prepare for emergencies, and support vulnerable communities.

Cycle parts to satellites, five decades of betting big

Ludhiana lad Sunil Bharti Mittal has come a long way in half a century of entrepreneurship. Mittal, 69, spoke to **TOI** about his journey, the next frontier and succession as Airtel eyes the status of the world's first firm with a billion customers

Sidhartha & Saurabh Sinha | TNN

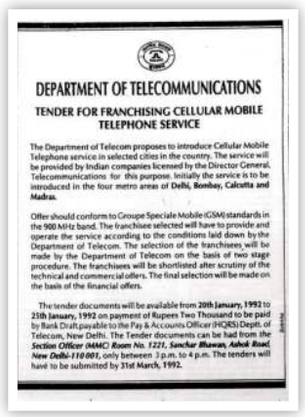
From cycle parts at 19, when did you decide to spread your wings?

■ It was one step at a time as per the next best aspiration. In the first 4-5 years, there was a lot of effort, little result and frustration with results proving elusive despite putting in long hours. My trading activity got me some capital when I started importing stuff, including generators and phones. I knew that we had to move out of Ludhiana, which I did in 1979.

My telecom journey started in 1982 when I imported telephones from Taiwan. I wanted to create a company that would one day become an institution. And all the money we earned went in that direction.

How did you decide to become a telecom service provider?

■ I was in Goa in 1992 for the New Year and on Jan 2, I got the Jan 1 edition of Economic Times which had a tender for starting mobile phone services. I told my wife, we have to enter this space and if we make it, it will catapult us into a different league.



DEPARTMENT OF TELECOMMUNICATIONS

TENDER FOR FRANCHISING CELLULAR MOBILE TELEPHONE SERVICE

The Department of Telecom proposes to introduce Cellular Mobile Telephone service in selected cities in the country. The service will be provided by Indian companies licensed by the Director General, Telecommunications for this purpose. Initially the service is to be introduced in the four metro areas of **Delhi, Bombay, Calcutta and Madras.**

Offer should conform to Groupe Speciale Mobile (GSM) standards in the 900 MHz band. The franchisee selected will have to provide and operate the service according to the conditions laid down by the Department of Telecom. The selection of the franchisees will be made by the Department of Telecom on the basis of two stage procedure. The franchisees will be shortlisted after scrutiny of the technical and commercial offers. The final selection will be made on the basis of the financial offers.

The tender documents will be available from **20th January, 1992** to **25th January, 1992** on payment of Rupees Two Thousand to be paid by Bank Draft payable to the Pay & Accounts Officer (HQRS) Deptt. of Telecom, New Delhi. The Tender documents can be had from the ***Section Officer (MMC) Room No. 1221, Sanchar Bhawan, Ashok Road, New Delhi-110 001***, only between 3 p.m. to 4 p.m. The tenders will have to be submitted by **31st March, 1992.**

We have structured our system very differently. It's a family in business not a family business

People told me mobile telecom was for players with deep pockets. I didn't know what deep pockets meant at that time. Had I known, perhaps I might not have entered it

We used to make Beetel phones, answering machines and cordless phones then and the annual turnover was Rs 25 crore and profit Rs 5 crore. It was not in our league. People told me mobile telecom was for players with deep pockets. I didn't know what deep pockets meant at that time. Had I known, perhaps I might not have entered it. We formed a consortium and got Bombay, which was later downgraded to Delhi, which was in any case my first choice.

Is financial services the next big bet? How will you navigate a crowded space?

■ It is the next new big bet for us and we are very excited about it. Since we have a good idea of our customers, lending to them becomes better and easier. We will make a big play out of this. Second, our borrowing cost is much superior to second rung companies and we can lend at lower rates. If we can control our loss ratios better than the market, then it can become a superior business. These are early days. But give us a year's time, then we'll be able to talk more about it.

Most Indian telecom customers are pre-paid. How do you know their credit profile?

■ We know whether our customers are current with their payments and their transactions. You can say this cohort of customers is good and can lend to them. You can figure out from their spending pattern, UPI usage. This we also share with other companies, based on our customer attributes. We get a commission of 3-4% from them. They rely on us very heavily because they know delinquency will be less on our cohorts. If the market is doing 5-6% of losses, you'll probably do about 2.5-3% on our cohorts.

We have Airtel Payments Bank, which comes close to Rs 4,000 crores of revenue and about Rs 4,000 crores of deposit. We have an ambition to take it bigger with DBT, remittance and cash management services. We will not do all the lending on our own. There will be sourcing from the market and by us. That is how we will do book building.

Are telecom rules more transparent now?

■ Most legal issues are legacy ones like AGR, interconnect issues. You have to compliment govt for the reset it did through the reforms package. There were 40 approvals earlier which have now been reduced. Govt litigation is very limited. Policy is much more predictable. Spectrum auctions are regular, and no artificial scarcity is being created because govt has understood that telecom is the backbone of Digital India.

There are concerns that telecom is turning into a duopoly, affecting pricing.

■ Eight or nine years ago, I had said that our average revenue per user (ARPU) target is Rs 300, which we have not reached so far. Factoring in inflation, that number would be closer to Rs 500 now. (In July-Sept 2026 quarter Airtel had an ARPU of Rs 271). Affordability is something India should cherish. Even if this gets to Rs 350 with low-end customers paying Rs 200 and high-end ones paying Rs 400-500, tariffs in India are the lowest in the world. Telecom is very different from airlines, there is so much capacity.

How has consumption of voice calls and data changed?

■ Call time has been static at 1,150 minutes per month for many years. Data consumption is rising as people are watching more videos. It used to be 5 GB per month and now it is 35-36 GB, which is the highest in the world.

Why aren't Indians creating their own social media platforms?

■ That is the network effect. My son started Hike messenger in 2012 and became a unicorn very quickly. But in the end, people switched over to WhatsApp, Facebook Messenger. Once you have 70-80 crore people on WhatsApp, the network effect kicks in.

What will satellite communications mean for India?

■ In the US, the fight between telcos and Starlink has become quite visible now. The ARPU there is $50-60. With that figure, one can do home broadband and Starlink can compete with telcos. In India (with its ARPU) this will be complementary service for places that have no coverage.

Can India build tech sovereignty in areas like satellites?

■ As one of the only two low earth orbit operators today through OneWeb, we would like to play a bigger role ahead in India. Airtel doesn't intend to build its own constellation. But it will tie up with the global constellations to provide local services like we've done with Starlink, OneWeb and make it as local as possible.

We have ground control stations, monitoring, and legal interception all in India to give Indian govt comfort that the service is in a controlled environment.

Devices we use now may start to disappear in 10 years. Your glasses, rings will be doing all the work. Everything will be through a sensing network

Are you looking to increase your BT stake beyond 25%?

■ We are happy to be the single largest shareholder in BT. BT is a real gem. It just needs to get its act together, attain a better velocity of business. At this time, we are okay with 25% stake. We will see how things pan out because it's a large investment.

Africa took longer to work out than you had anticipated...

■ Africa took real strength out of us to stabilise the business. The first 4-5 years were very tough. The last 4-5 years have been very good. It has been a 16-year journey. It's now a FTSE 50 company, generating close to $8 billion revenue.

What is the succession plan?

■ If you look at Airtel, which is the largest pie, our succession is done. With Gopal Vittal and Shashwat (Sharma), we have professionals in top management positions, the company is highly empowered. There's a good set of people on the board and I am the only person from the family involved at this time. Who replaces me as the next shareholder steward? Someone will emerge. The family will play the key stewardship role because when a crisis comes in a company, like we have seen, you need an anchor at that time. That time professionals can't take the bets that an entrepreneur can take.

I have two sons and one daughter, they are all grown up. They have broad shoulders and handle a lot of responsibility. There are other family members. There will be a good set of shareholders. We have structured our system very differently. It's a family in business not a family business.

How will we communicate in the next decade?

■ Devices we use now may start to disappear in 10 years. Your glasses, rings will be doing all the work. Everything will be through a sensing network. While talking to you, I will know all about you. That is coming. It's not too far. I will tell my wearable to dial so and so, it will dial. I will dictate an email or message while driving and the same will happen. This change has started and in the next five years devices will just be an additional tool.

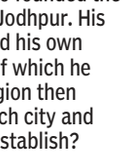
INQUIZITIVE

JOY BHATTACHARJYA

1 If the FBI is the US domestic intelligence agency and MI5 its UK equivalent, in which country does the Shin Bet operate?

2 The phrase "back to square one" is believed to have originated from which board game originating in India, where it was known as Moksha Patam?

3 In the history of Formula 1 racing, only two drivers have won seven individual titles. One of them is **Michael Schumacher.** Which British driver is the other?



4 The Blue and White Nile finally meet at which African capital city?

5 Which company — founded in 1993 and currently in the news — toyed with Huaprimal, Prihuamal and Malluapri as name options, incorporating all the three founders' names, before finally deciding on the name by which it is currently known?

6 Which edible item would you find in varieties named Malabar, Ceylon, Bun and Bidari?

7 On Oct 21, 1943, from which Asian city did Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose make the first proclamation of an Azad Hind govt?

8 Which international music director has collaborated with **A R Rahman** for the score of the 2026 film 'Ramayana'?

9 Rao Jodha was a great leader of the Rathore clan, who founded the city and kingdom of Jodhpur. His eldest son decided to found his own kingdom, the capital city of which he established in 1488 in a region then known as Jangladesh. Which city and former royal state did he establish?

10 Which legendary Greek city-state, known for its military prowess, was located in an area known as Laconia?

ANSWERS

1 | Israel
2 | Snakes & Ladders
3 | Lewis Hamilton
4 | Khartoum, the capital of Sudan
5 | Nvidia (founded by Jensen Huang, Chris Malachowsky and Curtis Priem)
6 | Parotta, the South Indian version of paratha
7 | Singapore
8 | Hans Zimmer
9 | Bikaner
10 | Sparta

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — CORRIGENDUM

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	OLD REFERENCE /NIT NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HPGCL	NIT NO.670/RGTPP/ MM/I/TOE-13506 DATED 23.10.2026 TENDER ID 2026_HBC_556269_1	CORRIGENDUM-1ST DUE DATE OF BID SUBMISSION 16.11.2026 UP TO 15:00HRS/OPENING DATE 17.11.2026 UP TO 15:30HRS. SUPPLY OF SULPHURIC ACID FOR ALL THREE POWER GENERATING STATION FOR RGTPP PTPS AND DCRTPP	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9315164637 mm1.rgtpp@hpgcl.org.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in RO No. 50949

32001/1319/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER & BASIN MANAGER
BAITARANI BASIN, KENDUJHAR
E-mail: cebmbaitaranibasin16@gmail.com

e-PROCUREMENT NOTICE No. CEBBK-10/2026-27

The Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, Baitarani Basin, Kendujhar, on behalf of the Hon'ble Governor of Odisha, invites online Percentage Rate bids in double cover system through e-Procurement from eligible contractors registered with the State Government and contractors of equivalent Grade/Class registered with Central Government/MES/Railways or other licensing authority.

1.	**Type of Work**	Civil Work
2.	**Total No. of Works**	02 (Two)
3.	**Amount put to Tender (Excluding GST)**	1. Rs. 8,47,45,645/- 2. Rs. 8,47,45,603/-
4.	**Period of Completion**	12 (Twelve) Calendar Months
5.	**Class of Contractor**	'A' & 'Special' Class

PROCUREMENT DETAILS

SL. No.	Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Name of Work	Bid Amount	Availability & Submission of Bid On-line	Date & Place of Opening of Technical Bids
01	Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, Baitarani Basin, Kendujhar.	CEBBK-KID-16/2026-27	Improvement to Kathapal Minor, Keshadurapal Minor, Santara Minor, Basantapura Minor and Toraniapal Minor under Remal Irrigation Project.	Rs. 8,47,45,645/- EMD: Rs. 8,47,500/- Bid Doc.: Rs. 10,000/-	From 11:00 Hrs. of 13.11.2026 to 03.12.2026, 17:00 Hrs.	04.12.2026 at 11:30 Hrs. at the office of the Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, Baitarani Basin, Kendujhar.
02		CEBBK-KID-17/2026-27	Improvement to Rekutia Minor, Tulasipur Sub-Minor, Dhaliaposi Sub-Minor under Remal Irrigation Project.	Rs. 8,47,45,603/- EMD: Rs. 8,47,500/- Bid Doc: Rs. 10,000/-		

Bidders shall participate online bidding only. Further details can be seen from the Govt. of Odisha e-Procurement Website **www.tendersorissa.gov.in.** Any addendum/ corrigendum/ cancellation of the tender can be seen in the above website only.

Sd/-
Chief Engineer & Basin Manager
Baitarani Basin, Kendujhar
OIPR-32001/32495/1/26-27/0012

32001/1315/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
UPPER INDRAVATI PROJECT
AT/PO: MUKHIGUDA DIST:KALAHANDI, ODISHA, PIN: 766026
e-mail address: cceuip1987@gmail.com/louiipbbsr@gmail.com

TENDER CANCELLATION NOTICE

The Tender invited for the works (1) Improvement of service road with black topping of chhenagaon distributary from RD 00 m to 2500 m and RD 5000 m to 7500 m and Gurjimunda minor from RD 00m to 3400 m under Right Canal Division- II, Junagarh and (2) Improvement of service road with black topping of Kusumkhunti branch canal from RD 8.1 km to 8.38 km and 20 km to 20.16 km, Karlapada minor from RD 00 m to 2350 m, Pastipada minor from RD 00 m to 2600 m, Chahagaon minor from RD 00 m to 1600 m and Ghugurpala minor from RD 00 m to 1400 m under Right Canal Division- II, Junagarh. **vide e-Procurement Notice No: CCE, UIP - 17(02)/2026-27, DATE: 28.10.2026** of O/o the Chief Construction Engineer, Upper Indravati Project, Mukhiguda are hereby Cancelled.

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Upper Indravati Project
Mukhiuguda
OIPR-32001/32352/1/26-27/0021

National Dairy Development Board
PB No. 40, Anand, Gujarat-388001, Tel: 02692-260 148/149/160 Fax: 02692-260 159
Website: www.nddb.coop, Email: purchase@nddb.coop
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB) / LOCAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING (LCB)

Bids are invited on behalf of Service Recipients/ NDDB from eligible bidders for the works listed below:

Sl. No.	Description of works / Bid Reference	Estd. Cost (₹) incl GST/Duration	Event Start / Close Date	Bid submission / opening date & time
A	**Civil, Structural, Water Supply, Sanitary & Other Misc. works including Internal Electrification works for:**			
I	75 MTPD Dung based CBG Plant at Himmatnagar (Sabar Dairy), Sabarkantha, District, Gujarat. **NDDB/HO/Purchase/82/26-27/ET/82[Civil-Sabar]**	1530 Lakh / 10 Months	13.11.26 04.12.26	04.12.26 15:00 hrs. 04.12.26 15:30 hrs.
B	**Design, Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of the following:**			
I	75 MTPD Dung based CBG Plant including PROM plant at Himmatnagar (Sabar Dairy), Sabarkantha, District, Gujarat. **NDDB/HO/Purchase/83/26-27/ET/83[CBG-Sabar]**	2229 Lakh / 10 Months	13.11.26 04.12.26	04.12.26 15:00 hrs. 04.12.26 15:30 hrs.

For further details pertaining to IFB and for downloading the bid document, please visit these websites: **www.nddb.coop**,and **www.mstcecommerce.com/eprocn** for any clarification please contact **Group Head (Purchase), NDDB, Anand**-388001
NB: Any corrigendum/modification etc. will be posted only on these websites.

झारखण्ड सरकार राष्ट्रीय स्वास्थ्य मिशन
स्वास्थ्य चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग, झारखण्ड
फोन नं०– 0651–2261000,2261856–2261002
मेल आई०डी०–mdnhm-jh@jharkhandmail.gov.in

आवश्यक सूचना
(PR No. 391004)

विशेषज्ञ चिकित्सा पदाधिकारियों की निविदा आधारित नियुक्ति हेतु राष्ट्रीय स्वास्थ्य मिशन, झारखण्ड द्वारा प्रकाशित विज्ञापन संख्या – NHM/03/2026(SMO BID)-2750(MD) दिनांक 30.09.2026 के विरूद्ध आवेदन समर्पित करने की अंतिम तिथि 15.11.2026 थी। उक्त तिथि को संशोधित करते हुए उपरोक्त विज्ञापन के विरूद्ध आवेदन समर्पित करने की अंतिम तिथि दिनांक 30.11.2026 तक विस्तारित की जाती है।

विज्ञापन की शेष शर्त्ते यथावत् रहेंगी।

PR 393706Health Med Edu and Family Welfare(26-27) D"

प्रशासी पदाधिकारी
राष्ट्रीय स्वास्थ्य मिशन,
झारखण्ड

Empanelment of Special Public Prosecutor for Narcotics Control Bureau before various High Courts

Applications are hereby invited from Advocates for empanelment as Special Public Prosecutor (SPP) in Narcotics Control Bureau for handling NDPS Cases before Hon'ble High Courts of Gujarat at Ahmedabad, Karnataka at Bengaluru, Madhya Pradesh at Jabalpur, Orissa at Cuttack, Punjab & Haryana at Chandigarh, Madras at Chennai, Delhi at New Delhi, Allahabad at Prayagraj, Gauhati at Guwahati, Manipur at Imphal, Jammu, Kashmir & Ladakh at Jammu, Kerala at Ernakulam, Calcutta at Kolkata, Bombay at Mumbai, Patna at Patna, Jharkhand at Ranchi, Himachal Pradesh at Shimla, Goa bench of Bombay High Court, Lucknow bench of Allahabad High Court, Jaipur & Jodhpur benches of Rajasthan High Court and Jalpaiguri bench of Calcutta High Court.

The eligibility criteria and other details are available in the Terms & Conditions posted on the website of Narcotics Control Bureau, https://ncb.mha.gov.in/vacancies (direct link to document : https://tinyurl.com/mr3fw4s8).

The interested advocates may apply in the requisite proforma to the AD (Legal) of NCB over email dlahq-ncb@nic.in clearly mentioning 'the court/courts applied for' in their application latest by 21.12.2026.

Dy. Director General (Special Wing)

CBC 19126/11/0108/2627

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT/EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	FACILITIES FOR DIFFERENTLY ABLED PERSONS IN THE JUDICIAL COURT COMPLEX, JIND IN DISTRICT JIND (PROVIDING 15 PASSENGER LIFT ONLY) + 3 WORKS	11.11.2026 18.11.2026	27.90 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9034929655 pwdeeedrohtak1@gmail.com
2	PWD B&R, SIRSA	DNIT FOR SPECIAL REPAIR OF ROAD FROM JIWAN NAGAR TO SAINPAL VIA KARIWALA KM 0.00 TO 18.90 (ROAD ID:5899) IN SIRSA DISTT. IN RANIA CONSTITUENCY UNDER HEAD-3054 (GROUP-4) (WITHOUT GST) + 1 WORKS	11.11.2026 23.11.2026	821.61 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666222959 pwd-eepd2-sirsa@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, SIRSA	DNIT FOR CONSTRUCTION OF TEHSIL BUILDING AT NATHUSARI CHOPTA IN SIRSA DISTT.(WITHOUT GST)	11.11.2026 26.11.2026	738.29 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666222959 pwd-eepd2-sirsa@hry.nic.in
4	PANCHAYATI RAJ, KURUKSHETRA	LAYING OF RCC PIPELINE FROM DISPENSARY TO POND UNDER DISTT. VILLAGE - DHANAGLI, BLOCK - SHAHABAD(M) DISTT. PLAN SCHEME. + 2 WORKS	11.11.2026 18.11.2026	34.16 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896224357 prexeeng.krk@hry.nic.in
5	PANCHAYATI RAJ, FARIDABAD	CONSTRUCTION OF RAIN WATER HARVESTING SYSTEM IN SC CHAUPAL AT VILLAGE SIDHOLA BLOCK FARIDABAD DISTRICT FARIDABAD VANGY + 9 WORKS	10.11.2026 18.11.2026	106.30 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467905067 prexeeng.fbd1@gmail.com
6	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, HISAR	FOR HIRING OF HYDRA MACHINE AND JCB , TRACTOR TROLLY, AT VARIOUS LOCATION UNDER JURISDICTION OF PHESD NO.2 HISAR + 3 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 18.11.2026	37.78 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662-247033 eephisar@gmail.com
7	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, ROHTAK	SUPPLY, ERECTION AND COMMISSIONING OF 03 NO. DG SETS OF DIFFERENT CAPACITY AS PER SITE CONDITION AT PERMANENT PUMP HOUSES AT RD 5750 OF PILANA MINOR, RD 169500 OF KAHANAUR DISTY., RD 8000 (SANGHI-I PUMP HOUSE) OF SANGHI MINOR AND RD 10000 OF JINDRAN PUMP HOUSE.	CLOSING DATE 18.11.2026	35.79 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9812111077 xenwsdnrtk@gmail.com
8	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, ROHTAK	REPAIRING DAMAGED LINING PATCH AT VARIOUS RDS OF ASANDA MINOR YEAR 2026 - 2027.	CLOSING DATE 17.11.2026	1.43 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9464040970 xensampla@gmail.com
9	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, FATEHABAD	CLEARANCE OF BUSHES AND VEGETATION OF KHERI DISTY FROM RD 69000157500 + 2 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 16.11.2026	16.04 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466751554 xenwsdivisionfbd@yahoo.com
10	HARYANA ROADWAYS, JHAJJAR	E- TENDER FOR HIRING OF ACTIVITY I.E 1 CLEANING OF BUSES WITH BROOM. 2 WASHING OF BUSES HARYANA ROADWAYS, JHAJJAR.	20.11.2026 08.12.2026	50,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9812676073 gmhrjjr@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in RO No.50969

कार्यालय जिलाधिकारी उत्तरकाशी

सार्वजनिक सूचना

(राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग संख्याः 34 के कि0मी0 08.00 से कि0मी0 29.300 के निर्माण हेतु अर्जित की गई भूमि से प्रभावित भूमिधरों को अधिनिर्णित धनराशि प्राप्त करने और कब्जा सौंपने के सम्बन्ध में)

सभी भूमिधर एवं हितबद्ध व्यक्तियों का ध्यान दिनांक 12 अप्रैल 2026 (ग्राम गंगोत्री, धराली, झाला तहसील भटवाड़ी, जिला उत्तरकाशी) को निम्न समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित सूचना की ओर आकर्षित किया जाता है, जिसके माध्यम से आपको निम्न बिन्दुओं के बारे में अवगत कराया गया थाः–

01. अधिनिर्णय की घोषणा दिनांक 31 दिसम्बर, 2024।
02. प्रतिकर को 60 दिन की अवधि में प्राप्त करने की सूचना ।
03. अधोहस्ताक्षरी को अधिनिर्णित भूमि का कब्जा सौंपने की सूचना।

क्रम सं.	समाचार पत्र का नाम	प्रकाशन की तिथि
1	2	3
1.	अमर उजाला	12 अप्रैल, 2026
2.	टाईम्स ऑफ इंडिया	12 अप्रैल, 2026

विहित 60 दिवस की अवधि का अवसान दिनांक 10 जून, 2026 को हो चुका है। अतः राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग अधिनियम की धारा 3E की उपधारा 2 के अधीन अधिग्रहित भूमि का कब्जा तहसीलदार/उप जिलाधिकारी, भटवाड़ी को स्वतः ही सौंप दें, अन्यथा की स्थिति में पुलिस बल के माध्यम से कब्जा प्राप्त कर लिया जायेगा।

परियोजना प्रभावित सभी भूमिधर एवं हितबद्ध व्यक्ति जिन्होंने अभी तक प्रतिकर की धनराशि प्राप्त नहीं की है, वह अधिनिर्णित धनराशि किसी भी कार्य दिवस को कार्यालय समय में उप जिलाधिकारी कार्यालय भटवाड़ी कार्यालय में बैंक पास बुक की स्वप्रमाणित प्रति, 02 पासपोर्ट साईज रंगीन फोटोग्राफ, आधार कार्ड की प्रति, अर्जित भूमि की खतौनी की प्रमाणित प्रति एवं शपथ–पत्र इत्यादि दस्तावेजों के साथ प्रतिकर प्राप्त करने हेतु आवेदन कर सकते हैं।

सक्षम प्राधिकारी(भू०अ०) /
अपर जिलाधिकारी,
उत्तरकाशी।

'Govt must release 6,000-7,000 Maoists, including 10 on death row, from jail'

After surrendering in Feb 2026 and enrolling a law college, top CPI (Maoist) leader **Thippiri Thirupathi** *alias* **Deoji** *(61) is ready for his next innings in democratic politics. Deoji speaks to* **TOI's Bharti Jain** *on his demand to lift the ban on CPI (Maoist) and make it a lawful party. Excerpts:*

What propelled you to join the armed Naxal movement?

■ I left studies and shifted to Dandkarenya forests in 1984. The socio-political scenario in those times was marked by exploitation of peasantry and women by feudalistic set-up. In 1978, there was a big uprising by farmers of Telangana. The mass movement started giving voice to farmers, women etc. I subscribed to its anti-feudal sentiment and joined the students' Radical Students Union to actively support this cause. I was arrested several times and tortured by police. Since circumstances did not allow us to openly carry out our struggle, I went underground.

What was life like in the jungles?

■ Our commitment to CPI (Maoist)'s agenda of seizing power through armed revolution had mentally prepared us to face all odds. Negotiating difficult terrain, exhaustion, poor living conditions felt normal to us.

Where did Maoists' source their weapons from?

■ Firstly, we would snatch or loot weapons (from security forces); secondly, we manufactured them ourselves. Thirdly, depending on funds available, we purchased arms and ammunition domestically from arms dealers and smugglers.

What were primary sources funding?

■ CPI (Maoist) was funded by the people. We also extorted money from outsiders who worked in our areas, like 'tendu patta' contractors and bamboo harvesters. That CPI (Maoist) had massive funds is propaganda. Our policy was to raise money to sustain us for three years. This money was spent on people's issues, armed struggle and propaganda; extravagance was avoided. The party never had funds in excess of Rs 30-40 crore at any time.

Describe the impact of decisive operations on CPI (Maoist)?

■ In Dec 2023, at a conference of DGPs chaired by home minister Amit Shah, consensus emerged in favour of waging a decisive battle to eliminate Naxalism. Operation Kagaar was launched in Jan 2024 and continued till March 2026.

In Aug 2024, our politburo/central committee members met in Dandakaranya. We assessed that the decline in Naxals' influence that began in 2018 had acquired serious proportions. We decided to disband big outfits like PLGA, operate in small teams and work among people. But the cadre was incapable of implementing these decisions. It became too risky for them to move out of Dandakaranya. They got concentrated there, exposing themselves.

In March 2025, we decided that we were open to holding peace talks with govt. Our condition was cessation of operations against us. But govt rejected talks. The anti-Naxal operations continued with severity and many of our top netas, including general secretary Nambala Keshav Rao, were killed. After comrade Sonu surrendered, we could not arrest the wave of surrenders.

TOI INTERVIEW

IANS

We didn't surrender to lead a comfortable personal life. We want to take up people's issues through legal means. We will engage in people's politics to achieve exploitation-free society

How did HM Shah's March 31, 2026 deadline impact CPI(Maoist)?

■ If the coordinated and fierce operations by Centre and 12 states had not been run with a definite deadline, our movement would've lasted longer.

Why did you decide to surrender?

■ Given the circumstances we concluded that the situation was no longer conducive to continuing armed struggle. So we decided to give up violence and come overground. We haven't surrendered to lead a comfortable personal life. We want to take up people's issues through legal means. We will now engage in people's politics to achieve exploitation-free society.

What are your expectations or demands from govt?

■ We have been demanding that the ban on CPI(Maoist) be lifted. This way we can take up political activity in an open and legal manner.

Amit Shah claims the country became Naxal-free in March 2026; so it is only apt to free Naxals who are still in jails. We welcome govt's decision to review cases against Naxals but a distinction must not be drawn between serious and non-serious crimes.

Govt may argue that Maoists have killed many and that law should take its course. But this was a war and resulted in losses on both sides. A blanket govt order must be issued for release of 6,000-7,000 Maoists in jails, including the 10 given death sentence in Jhiram Ghati case. We also seek protection for surrendered Naxals, against revenge attacks.

Will CPI(Maoist) political document, which talks of seizing power through armed struggle, be rewritten to reflect transition to lawful politics?

■ Politics does not exist in a rigid form. Unlike divine scriptures that cannot be rewritten, politics is dynamic. Politics must adapt to changing times. Leninism and Marxism may be our theory, but the political document must reflect changed tactics and strategy.

If the ban is lifted, will CPI (Maoist) enter electoral politics?

■ We will need to consult others in CPI(Maoist). If elections do not achieve our ends, we may stay away.

Will you consider floating a new party?

■ Since Shah had asked us to work openly and legally, our obvious choice is to do so through CPI(Maoist). We will consider alternatives if this does not work out.

What prompted you to study law post-surrender?

■ As we engage in political activity as per law, we shall need a countrywide network of legal experts to implement our political agenda.

The knowledge of law will help us defend activities that are within the legal framework. It will also help in perception management.

CRPF men wounded in Kulgam terror attack out of danger

▶Continued from P1

Killings came as forces intensified searches in south Kashmir's Kulgam after a terrorist fired at a CRPF checkpoint around 70km south of Srinagar on Wednesday, wounding three men. A CRPF officer said the attack appeared to have been carried out by a lone gunman using a high-calibre weapon, possibly an AK-47, before escaping. The wounded men were out of danger.

All parties condemned the Kulgam attack and Kishtwar killings. J&K LoP Sunil Sharma alleged terrorists had kidnapped the SPOs while they were travelling through the dense forest. "These terrorists, who are on the verge of being wiped out, are still trying to make their presence felt. This is a matter of concern for us," he said.

Former NC MP Aga Ruhullah Mehdi said the attacks were intended to derail the progress towards peace. "The perpetrators must be held accountable without delay," Mehdi added.

Former NC MP Aga Ruhullah Mehdi said the attacks were intended to derail the progress towards peace

SPOs are temporary, honorarium-based local recruits appointed to assist J&K police. Trained in handling weapons, they support village defence committees, and participate in counter-terrorism operations alongside security forces in remote areas.

In a separate operation in north Kashmir, security forces rounded up Ghulam Jeelani Reshi of Tangmarg from a forest. One hand grenade was found on him and another was found concealed in the forest following his disclosure, police said.

TOI LINE OF NO CONTROL SANDEEP ADHWARYU

Changes in Raj rolls can be sought till Jan

▶Continued from P1

This difference in method explains why a draft SSR roll may not mirror a final SIR roll. But the wider problem is the coexistence of sharply different official numbers. The SSR draft is around 11 lakh higher than the final SIR roll, yet around 18 lakh lower than the SEC's early-Oct roll.

The draft rolls have been shared with recognised political parties and uploaded on the CEO website. Voters can seek inclusion, deletion or correction through the prescribed forms before the final roll is frozen in January. Mahajan urged eligible citizens to verify their names in the draft roll and apply for inclusion if their names are missing.

Bhojpuri songs at Mum stations trigger row

Mumbai: Language wars again erupted in Mumbai, this time over the playing of devotional Bhojpuri songs at several stations across the city ahead of Chhath Puja. Following warnings of agitation from outfits alleging threat to Marathi identity, the songs were stopped at some stations, reports **Manthan K Mehta**.

Jitu Patil of Maharashtra Navnirman Railway Sena said, "We warned the railway administration of an agitation."

Marathi Ekikaran Samiti also objected, arguing that the railway administration should be mindful of Maharashtra's linguistic and cultural identity.

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Authorised Signatory

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I, Archana Dinesh Kumar Jhamb, R/O Flat No 702, Kalypso Court, Tower 11, JP Wishtown, Sector 128, Noida 201304, Dist Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh, have changed my name to Archana Dinesh Jhamb.

I, Ravi Kumar Gupta S/O: Surendra Prasad, R/o Flat No S-3,Plot No 200 Gyan Khand 1, Indrapuram, Gaziabad, I.E. Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh - 201010 have changed my name to Ravi Kumar for all purposes.

I, Jagdish Chander Lachmandas Jhamb, R/O House No 613, Sector 4, Urban Estate, Gurgaon, Haryana, 122001, have changed my name to Jagdish Chander Jhamb.

I, Nahid Praween, D/o Noor Alam, R/o J-43, 4th Floor, Abul Fazal Enclave-1, Jamia Nagar, Okhla, New Delhi-110025, have changed my name from Nahid Praween to Nahid Perween for all future purposes.

I Maryada Pandey W/o Rajender Kumar Pandey R/o E-23A, GNo-2, Shiv Durga Vihar, Lakkarpur, FBD-121009 have changed my name to Sandhya Pandey R/o E-172, GNo-5, Shiv Durga Vihar, Lakkarpur, FBD

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MINISTRY OF COMMERCE AND INDUSTRY
सत्यमेव जयते

Organiser
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13 – 27 November 2026

Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi

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A GRAND OPENING TO THE CELEBRATIONS

Inauguration on 13 November 2026 by

Shri Piyush Goyal

Hon'ble Union Minister of Commerce & Industry

Followed by a special Odissi performance by

Padma Shri Guru Madhavi Mudgal & Group

PLAN YOUR VISIT

Business Days	General Public Days
14–18 November	19–27 November

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Ticket booking | Navigation | Venue maps | Programme information

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VIKAS aur VIRASAT
Development & Heritage

For more information, visit itpo.gov.in/iitf

HEALTHCARE COSTS SQUEEZE URBAN HOUSEHOLDS
RISE 14% ANNUALLY, TRIPLE HEADLINE INFLATION

From rising doctor fees and expensive diagnostic tests to the growing cost of caring for ageing parents, healthcare is putting increasing financial pressure on urban working households, according to a survey

AI Image

HEALTHCARE COSTS OUTPACE INFLATION

Cost component	Annual increase
Private healthcare costs	13-14% annually
GP and specialist consultation fees	40-45%
Diagnostic costs	30-35%
Dental costs	35-40%

₹1,050-1,500 Average GP & specialist consultation fees in Tier-1 cities between 2023 and 2026

3 times: Private healthcare inflation compared with general Consumer Price Index inflation

25-50% Share of an employee's annual corporate OPD cover that a single dental procedure or MRI can consume

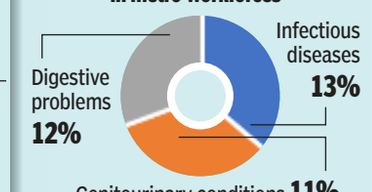
PREVENTIVE HEALTHCARE GAINS GROUND

87%: Employers now offer health benefits beyond basic hospitalisation

24%: Year-on-year increase in employers offering such benefits

Survey by: Prudent Insurance Brokers

Leading causes of hospitalisation in metro workforces



₹55,000-87,000: Average hospitalisation costs for these conditions

WORKPLACE HEALTH ALERT

41% Rise in suicide deaths among Gen Z employees between FY25 and FY26, according to claims data

16% Increase in Employee Assistance Programme (EAP) adoption

- Over 60% companies offer only basic phone or chat helplines under these programmes

ELDERCARE SQUEEZE

28%: Organisations offer no caregiving support, despite employees increasingly balancing childcare with caring for ageing parents

50-60%: Share of hospitalisation claims accounted for by elderly parents in sectors such as IT

10-20%: Co-payment on parental health claims introduced by some companies, requiring employees to bear part of the cost

GAPS IN WOMEN'S HEALTH COVER

PCOS/PCOD* management	17%
Menopause support programmes	12%

***PCOS:** Polycystic Ovary Syndrome. **PCOD:** Polycystic Ovarian Disease

₹50,000-75,000: Standard maternity cover offered by most companies

Rules eased for 'Rent a Cab' biz to help smaller operators

Dipak.Dash@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: In a bid to help smaller entrepreneurs and start-ups, govt has proposed reducing from Jan the minimum fleet requirement for 'Rent a Cab' operators to five vehicles from the existing 50, with at least two cabs per location. The requirement for branches in five tourist cities is being removed.

The draft Rent-a-Cab Scheme, 2026, also explicitly extends its coverage to vehicles rented with or without drivers. For chauffeur-driven rentals, operators must provide drivers with police-verified antecedents. The cabs must also have location-tracking devices.

The proposed scheme, which will replace the 1989 framework, introduces sweeping changes to licencing, safety, insurance and operational requirements.

Operators will be able to obtain a single electronic licence, valid across the state or Union territory, for a uniform fee of Rs 25,000, replacing separate main and branch licences. Approved operating locations can include airports, railway stations and bus terminals.

The road transport ministry has proposed a 60-day timeline for grant and renewal of licences, which will remain valid for five years. Applications for adding or removing vehicles or operating locations will be deemed approved if authorities do not complete the process within 30 days. Electronic Vahan registers and automatic retrieval of vehicle data are also expected to reduce paperwork.

Operators must maintain websites, provide round-the-clock grievance support and arrange emergency repairs and towing when needed.

More than BJP, INDIA bloc may feel Bhim-MIM sting

▶Continued from P1

The two lawmakers said they would soon discuss the seat-sharing formula and announce their respective party candidates.

Azad listed health, education and employment as the key areas on which the alliance will focus. He promised free education up to Class XII, well-equipped hospitals and better employment opportunities for the jobless youth.

"There has been an attempt to describe our newly constituted Morcha as third front. But let me be clear. If you delve deep into what all has transpired behind the scenes, it is not the third but the first front and the strongest one at that," Azad said, adding that SPM would be open to all oppressed, neglected and exploited sections of society.

Owaisi expressed confidence that SPM would emerge as a strong alternative to stop BJP from forming govt in UP for a third consecutive term.

'It is not the third but the first front and the strongest one at that,' Azad said about the alliance

"The strata of society that we — my brother (Azad) and I — come from and represent have always been used as only a vote bank. Apart from stopping BJP, our Morcha will work towards improving the education, health and employment sectors, which are in very bad shape," he added.

While Azad and Owaisi talked about dislodging BJP, poll pundits said their alliance could hurt INDIA bloc more by chipping away at Muslim and Dalit votes. "If this alliance eats into Muslim and Dalit votes, it could disrupt opposition's calculations. This is because their winning formula rests on these two communities," said an analyst, referring to SP's PDA pitch that focuses on SCs, backward classes and minorities.

Earlier, Owaisi's attempts to enter the opposition alliance had proved futile as SP and Congress cold-shouldered his repeated offers to put up a joint fight against the BJP.

Even after the formation of SPM was announced, the two parties continued to maintain that AIMIM and ASP-KR were electorally insignificant in state politics and their performance in previous elections was a proof of it. "The people of UP have lost faith in the BJP govt and I see Akhilesh Yadav as the only leader who can dislodge BJP from power in 2027 polls," Ayodhya MP Awadhesh Prasad of SP said. Congress MP Imran Masood shared similar views.

'Told of visa cancellation just before departure'

▶Continued from P1

During PM Narendra Modi's Oslo visit, **Helle Lyng Svendsen** had reportedly questioned MEA secretary (west) Sibi George over India's human rights record, asking why Norway should trust a country where such "violations" happen.

In an email interaction with **TOI** Wednesday, the commentator with Oslo-based newspaper Dagsavisen said the Indian embassy in Oslo informed her that she would not be allowed to enter India but did not explain why.

She said the organisers had informed her last week that political clearance had been granted for her participation. After submitting the required documents on Nov 5, she was informed on Nov 10 that her passport, with the visa, was ready for collection.

"Indian embassy called me 10 minutes before I was leaving for the airport to tell me that my visa would not be valid upon entry to India. They did not want to elaborate to me in writing why it had happened, but apologised for the inconvenience," she told **TOI**.

After her attempt to question PM Modi and her exchange with an MEA secretary, Svendsen was promptly embraced by the opposition and activists back home. She extended support to and lauded CJP's protests against the govt.

Svendsen questioned whether the visa decision was linked to her interaction with Modi in Oslo and her subsequent criticism of the PM and his govt. "It is very unfortunate how much of a hassle it is to host a political conference in the world's largest democracy," she said.

Reacting to the incident, Indian National Congress, in a post on X (formerly Twitter), wrote: "Why are Modi and his govt so afraid of questions?"

New bill may incorporate Shah assurance of 50% extra LS seats

▶Continued from P1

Home minister has revived 'delimitation plantation', will fail again: Congress

Congress on Thursday shot back at reports of an imminent special session of Parliament to pass the delimitation bill as "delimitation plantation" by Union home minister Amit Shah, and asserted that any such move will fail like the previous one in April.

In what he claimed was the source of fresh media reports about the special session, Congress spokesman **Jairam Ramesh** said, "The home minister has revived the 'delimitation plantation' today while talking informally to a group of journalists. He told them this afternoon that a three-day special session will soon be called and the Bills will be passed by a 15-18 vote margin." Referring to the last Parliament session called to pass delimitation bill, Ramesh said Shah had made the same claim seven months ago but the Modi govt faced a humiliating defeat in the Lok Sabha, falling short by over 50 votes. "He is the master of bluff and bluster. His bulldozer did not work then and will not work again," he said. TNN

However, numbers are aligned in a way in Lok Sabha that govt is unlikely to reach the threshold without the support of DMK, which is no longer a member of opposition INDIA bloc, but has maintained distance from BJP so far, and Nationalist Congress Party faction headed by Sharad Pawar, currently a Congress ally. Both Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam and NCP-SP had earlier hinted that they can back the Constitution amendment bill if it is fair and does not discriminate among states.

Senior BJP sources have maintained that the bill was very much on the table. However, absence of any official step so far to bring back the bill and convene Parliament has lent a touch of uncertainty to the widely-speculated move, more so as the customary winter session often starts from the fourth week of Nov.

BJP sources, though, noted that the Parliament's winter session has not always been convened in Nov.

Several winter sessions have started in Dec, and it is largely the govt's prerogative to pick a session's timing. By not proroguing the monsoon session, which was adjourned indefinitely on August 13, the govt has kept the pot boiling about the prospect of the same session being reconvened for a short duration as this allows parliamentary affairs ministry to urge Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha chairs to summon MPs at a short notice.

BJP sources added the bill will have the same features that its earlier version had, with the possibility that the assurance Union home minister **Amit Shah** had offered in Lok Sabha in April of every state getting additional Lok Sabha seats in the same proportion (50%) being written into the proposed law to satisfy the DMK.

Congress has been critical of govt for not proroguing the last session and linked it to its overdrive to cobble two-thirds majority. Govt's efforts will not succeed, it has insisted.

CCPA probing plaints against another ride-hailing platform

▶Continued from P1

The action follows a similar order and Rs 10 lakh penalty in Sept against ride-hailing platform Rapido for a similar violation. CCPA had also ordered Rapido to discontinue this practice. **TOI** has learnt that CCPA is also investigating similar complaints against another popular ride-hailing platform.

The penalty so far seems to have had little impact, as such platforms are continuing the practice.

The authority took up a complaint it received in May 2025 alleging that Ola's app was prompting customers to pay tips in advance out of fear that their bookings could be delayed or drivers might not accept their rides. The app displayed the message, "adding a tip might help increase the chances of getting a ride faster", along with pre-set tip amounts.

Ola had defended this, saying that it only offered customers an option to voluntarily reward drivers and the entire tip went to them. It maintained that customers had equal access to rides irrespective of whether they chose to pay an additional amount.

However, CCPA observed that Ola had not provided technical evidence or backend documentation to substantiate its claim that tipping did not influence ride allocation.

Died clutching sickle she used for harvesting

▶Continued from P1

The Naga-Kuki gunfight, which broke out around 11 am at a site between Taphou in Kangpokpi and Kailengjang in Senapati, inflamed ongoing tensions over two missing Kuki youths – Paoginlal Hangshing and Tinginlun Chongloi – being found dead in Senapati on Nov 1.

Kimneineng Chongloi, the latest casualty in the feud involving Kukis and Nagas, died clutching the sickle with which she had been harvesting her crop. The two wounded were identified as David Chongloi and Lamchon Chonglo.

Committee on Tribal Unity accused the state of failing to protect civilians from repeated attacks, the latest of which it blamed on militants linked to NSCN-IM & ZUF-K.

GOVERNMENT OF ASSAM
PUBLIC WORKS ROADS DEPARTMENT
O/O THE CHIEF ENGINEER (EAP)
ARR&TI CAMPUS, FATASIL AMBARI, GUWAHATI-25
Email-id: as-ce.asbip@assam.gov.in

RFB No. CE/EAP/ARRBP/BR/Z4/T18

REQUEST FOR BIDS (RFB)
E-PROCUREMENT NOTICE - Open Competitive Bidding
(Two-Envelope Bidding Process with e-Procurement)

The Government of Assam through Government of India has received a loan from the World Bank towards the cost of the **Assam Resilient Rural Bridges Program (ARRBP)** and intends to apply part of the proceeds of the loan to the eligible payment under the contract. Bids are invited online from the eligible bidders from India for the **4 (Four) packages in the district of Cachar, Sribhumi, Dima Hasao and Karbi Anglong.** Details may be seen at website **http://www.assamtenders.gov.in** and also at the office of the undersigned during office hours.

The bidding documents are available online on **http://www.assamtenders.gov.in** from **13.11.2026 to 03.12.2026.** Bidders will be required to register on the website which is free of cost. For submission of the bids, the bidder is required to have Digital Signature Certificate (DSC). Bids must be submitted online on **http://www.assamtenders.gov.in** on or before 14:00 Hours on **03.12.2026**. Other details can be seen in the bidding document. The method of paying Bid Security, Tender Processing fees as indicated in the table of this e-procurement shall be required to be submitted online on **http://www.assamtenders.gov.in** by selecting "Pay Online" option.

Chief Engineer, (EAP) PWRD
Assam, Fatasil Ambari, Guwahati-25

DIPR/CF/TOI/2356/13-Nov-26

ग्रेटर नौएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
प्लाट सं. 01, नालेज पार्क-IV, ग्रेटर नौएडा, गौतमबुद्ध नगर, उत्तर प्रदेश-201308
वेबसाइट: www.greaternoidaauthority.in ई-मेल: authority@gnida.in

पत्रांक: ग्रे. नौ./वरिष्ठ प्रबन्धक/उद्यान/2026–27/1412 दिनांक: 12.11.2026

सार्वजनिक सूचना

कृपया सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि सम्राट मिहिर भोज पार्क (सिटी पार्क) के सामने स्थित पार्किंग एरिया को प्रदर्शनी/मेले हेतु पूर्ण पारदर्शिता प्रणाली के तहत दिनाँक **01.12.2026** से निर्धारित तिथि तक बुकिंग हेतु Auction के माध्यम से आवंटित किया जाना प्रस्तावित है। Auction से सम्बन्धित समस्त नियम व शर्तें दिनाँक **18.11.2026** से प्राधिकरण की Official Website: **www.greaternoidaauthority.in** पर उपलब्ध होंगी। तद्क्रम में दिनांक **19.11.2026** से Auction हेतु Apply किया जा सकता है। तदनुसार Auction की कार्यवाही दिनाँक **23.11.2026** से की जानी प्रस्तावित है। समस्त पात्र एवं इच्छुक आवेदक समयबद्ध तरीके से आवेदन प्रक्रिया में प्रतिभाग/सहभागिता करें।

वरिष्ठ प्रबन्धक (उद्यान)

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Directorate of Farmer Welfare and Agriculture Development
Vindhyachal Bhawan Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh

F.B. /30/Winds_Tender/2026/404 Date:- 10.11.2026

Tender Notice

Selection of WINDS Implementation Partners (WIP) for setting up of Automatic Weather Station (AWS) at Tahsil level and Automatic Rain Gauge (ARG) at Gram Panchayat level and providing weather datasets as per the guidelines of Weather Information Network Data System (WINDS)

The Department of Farmer Welfare and Agriculture Development, Government of Madhya Pradesh invites quotations from experienced agencies for installation of Automatic Weather Station (AWS) at Tehsil level and ARG at Gram Panchayat (GP) level under WINDS in the State of Madhya Pradesh.

All empanelled Companies are mandated to get enrolled on https://mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app in order to download the tender documents and participate in the subsequent bidding process.

The Tender Document can be uploaded online on https://mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app. For any clarification, kindly contact The Director, Farmer Welfare and Agriculture Development, Email: dagpa@mp.gov.in, dagcropins@mp.gov.in, Phone: 0755-2551336, 0755-2572468

Director
Farmer Welfare and Agriculture Development
M.P. Bhopal

G-21368/26
"पॉक्सो है सुरक्षा का हथियार, बच्चों पर न करें अत्याचार"

ARMED FORCES MEDICAL SERVICES: 2026
JOIN AS MEDICAL OFFICER
(SHORT SERVICE COMMISSION)

CORRIGENDUM With reference to the notification published in the **"Employment News" dated 07 Nov 2026** for the post of Medical Officers (Short Service Commission) in the Armed Forces Medical Services (AFMS), the date **18 November 2026** stipulated for declaration of the final result of the PG degree for candidates pursuing PG degree shall be read as **31 December 2026.**

All other terms and conditions of the original advertisement shall remain unchanged.

By Order of the Competent Authority

MUNICIPAL CORPORATION CHANDIGARH

RFP NOTICE

RFP FOR SELECTION OF AGENCY FOR DESIGN, ENGINEERING, SUPPLY, INSTALLATION, TESTING, COMMISSIONING AND COMPREHENSIVE OPERATION & MAINTENANCE OF 45 TPD SLUDGE MANAGEMENT PLANT AT STP DIGGIAN, SECTOR 66, SAS NAGAR, MOHALI.

RFP document can be downloaded from etenders.chd.nic.in. The interested experienced and eligible entities may participate on or before **19.11.2026** (Re-invite).

- **Bid Submission Schedule (Online) : 13.11.2026**
- **Opening Technical Bid (Online) : 19.11.2026**

Executive Engineer
M.C.P.H. Division No. 4, Chandigarh

UP Rajya Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Ltd.
MALAWAN -ETAH - 207001

PUBLICATION OF GEM-TENDER NOTICE (IN/OUT OF STATE)

1- GEM/2026/B/8206295, Name of Work - Procurement of conveyor pulley laggings for CHP, 2X660 MW, Malawan Etah | Estimated cost: Rs-23,09,260.00(Including GST), EMD: Rs-30,000.00, Last Date of uploading Bid 21.11.2026 16:00 hrs.

2- GEM/2026/B/8215102, Name of Work - Procurement of Plate and other steel, 2X660 MW, JTPP, Malawan Etah | Estimated cost: Rs-28,34,932.00 (Including GST), EMD: Rs-30,000.00, Last Date of uploading Bid-19.11.2026, 13:00 hrs.

3- GEM/2026/B/8250871, Name of Work- CONSTRUCTION OF 06 OFFICE ROOMS AT CISF FIRE STATION AT 2X660MW JAWAHARPUR THERMAL POWER PROJECT, MALAWAN, DISTT-ETAH [U.P.] Estimated cost:Rs-37,72,288.52 (GST अतिरिक्त) EMD:Rs-75,500.00, Last Date of uploading Bid 21.11.2026, 16:00 hrs.

4- GEM/2026/B/8218137, Name of Work- Procurement of Fasteners, V-Belts, Jointing sheets, Shims etc. at 2X660MW JTPP, Malawan, Etah | Estimated cost:Rs-11,80,946-69 (with GST) EMD:Rs-10,100.00, Last Date of uploading Bid-23.11.2026, 17:00 hrs.

5- E-Tender No. 2026-RUVNL_1207631_1, Name of Work - Urgent Removal of Stuck P-91 Metal plate Material from Separator-B of Unit-2 Estimated cost:Rs-1,85,00,000.00 (GST Extra) EMD:Rs-2,00,000.00, Last Date of uploading Bid-17.11.2026, 15:00 hrs.

For information regarding Addendum/Corrigendum/Rejection of Bids kindly regularly visit Website **https://gem.gov.in and http://etender.up.nic.in/**

पत्रांक : 125/अधी०अभि०(मु०)/2x660 मेवा/ज०ता०प०/ दिनांक: 12.11.2026

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Navyug Market, Opp. Old Bus Stand Ghaziabad 201001, Uttar Pradesh
E-mail:gzb.nagar.nigam@gmail.com Website:www.ghaziabadnagarnigam.in

TENDER NOTICE NO: 143/Nirman/2026-27 Dated 12-11-2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Name of RFP	Selection of Transaction Advisor & Project Development Consultant for Development of the Ghaziabad Integrated Business and Innovation Hub, Ghaziabad, on Public–Private Partnership (PPP) / Design–Build–Finance–Operate–Transfer (DBFOT) Mode.
Ref No.	143/Nirman/2026-27 Date 12-11-2026
Date of Publication of e-Bid notice	13-11-2026 on e-Tender Portal https://etender.up.nic.in
Last date for submission of e-Bids on e-Tender portal	21-11-2026, 3:00 PM
Site for Submission of e-Bids e-Bid Inviting Officer	e-Tender Portal https://etender.up.nic.in Municipal Commissioner, Ghaziabad Nagar Nigam
Date of Opening of Technical e-Bids	21-11-2026, 4.00 PM
Date of Opening of Financial e-Bids	To be informed at a later stage
Venue of Opening of e-Bids	Ghaziabad Nagar Nigam Navyug Market, Opp-Old Bus Stand Ghaziabad – 201001 (UP)
Contact addresses	Chief Engineer (Ghaziabad Nagar Nigam) Email: nirmanvibhag01@gmail.com gzb.nagar.nigam@gmail.com Phone: 8178016833
Consortium:	Allowed
Tender Fee:	Non-refundable fee of INR 5,900, (including GST 18%) to be paid on E-tender website i.e. https://etender.up.nic.in
EMD:	INR 1,00,000/- to be paid on E-tender website i.e. https://etender.up.nic.in

Chief Engineer
Ghaziabad Nagar Nigam

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road Gandhinagar,
Bengaluru - 560009. Phone No. 22265383. website : www.kiadb.in

No.IADB/ENGG/PMC/ETND-EP-01/1686/2026-27 Date: 11.11.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR PROVIDING PROJECT MANAGEMENT CONSULTANCY SERVICES
(Through GoK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal only)

KIADB is inviting tender under Quality Based Consultancy System (QCBS) as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Consulting Firms under two cover system for the following work:

Name of the work: Project Management Consultancy Services for Formation of Industrial Layout Including Formation of Industrial Layout Including Formation of Roads, Flexible Pavement, Construction of RCC Side Drains, RCC Utility Ducts, HDPE Water Supply Pipeline etc., at Ittagatti Industrial Area, Sector-1 in Dharwad Taluk & District and Formation of Industrial Layout Including Formation of roads of flexible pavement, construction of RCC side drains, RCC box culverts, RCC utility ducts, HDPE water supply pipelines etc at Ittagatti (Sector-2) Industrial Area in Dharwad Taluk & District.

- Last date for submission of bids **is: 25.11.2026 upto 04:00 pm**

Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in**

Sd/-
Chief Engineer-2
K.I.A.D.B

DIPR/CP/3653/CCL/2026-27

INDIA DIGEST

720-pg chargesheet in Veeramani case

The SIT probing the child rape case against Gem Granites chairman R Veeramani has filed a 720-page chargesheet. His associates and drivers have also been named. According to police, Veeramani raped a 14-year-old girl belonging to a scheduled caste.

Mom, 3 kids die in Arunachal fire

Three minor children and their mother died at their home in a massive fire at a Parsi-Parlo township in Arunachal's Kurung Kumey Thursday. The husband suffered serious burn injuries. The fire also destroyed 19 kutcha houses.

Boy, 8, 'assaulted' in Goa school toilet

An eight-year-old student was allegedly assaulted sexually by a 13-year-old senior in a toilet cubicle of a govt-aided school in Goa. The school had allegedly convened a meeting and attempted to deal with the matter "informally".

Jr doc found dead in Jodhpur hostel

A resident doctor died under suspicious circumstances at Jodhpur's Umaid Hospital Thursday. Dr Nikki Chaudhary was a first-year PG student in the anaesthesia department. She was found unconscious in her PG, then doctors declared her dead.

AAP's 2nd Punjab list out, mantri among 7 MLAs axed

Vibhor.Mohan
@timesofindia.com

20 LOST SEATS AMONG AAP'S 31 PICKS

- **AAP's release of its second list** takes total number of candidates **announced so far to 71**
- Agriculture minister **Gurmeet Singh Khudian** and former minister Anmol Gagan Mann are among those denied tickets
- The list includes **two renominated MLAs: Saravjit Kaur Manuke** from **Jagraon and Amandeep Singh Goldy** Musafir from Balluana
- Sitting MPs **Gurmeet Singh Meet Hayer** and **Raj Kumar Chabbewal** will contest from **Barnala and Phagwara,** respectively
- Of the **31 constituencies, 20 are seats that AAP lost in the 2022** assembly elections

Chandigarh: Aam Aadmi Party Thursday announced its second list of 31 candidates for Punjab assembly polls, dropping seven sitting MLAs, including minister Gurmeet Singh Khudian and 2022 giant-slayer Charanjit Singh, while fielding two MPs, Gurmeet Singh Meet Hayer and Raj Kumar Chabbewal.

Of the 31 seats, 20 are constituencies the party lost in the 2022 polls. Five on the new list are women, including Punjabi actress Sonia Mann, who joined AAP in 2025 and was made the party's Raja Sansi constituency in-charge, which she will now contest.

"AAP has announced candidates for 71 seats so far, while other parties are still grappling with internal differences. Early announcement will give AAP candidates ample time to reach out to voters," CM Bhagwant Mann said.

Asked if the party apprehends more defections after the second list (three MLAs quit after the first), Mann said AAP's political affairs committee had discussed reports of surveys conducted over the past year and public feedback before finalising the names.

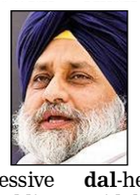
While no sitting cabinet minister features in the second list, former minister Anmol Gagan Mann has also been dropped. However, the big surprises are Khudian, who had defeated former CM Parkash Singh Badal in Lambi in 2022, and Charanjit, who beat then CM Charanjit Singh Channi in Chamkaur Sahib.

Khudian has been replaced by his nephew Randhir Singh Dhira Khuddian, while Charanjit has been bypassed in favour of Jasvir Singh Garhi, ex-BSP state chief. Khudian's differences with AAP Punjab in-charge Manish Sisodia came into the open during a party meeting in Ludhiana on May 19.

MPs Meet Hayer and Chabbewal have been fielded from Barnala and Phagwara. Chabbewal's son Ishank was nominated from Chabbewal in the first list. A father-son duo getting tickets is a first for AAP. The party has changed its candidates in eight seats, while only two sitting MLAs have been renominated in the second list. Three candidates who lost last time have been given another opportunity.

Tie-up with SAD likely, BJP may seek larger share of pie

New Delhi: Signalling that BJP's alliance with Shiromani Akali Dal is on the cards, sources said Thursday the party will contest a substantially higher number of seats than it did under its earlier seat-sharing arrangement with the regional outfit.



BJP sources said the alliance will be announced at an opportune time, amid the party's determined efforts to expand its presence in Punjab with an aggressive campaign against drug addiction and opposition to conversion by missionaries as its key planks. It has also inducted members of other parties.

BJP used to contest 23 seats in the 117-member Punjab assembly as a SAD ally, before the Akalis broke off their ties in 2020 over their protest against farm laws, which were subsequently reversed.

"We will contest more seats," a party functionary said, without giving details of the likely share of alliance members. The party is also expected to keep a breakaway Akali faction, SAD (Punar Surjit), in the alliance.

BJP's vote share in Punjab in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections at over 18% was higher than over 13% of **Sukhbir Singh Badal**-headed SAD, once a formidable regional player whose fortunes have been on a decline as AAP surged to power in the 2022 assembly polls.

BJP is hopeful that a consolidation of votes in favour of its alliance can make it a strong contender for office in the state's fragmented political arena in which Congress is main opposition party. TNN

Some people think democracy is in their pockets, says Modi

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: PM Modi Thursday launched a sharp attack on Congress and took a swipe at Rahul Gandhi without naming him, saying some people carry the Constitution in their pockets and think the country's Constitution and democracy are indeed in their pockets.

Addressing India Today Group's Bharat Kisan Conclave, Modi said these people continue to display what he described as an "undue sense of entitlement" despite no longer being in govt. "Even when they are not in office, they behave this way. It is a strange kind of intoxication of power," he said.

Speaking on agriculture, the PM stressed that agricultural development, smarter farming and farmer empowerment are key to building a 'Viksit Bharat'. Citing a World Bank study, he claimed 50 crore people had come out of poverty over the past 12 to 13 years and highlighted that small farmers and agricultural labourers were among them, while rural areas had witnessed a significant decline in poverty.

Modi said focus of his govt is on empowering farmers to become agricultural entrepreneurs

Earlier in the day, Modi said that India will achieve its goal of becoming a developed nation by 2047 as the mindset has changed and targets set by govt, which appeared impossible, have been met. "When a deadline is set, priorities change, the way of working changes and the speed changes too. And the achievements with which India is moving forward today, achieving the goal of a developed India is not impossible. Just think what India has achieved in the past few years," Modi said during a post-Diwali meeting with journalists at BJP headquarters.

PM to visit Manila next wk for Asean, likely Quad meet

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: PM Narendra Modi will travel to the Philippines on Nov 16-17 for the 23rd Asean-India Summit and the 21st East Asia Summit, govt said Thursday, while adding that India-Asean relations are a central pillar of India's Act East Policy and its vision for the Indo-Pacific.

There was no official announcement by India about the Quad leaders' summit that is expected to take place on the margins in Manila, although the meeting remains tentatively scheduled for Nov 17 in Manila. It's learnt that India, Australia and Japan will wait for the US to first announce the leaders' summit that hasn't taken place for the past two years.

Secretary of state Marco Rubio said last month that the Quad leaders will meet finally in Manila. It's not clear yet if Modi will also have a formal meeting with President Donald Trump, as officials said the PM's bilateral meetings — except the one confirmed with host Philippines' President Ferdinand Marcos Jr — are still a work in progress.

The Asean and East Asia Summit meetings this year will take place amid renewed China-Philippines tensions caused by overlapping claims in the South China Sea. Reports from the Philippines have said though that Asean and China are nearing an agreement for a code of conduct for the South China Sea.

"This is a very important international waterway. So, whatever Code of Conduct is developed must be compliant with international maritime law...it must take into account the legitimate rights of countries that are not participating in that negotiation," said MEA secretary (east) Rudrendra Tandon.

Pitroda, Modi display rare public bonhomie

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Congress's overseas wing head, **Sam Pitroda**, is a vocal critic of PM Narendra Modi and the key organiser of Rahul Gandhi's overseas outreach events.

But the festive season brought out of him rare words of praise for Modi, who in turn extended his Diwali greetings to the fellow Gujarati.

Modi said, "Happy Diwali and Nutan Varsh Abhinandan to you Sam Bhai and to Anjana Ben. Praying for a joyful and healthy year ahead. Jai Jagannath!"

In remarks to a news agency, Pitroda had called Modi a "Gujarati friend" whom he respects as a person.

"My wife and I have met him. He has been very warm, kind, loving and caring at a personal level. Of course, he is a good orator and hard-working, and we get along well. We have no personal issues. I have nothing against Mr Modi as a Gujarati leader, friend or well-wisher. He has been very warm towards me, and I appreciate that. Similarly, I have been to his house in Gujarat several times," he said.

Modi's greetings took even some BJP supporters by surprise. One said on X if he could wish Pitroda, he could wish him as well. Sure enough, Modi posted his Diwali greetings to him.

Punjab ex-SSP gets 5-yr jail in 1992 kidnapping & disappearance case

Mohali: A special CBI court in Mohali sentenced dismissed Punjab Police SSP Gurmeet Singh Randhawa to five years' imprisonment and fined him Rs 75,000 in the 1992 kidnapping and disappearance of Ludhiana transporter Amrik Singh Sakri, reports **Barinderjit Saluja**.

Randhawa, 71, was jailed for five years under Section 365 and two years under Section 120B of IPC. Both sentences will run concurrently.

Sakri's wife, Amrik Kaur, said the family would challenge the order in Punjab and Haryana HC. "Randhawa should have been awarded life term at least. Five years is too less for the crime he committed."

Punjab govt had sacked Randhawa in 2015. Co-accused Parminderjit Singh, an ex-police security guard, was acquitted due to insufficient evidence. Three other accused cops and the alleged mastermind, former Tarn Taran SSP Ajit Singh Sandhu, died during investigation and trial.

Death threat to Kejriwal, claims Delhi AAP MLA

Mohali: Police have registered a case under BNS and IT Act following a complaint by Delhi AAP MLA Jarnail Singh, who alleged he got a call from the Lawrence Bishnoi gang, threatening to kill former Delhi CM **Arvind Kejriwal** and his daughter unless Kejriwal paid Rs 7 crore.

Jarnail, who represents Tilak Nagar constituency, was in Mohali when he received the call. According to the complaint, he received a call and a threat message on his personal mobile number on Nov 6 from a WhatsApp profile that carried the name 'H'. The caller allegedly claimed to represent the Lawrence gang.

While AAP condemned the death threat and said the Bhagwant Mann govt would not allow anyone disturb state's peace, BJP's former state chief Sunil Jakhar called it a part of AAP's agenda to create the sense of fear. TNN

Yogi: Bulldozers now UP brand, make them here

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Lucknow: Pitching his govt's reputation for 'bulldozer action' against criminals, Uttar Pradesh chief minister **Yogi Adityanath** on Thursday invited CNH Industrial, which is setting up a tractor manufacturing plant in Gautam Buddh Nagar, to also manufacture the heavy machinery in the state.

"You must have heard about Uttar Pradesh's bulldozer. I would like to tell CNH that since you are manufacturing tractors in the state, you can also manufacture bulldozers here. There will automatically be demand for them in the country and abroad because it has already become a brand here," the CM said.

The chief minister was virtually addressing the groundbreaking ceremony of CNH Industrial's tractor manufacturing plant in the Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority area.

"Uttar Pradesh has moved from the rule of mafia to the rule of law," he said, attributing improvement in law and order to his govt's zero-tolerance policy towards crime and tough action against criminals. Yogi said a robust law and order had helped the state move towards becoming a destination for ease of doing business.

'Drugs sold like toffees': Nihang to Punjab min

Sangrur: Punjab minister and AAP state chief Aman Arora faced protests at a public function in Sangrur's Tolawal over alleged open sale of 'chitta (heroin)'. A Nihang, Gurpreet Singh Goldy, approached the stage when Arora was distributing property ownership documents and alleged drugs were being sold "like toffees", reports **Bharat Khanna**.

Arora termed Punjab's drug problem as a "cancer" that had taken root under previous govts and could not be cured overnight. Interrupted by an agitated crowd, Arora pointed to a vicious cycle hindering police action: residents from neighbouring villages frequently acted as bail guarantors for arrested drug peddlers, allowing them to walk free.

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Railways may do away with RAC facility

New Delhi: Railways is looking into the option of doing away with the Reservation Against Cancellation (RAC) facility, under which two passengers are allotted a single berth and charged the full fare despite getting only half the sleeping space.

TOI has learnt the move is being examined in the wake of concerns over passenger convenience and the need to revisit a provision that has remained a part of the reservation system for decades. "There is a view that when a passenger isn't getting full sleeping space, it may not be appropriate to charge the full fare," said an official.

The RAC facility also becomes a cause for discomfort when the same seat is allotted to a male and a female passenger. Train ticket examiners face challenges in finding an alternative arrangement in such cases.

The issue of travellers with RAC tickets being charged full fares has also been flagged by a parliamentary panel, which questioned its rationale. The panel has recommended that railways review the arrangement to ensure passengers are not made to pay the full fare without getting the benefit of a proper berth. — **Dipak Dash**

Can GLP-1 drugs cause vision loss? Why FDA wants a warning on packs

The US health regulator has flagged an eye hazard after clinical trials and case reports over two years about GLP-1 use showed a possible rise in risk of rare eye condition NAION, which can cause permanent blindness. Its label warning directive covers both semaglutide (Ozempic, Wegovy) and tirzepatide (Mounjaro, Zepbound). **TOI** explains what the risk is and why those on the drugs should be cautious

What is NAION?

- **Full form:** Non-arteritic anterior ischemic optic neuropathy
- **Who are at risk:** Older adults, those with diabetes, hypertension, high lipids, sleep apnea, heart disease, kidney disease, and smokers. The new FDA directive says those on GLP-1 medication are also at risk
- **What happens:** Reduced blood flow damages front of the optic nerve, which carries visual signals from the eye to the brain
- **How it starts:** Vision loss is usually sudden and painless, affects one eye at a time and may first be noticed on waking
- **What it looks like:** Part of the field of vision may appear blurred, dark or missing. Colours may also look different
- **Can vision recover?** Some people regain part of their vision, but loss can be permanent
- **How to test?** A detailed eye exam, including a fundus test to identify an anatomically crowded optic disc, can help identify those at risk

HOW BIG IS THE RISK?

1 **Six** in every **1 lakh** people taking GLP-1 medication for at least a year are at risk, according to FDA review of 126 trials, where placebos and other glucose-lowering drugs were also used for comparison. For other drugs, it was **less than four** in every **1 lakh** people

2 A 2024 Harvard study first flagged the risk. A cohort of 16,827 patients revealed a higher risk of NAION in those prescribed semaglutide, compared with those given other non-GLP-1 medications for diabetes or obesity

3 A 2025 study by scientists from Taiwan, published in JAMA Ophthalmology, compared two groups of around 175,000 people with diabetes to find higher risk with semaglutide than with other diabetes drugs

TOI HEALTH+

"With NIAON, vision recovery is usually modest, and some patients may have permanent visual field defects. It may also affect the second eye. Early evaluation, risk factor control are crucial

Dr Anusha Arvind, NEURO-OPHTHALMOLOGIST, NARAYANA NETHRALAYA, BENGALURU

"Exact mechanism by which GLP-1 drugs may raise NAION risk is not yet established. But changes in BP and fluid balance could affect blood supply to optic nerve. Rapid metabolic changes, especially in people with diabetes, may also play a role

Dr Vivek Garg, HEAD OF OPHTHALMOLOGY, MAX HOSPITAL, GURGAON

What should people on GLP-1 drugs do?

- Don't panic or stop medication independently. Discuss risk with doctor
- Any sudden, painless blurring or loss of vision, or a dark spot appearing in one eye needs prompt medical attention
- It is important to maintain blood sugar and blood pressure control, as well as manage underlying conditions

As told to **Jahnavi T R**

PAN, EPIC not enough: HC declares Assam woman a foreigner

Prabin.Kalita
@timesofindia.com

HC said PAN and EPIC issued on self-declaration without formal inquiry cannot independently establish citizenship

Guwahati: Gauhati HC has upheld a foreigners tribunal order declaring Kulchan Begum of Assam's Darrang district a foreigner and revoking her interim bail, after she could not establish her Indian citizenship despite producing 14 documents, including PAN and voter ID cards, in a 26-year battle.

A bench of Justices Kalyan Rai Surana and Susmita Phukan Khaund ruled in its Nov 5 order that PAN cards and elector photo identity cards (EPICs) issued on self-declaration without formal inquiry could not independently establish citizenship.

"The PAN card and EPIC exhibited by the petitioner are not proof of citizenship. These are documents that are issued on self-application without any formal inquiry by the IT department and EC. Therefore, unless the records supplementing the PAN card and EPIC are proved, the said exhibited documents cannot be accepted as a proof of citizenship of India," the bench said.

Begum had submitted PAN and EPIC cards of a man she claimed was her father, who she said contested parliamentary and assembly elections. She had presented her own EPIC, voter lists carrying the names of a couple she claimed were her grandparents, and an acknowledgement of her NRC application. But she failed to establish her relationship with her purported father and grandparents. The NRC acknowledgement was also not proved.

The court said an Area Sabha representative's certificate and ration card could not establish citizenship or parentage. It also found no evidence that the alleged father and grandparents had continuously lived in Assam for 27 years between 1970 and 1997, as required under special provisions of the Citizenship Act applicable to Assam.

HC said none of the documents discharged her burden under Section 9 of the Foreigners Act, 1946, to prove she was an Indian citizen and the daughter of Indian parents.

HC: Sad day for democracy if case filed to suppress protest

Nagpur: Bombay HC's Nagpur bench quashed a criminal case against a 26-year-old Chandrapur man who led an agitation demanding repairs to a battered road, warning that it would be a "sad day for democracy" if peaceful protesters faced criminal prosecution, reports **Abhishek Choudhari**.

Justice MW Chandwani held in the order that the prosecution of Nishkarsh Nimgade amounted to an abuse of the process of law, stressing that criminal cases could not be used to suppress democratic protests. "It is a settled law that prosecutions must not be launched to stifle agitations that are part of a democratic process as long as protesters don't take the law into their own hands or indulge in violence or damage public or private property," Justice Chandwani said, citing a Supreme Court ruling.

HC said Article 19(1)(b) of the Constitution guaranteed the right to assemble peacefully and without arms.

According to the prosecution, a pickup vehicle hit an electricity pole and overturned near Nandgaon on Jan 21, leaving at least one man critically injured. A crowd gathered at the spot and demanded action against PWD officials and the contractor over poor road quality. Later, police named Nimgade in an FIR alleging wrongful restraint, unlawful assembly, and other offences.

After SSR, Bihar adds 13L voters to SIR tally

Patna: Bihar has over 7.55 crore voters in draft rolls for 2027 published Thursday after the special summary revision (SSR) ordered by EC.

This is over 13 lakh more than the tally of 7.42 crore voters listed in post-SIR rolls ahead of the 2025 assembly elections, reports **Abhay Singh**.

The post-SSR rolls brought out by the state's chief electoral officer (CEO) include those eligible for enrolment in the final rolls to be released on Jan 4 next year and eventually for voting. Claims can be filed till Dec 12 this year and will be addressed by Dec 28.

The draft rolls have been displayed at all designated locations and the CEO's website to allow corrections. Of the total voters, 3.99 crore are men, 3.56 crore women and 1,489 transgender persons.

Govt confident of holding polls in violence-hit Manipur on time

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Amid continuing incidents of violence in ethnic-strife-hit Manipur, govt sources Thursday expressed confidence that the assembly polls in the state will be held on schedule.

The term of the Manipur assembly ends on March 13 next year, and the state is due to go to the polls alongside Goa, Punjab, Uttarakhand and Uttar Pradesh.

However, a long phase of ethnic violence, which has subsided but continues to persist sporadically, has left political circles wondering if the Manipur polls will be held on time.

"It will be held on time," a source said when asked.

EC, which has been making preparations, put Manipur's electorate at 19.94 lakh in its draft rolls, signalling an expansion of the voter base by nearly 2% before assembly elections expected by March. The draft rolls, prepared after a special summary revision (SSR), added 33,737 electors to the rolls published following Special Intensive Revision (SIR) in Sept.

The 60 assembly constituencies of the state registered a rise in voter numbers, with women outnumbering men by 55,437. Saikot recorded the highest gain of more than 2,600 electors.

The window for filing claims and objections will remain open until Dec 11. The final rolls will be published on Jan 4.

2L deletions, 4L additions in Assam rolls

Guwahati: A shade below two lakh voters' names were deleted and four lakh-odd were added during the special summary revision (SSR) of Assam's poll rolls, resulting in the draft list published Thursday reflecting a net increase of over two lakh to peg the state's electoral strength at 2.5 crore. Women voters marginally outnumber men in the updated rolls by 1,289 electors. Dalgaon has been found to have the highest number of electors (3.2 lakh) in the state. EC said the draft rolls were now officially open for claims and objections based on notified guidelines. The process will run until Dec 11, and the final rolls are scheduled to be published on Jan 4. — **Prabin Kalita**

EC restores Goan family of 6 on voter roll

Panaji: Forced by Bombay HC, the Election Commission Thursday restored a Goan family of six to the electoral roll of St Cruz constituency, where they now live, with their original EPIC numbers.

The names of Paresh Salgaonkar and five family members were struck off during the SIR exercise. Their Form 8 for change of address could not be processed because of a glitch in the EC's software.

Instead of fixing it, EC told them to fill Form 6, meant for new, first-time voters. The family refused and moved the HC.

Last week, the HC gave the electoral registration officer 10 days to restore all six names. It refused EC's plea to stay the order for two weeks to approach SC, holding that the right to vote cannot wait for an appeal. — **Lisa Monteiro**

Jewel thieves strike in TN & MP, decamp with gold, diamonds worth several crores

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Madurai/Bhopal/Jabalpur: In two big jewellery thefts, burglars decamped with 23 kg of gold and diamond items in Tamil Nadu's Madurai and jewellery worth Rs 15 crore in MP's Katni early Thursday.

In Madurai, a masked burglar sneaked into a newly opened Tanishq showroom at Palanganatham through a lift passage between 3am and 4am Thursday.

The suspect climbed the scaffolding erected behind the building for construction work and reached the third floor housing the showroom.

"He cut through the protective mesh covering the lift shaft, climbed down onto the roof of the lift car parked at the first-floor level, entered the cabin and forced open its glass door to access the showroom," said an investigation officer. CCTV footage showed the burglar leaving from the rear, unnoticed by security guards stationed at the main entrance.

In Katni, a group of burglars broke into Kisna Jewellers showroom in the Bargawan area by drilling through a nearly nine-inch-thick wall at the rear of the showroom.

The theft came to light around 11 am on Thursday, when the manager arrived to open the showroom. "Every item entering or leaving the showroom is recorded in our computer system. The exact value will be known only after the accounts team completes the verification," said owner Mohan Bajaj.

Katni SP Abhinav Vishwakarma inspected the spot and said a preliminary investigation suggested the burglary took place between 4am and 7am.

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS:TIRUPATI
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER, T.T.D, TIRUPATI

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

T.T.Devasthanams invites Expression of Interest (EOI) from various expert companies for Providing special lighting to the newly constructed outer prakaram with 3 Nos. of 5 storied Rajagopurams and 1 No. of 7 storied main Rajagopuram and inside of the temple at S.V Temple, Venkatapalem in the capital city of Amaravathi, AP.

For details log on to www.tirumala.org (or) Contact No. 98492 18181 / 98493 77040

TTD-40021(31)/1/2026 - PRO SEC (Adv. No. 240). Date - 12.11.2026 **Executive Officer**

Shirur Municipal Council, Shirur, Dist. Pune

Telephone No. 02138/222122

Email-shirur.pune@gmail.com | **E-Tender Notice Parent Portal:** http://mahatenders.gov.in

E-Tender Notice No. 23, Year-2026-27

E-Tender Notice No. 2026_DMA_1352614_1 for submission of e-Tender published under The date 07/11/2026 has been set; all concerned parties should take note of this. The pre-qualification criteria and detailed tender notice are available on the government website http://mahatenders.gov.in.

(Shri Pankaj Kakad) Planning Assistant **(Shri Pritam Patil)** Chief Officer

कार्यालय नगर निगम जयपुर

अम्बाबाडी सर्किल, अम्बाबाडी जयपुर

क्रमांक :– जसअ / 2026 / 302 दिनांक : 12.11.2026

ई– निविदा सूचना संख्या 38 से 63 / 2026–27

केन्द्र एवं राज्य सरकार के विभागों में पंजीकृत "एए" व "ए" श्रेणी के ठेकेदारों एवं नगर निगम जयपुर के उपयुक्त श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से विभिन्न विकास कार्यों की निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। कार्यों की अनुमानित लागत, टेण्डर बेचे जाने तथा प्राप्त करने की तारीख, टेण्डर शर्त आदि सम्पूर्ण विवरण राज्य सरकार के ई–प्रोक्योरमेंट पोर्टल http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, www.sppp.raj.nic.in तथा नगर निगम जयपुर की Web Site www.jaipurmc.org. पर देखी व Download की जा सकती है तथा निर्धारित अवधि तक ई–प्रोक्योरमेंट पोर्टल http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in पर अपलोड की जा सकेगीं।

SPPP portal UBN No. JMC2627WSOB00763 to JMC2627WSOB00769, JMC2627WSOB00788, JMC2627WSOB00770 to JMC2627WSOB00784, JMC2627WSOB00787, JMC2627WSOB00786, JMC2627WSOB00785

राज.संवाद / सी / 26 / 13107 अधिशाषी अभियन्ता विद्याधर नगर जोन

POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF UTTARAKHAND LTD.

(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Enterprise)

Office of Chief Engineer (O&M), Kumaon Zone, 220KV S/s, Campus, Kamaluaganja, Haldwani-263139

Corporate ID U40101UR2004SGC028675 Phone No. 7088117917

E-Tender Time Extension Notice-2

Due to unavoidable circumstances the date of submission of **E-Tender Specification No. CE/OandM/PTCUL/HLD/59/2026-27, TENDER ID (2026_PTCU9_100573_1)** has been extended upto 26.11.2026, 17:00 Hrs. For more details please visit E-Tender Website ***www.uktenders.gov.in*** and E-Tender time extension notice is available at PTCUL Website ***www.ptcul.org***. All other terms and conditions of the above tenders will remain same. For any assistance on E-Tendering, please contact +91-8899890000

Letter No. 2267/CE(O&M)/PTCUL/HLD/E-Tender

Date : 12.11.2026 **Chief Engineer (O&M)** Kumaon Zone

"Save Electricity in the Interest of Nation" PTCUL, Haldwani

VADHVAN PORT PROJECT LIMITED

(PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION DIVISION)

TENDER NOTICE No. VPPL/T- 13/2026 dated, 12/11/2026

SHORT E-TENDER NOTICE

Vadhvan Port Project Limited invites e-Tenders "ONLINE" in Single Stage two bid system from **13.11.2026 & last date for submission of bid is 14.12.2026** from eligible Consultants who fulfil the Pre - Qualification Criteria (PQC) as stipulated in the Tender for **"Selection of Consultant for Transaction Advisory Services for Development of Container Terminals, Liquid Terminals, Multipurpose Berths and Ro-Ro Terminal for Phase-I facilities of Vadhvan Port at Dahanu in Palghar District of Maharashtra State on DBFOT basis under various Packages"** Detailed Notice Inviting Tender and Tender Document is available on VPPL website **https://vadhvanport.in** or e-procurement Procurement Portal (CPP Portal) **"https://etenders. gov. in/eprocure/app.**

Chairman & Managing Director -VPPL

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Letter No. E Office File No: NCR-AGC0COMM/7/2026 **Date: 09.11.2026**

Tender Notice

On Behalf of The President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager-North Central Railway-Agra invites GeM Bid Number:- GEM/2026/B/8256100, Date:- 09.11.2026 as per details given as under:-

GeM Bid Number:- GeM Bid Number:-GEM/2026/B/8256100,Date:- 09.11.2026

GeM Bid Details:- Custom Bid for Services - Tender for the work for outsourcing of comprehensive management of parcel activities mentioned in FM Circular 26 of 2025 for MTJ under Agra Division for 03 years

GeM Bid End Date and Time:- Date:- 30.11.2026 Time:-14:00

GeM Bid Opening Date and Time:- Date:- 01.12.2026 Time:-14:00

Note:-Prospective bidders are requested to visit GeM Portal website **(https://gem.gov.in)**. The above mentioned GeM Bid details are available therein under the above mentioned GeM Bid Number. **2564/26 (D)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF UTTARAKHAND LTD.

(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Enterprise)

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (OPERATION & MAINTENANCE) , GARHWAL ZONE, 26-CIVIL LINES, ROORKEE

E-TENDER CORRIGENDUM

"Work of Strengthening of 220 KV Bus Bar (Tarantulla 1200 Amp) by Twin Moose Conductor (2000 Amp) & Associated works at 220 KV Substation Virbhadra Rishikesh" against e-tender specification **No.CE/GZR-27/2026-27** is hereby extended. The last date of submission of online offline e-tender is **26.11.2026** upto 15:00 hrs which shall be opened on **27.11.2026** at 15:15 hrs. Details of e-tender can be obtained from e-tender website **www.uktenders.gov.in** and information of e-tender can be seen from PTCUL website **www.ptcul.org.** All other terms and conditions shall remain same. For any assistance on e-tendering, please contact on Mb.No.+91-8899890000.

CHIEF ENGINEER (O&M)

No. 1142/CE(O&M)/GZR/Advt. **Dated: 12-11-2026**

"SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF NATION"

कार्यालय नगर विकास न्यास, अलवर (राज.)

क्रमांक :- लेखा/2026/6084 - 87 दिनांक :- 02/11/2026

NOTICE INVITING NIT – 16/2026-27

Repair And Maintenance Of Street Light Works In Uit, Alwar (Annual Contract). 03-11-2026 to 13-11-2026 3.00 PM. Technical bid Will be opened 16-11-2026 at 4.00 PM. particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.raj.nic.in** of the state and **www.uitalwar.in.** The approximate Value of the procurement is Rs. 151.00 lakhs.

UBN : UAL2627WSOB00149 **Executive Engineer**

Raj.Samwad/C/26/13112 **UIT, Alwar**

POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF UTTARAKHAND LTD.

(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Enterprise)

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (OPERATION & MAINTENANCE) , GARHWAL ZONE, 26-CIVIL LINES, ROORKEE

E-TENDER NOTICE

Power Transmission Corporation of Uttarakhand Ltd. Invites the following e-tenders.

1. Construction of Protection wall for Tower No. CD 62 at Panyali Village of 220 KV Chamba- Dharashu Line under 220KV O&M Division Chamba, Tehri (G), against e-tender specification **No.CE/GZR-34/2026-27.** Last date of submission online/offline of e-tender is **14.12.2026** upto 15:00 hrs. which shall be opened on **15.12.2026** at 15:00 hrs.

2. Construction of RCC and Revetment wall for protection of RC 94 of 220 KV Rishikesh-Chamba Line under 220KV O&M Division Chamba, Tehri (G), against e-tender specification **No.CE/GZR-35/2026-27.** Last date of submission online/offline of e-tender is **14.12.2026** upto 15:00 hrs. which shall be opened on **15.12.2026** at 15:15 hrs. Details of e-tender can be obtained from e-tender website **www.uktenders.gov.in** and information of e-tender can be seen from PTCUL website **www.ptcul.org.** For any assistance on e-tendering, please contact on Mb. No.91-8899890000.

CHIEF ENGINEER (O&M)

No. 1139/CE(O&M)/GZR/Advt. **Dated: 12-11-2026**

"SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF NATION"

BANGALORE WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD

Office of the Engineer in Chief

2nd Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, K.G. Road, Bangalore- 560 009.

No.:BWSSB/EIC/ACE(Cst DCW)/5074/2026-27 **Date:11.11.2026**

INVITATION FOR TENDER

(Through KPP Portal only)

BWSSB invites tender in two stage tender system from eligible contractors for the work of **Construction of 5.0 ML capacity RCC GLR which is feeding Kaval Byrasandra and other surrounding areas located at Pulikeshingar, Bangalore.**

Amount put to tender : **Rs. 1688.89 Lakhs.**

EMD: **Rs. 16.9 Lakhs.**

The last date and time for submission of completed tenders is on **26.11.2026 upto 16:00 Hrs.** The bids will be opened on **30.11.2026 after 11.00 Hrs.** The details regarding the tender and participation in the e-procurement process can be obtained by logging on to **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** For further details contact undersigned office during the working hours.

Sd/-

Engineer in Chief

DIPR/CP/JA/3649/2026-27

Maharashtra State Agricultural Marketing Board, Pune

Plot No. R-7, Market Yard, Gultekadi, Pune - 411037

Tel. No.: 020-24528100 / 24528200

Email - domestic@msamb.com Website - www.msamb.com

e-TENDER NOTICE

MSAMB invites online bids from eligible Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEMs) and / or their authorized bidders for Supply, Installation, and Testing of AI-Based Automatic Grain Analyser Machines at Agricultural Produce Market Committees (APMCs) in Maharashtra. The last date and time for submission of bids is 03.12.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. The tender document may be downloaded from the Maharashtra e-Tender Portal (https://mahatenders.gov.in) and the MSAMB website (www.msamb.com). Any corrigendum, extension of the bid submission deadline, or other information relating to this tender shall be published only on the above-mentioned websites.

Managing Director

AI AIRPORT SERVICES LIMITED

INVITATION FOR BIDS

AIASL invites eligible bidders for: **"Concession for the Development, Construction, Operation and Management of Facilities at AI Unity Complex, Chennai, under a Revenue-Sharing Model."**

Interested parties may download the tender document from the AIASL website: **www.aiasl.in/Tenders** and/or AIAHL website: **https://aiahl.in/tenders**

Tender No.: AIASL/HQ-Works/26-27/01

Last date for submission : 07 Dec. 2026

Please refer the tender document for all other details.

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)

Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813

Website : www.pspcl.in

TENDER ENQUIRY No. 04/BTI/GCD/TS/PSPCL/2026-27 **DATED: 12.11.2026**

Dy. CE/Grid construction circle, Power colony-1, Sarabha Nagar, PSPCL, Ludhiana Invites open e-Tender for hiring **01 No. mobile crane of 150 ton capacity for loading, unloading and placement of power transformers upto 31.5 MVA for carrying out various works under Grid Construction Circle, Ludhiana.** For detailed NIT Tender Specifications please refer to **http://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 12.11.2026 (11.30 AM onwards).

Note : Corrigendum and amendments, if any, will be published online at **http://eproc.punjab.gov.in.**

C1089/26, DPR/Pb.:1079/12/2026-27/17023

Virus Research and Diagnostic Laboratory

Government Medical College

Rampur Road, Haldwani, Dist. Nainital, Uttarakhand-263139

PUBLIC NOTICE:

CANCELLATION OF RECRUITMENT PROCESS

This is for the information of all concerned candidates that the recruitment process, including the walk-in-interview conducted on 21st September 2026 against Advertisement No. 479, for the 01 (One) contractual post of Scientist-B (Non-Medical) at the Viral Research and Diagnostic Laboratory (VRDL), Department of Microbiology, Government Medical College, Haldwani, hereby stands cancelled.

Principal,
Government Medical College
Haldwani (Nainital)

SAHARANPUR SMART CITY LIMITED
CIN: U75144UP2018SGC101551
Reg. Office: Gurudwara Road,
Nagar Nigam Campus, Saharanpur-247001 (UP)
Email: **smartcitysaharanpur@gmail.com**, Website: **www.saharanpursmartcity.com**

NIT No. 07/2026-27/03/SSCL Date: 12th November 2026

Notice Inviting Tender

Saharanpur Smart City Limited, Saharanpur invites online Bids on two stage system for the following works:

Name of Project/ Work(s)	Estimated Cost (excluding GST) (Rs.)	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.)	Tender Fee including GST (Rs.)	Period of Completion
Shifting of 11kv line, LT line and transformer during work of construction of road and retaining wall for approach road of newly constructed bridge in U/S of Dehradun Ambala road xing in district Saharanpur Tender ID: 2026_SSCL_1207676_1	17,94,835/- (Rupees Seventeen Lakh Ninety Four Thousand Eight Hundred Thirty Five Only)	36,000/- (Rupees Thirty Six Thousand Only)	5900/- (Five Thousand Nine Hundred Only)	Three (03) Months

1. Detailed NIT & Bid Documents shall be downloaded from **https://etender.up.nic.in**
2. Availability of Tender on-line for bidding: From 12.11.2026 at 1500 Hrs.
3. Last Date & Time for online submission of Bids: 18.11.2026 at 1700 hrs.
4. Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid: 19.11.2026 at 1100 hrs.
5. Date & Time of Opening of Financial Bid: To be intimated later
6. Pre-bid Meeting: 16.11.2026 at 1600 hrs. at SSCL office
7. SSCL reserves right to reject any or all Tenders and/ or cancel/ annul/ keep in abeyance the Auction Process.
8. Any subsequent addendum/corrigendum shall be published at eauction portal **https://etender.up.nic.in** only.

(Company Secretary)

SAHARANPUR SMART CITY LIMITED
CIN: U75144UP2018SGC101551
Reg. Office: Gurudwara Road,
Nagar Nigam Campus, Saharanpur-247001 (UP)
Email: **smartcitysaharanpur@gmail.com**, Website: **www.saharanpursmartcity.com**

NIT No. 08/2026-27/01/SSCL Date: 12th November 2026

Notice Inviting Tender

Saharanpur Smart City Limited, Saharanpur invites online Bids on two stage system for the following works:

Name of Project/ Work(s)	Estimated Cost (excluding GST) (Rs.)	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.)	Tender Fee (Rs.)	Period of Completion
Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of HT Electrical Infrastructure including Transformer at Convention Hall, Janmach, Saharanpur Tender ID: 2026_SSCL_1207721_1	33,42,716/- (Rupees Thirty Three Lakh Fourty Two Thousand Seven Hundred Sixteen only)	70,000/- (Rupees Seventy Thousand Only)	5900/- (Five Thousand Nine Hundred Only)	Six (06) Months

1. Detailed NIT & Bid Documents shall be downloaded from **https://etender.up.nic.in**
2. Availability of Tender on-line for bidding: From 12.11.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.
3. Last Date & Time for online submission of Bids: 18.11.2026 at 17:00 hrs.
4. Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid: 19.11.2026 at 11:00 hrs.
5. Date & Time of Opening of Financial Bid: To be intimated later
6. Pre-bid Meeting: 16.11.2026 at 16:00 hrs. at SSCL office
7. SSCL reserves right to reject any or all Tenders and/ or cancel/ annul/ keep in abeyance the Auction Process.
8. Any subsequent addendum/corrigendum shall be published at eauction portal **https://etender.up.nic.in** only.

(Company Secretary)

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	ROUGH COST ESTIMATE FOR REPAIR, MAINTENANCE OF (MOTORS, PUMP, STARTER ETC.) BOOSTING STATION OF SECTOR 29,30 IN WARD NO. 30 FOR A PERIOD OF 1 YEARS, DIV. V. + 13 WORKS	10.11.2026 17.11.2026	1,96,31,491/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01292411649 xenmcf5@gmall.com
2	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	ESTIMATE FOR PROVIDING AND LAYING RMC M-25 GRADE AT H.NO.894 TO 911, H.NO.1041 TO 1031, H.NO.1005 TO 1013, H.NO.977 TO 983, H.NO.975 TO 966, H.NO.943 TO 932, H.NO.1061 TO 1053,H.NO. 1030 TO 1020, H.NO.992 TO 987, H.NO.965 TO 964, H.NO.921 TO 925, H.NO.1042 TO 1045, H.NO.1045 TO 920, RAM KIRAT WALI GALI H.NO.1077/40 IN BLOCK C, SGM NAGAR IN WARD NO. -18,(NEW WARD) BADKHAL CONSTITUENCY, FARIDABAD + 12 WORKS	10.11.2026 17.11.2026	3,55,49,371/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01292411649 mcfamrut1@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in **RO No. 50950**

AP POWER GENERATION CORPORATION Ltd.
VS, VIJAYAWADA-520004
(A Govt. of A.P Undertaking)

Notification for AP e-Procurement
TENDER ID. No. 1005275

APGENCO invites open tenders for "R&M of Fly Ash System, Bottom Ash System & Ash Slurry Disposal System for Units 1 & 2 (2 x 210 MW) of Stage-I at Dr. NTTPS, Ibrahimpatnam" through AP e-procurement. **EVC: Rs. 6,49,99,300/-**
Schedule available Date & Time: 10.11.2026 - onwards.
Bid submission Closing Date & Time: 11.12.2026 - 13.00 Hrs.
For further details visit: https://tender.apeprocurement.gov.in

DIPR No: 5552PP/CL/ADVT/1/1/2021-22 Dt:12/11/2026

POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF UTTARAKHAND LTD.
(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Enterprise)
Office of Chief Engineer (O&M), Kumaon Zone, 220KV S/s, Campus, Kamaluaganja, Haldwani-263139
Corporate ID U40101UR2004SGC028675 Phone No. 7088117917

E-Tender Time Extension Notice-1

Due to unavoidable circumstances the date of submission of **E-Tender Specification No. CE/OandM/PTCUL/HLD/68/2026-27, TENDER ID (2026_PTCU9_101141_1)** has been extended upto 26.11.2026, 17:00 Hrs. For more details please visit E-Tender Website ***www.uktenders.gov.in*** and E-Tender time extension notice is available at PTCUL Website ***www.ptcul.org***. All other terms and conditions of the above tenders will remain same. For any assistance on E-Tendering, please contact +91-8899890000

Letter No. 2268/CE(O&M)/PTCUL/HLD/E-Tender
Date : 12.11.2026

Chief Engineer (O&M)
Kumaon Zone
PTCUL, Haldwani

"Save Electricity in the Interest of Nation"

Indira Gandhi National Forest Academy
Ministry of Environment, Forest & Climate Change,
Government of India,
P.O. New Forest, Dehradun-248006
Website: www.ignfa.gov.in/e-mail: director@ignfa.gov.in

ADVERTISEMENT FOR ENGAGEMENT OF IT ASSOCIATE (CONSULTANT "A" & TECHNICAL ASSOCIATE)

Applications are invited for the contractual engagement of IT Associate (Consultant "A" & Technical Associate) in Indira Gandhi National Forest Academy, Dehradun. The detailed terms and condition and application form for contractual appointment of IT Associate (Consultant "A" & Technical Associate) can be downloaded from the website of the Academy form the link given below: **https://www.ignfa.gov.in/contractualengagement**

OIC (IT)
Indira Gandhi National Forest Academy

CBC 13116/11/0005/2627

UP Rajya Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Ltd.
PANKI, KANPUR - 208020
E-Auction Notice
(For Cement Manufacturers, End Users and Traders Only)

1. E-Auction No.- MSTC/LKO/UPRVUNL/1/Panki Kanpur/26-27/42125 Sale of approximately 39.70 lakh MT of Dry Fly Ash generated at 1x660 MW Panki Thermal Extension Project, Kanpur for a period of 05 years through e-auction.

Site Inspection Schedule:- From 07.11.2026 to 21.11.2026.

Date of E-Auction:- 24.11.2026

Time of E-Auction:- 11:30 AM to 03:30 PM.

Website:- www.mstcecommerce.com, Contact no. 8004923173

पत्रांकः 65/1X660 मे०वा० पनकी विस्तार/मु०अभि०/टीएसएचआरडीडी/विज्ञापन/2026 दिनांकः 12.11.2026

"Save Electricity for Nation"

MAHARASHTRA METRO RAIL CORPORATION LTD.
(A joint venture of Govt. of India & Govt. of Maharashtra)
PUNE METRO RAIL PROJECT
Metro Bhavan, Premises of District Court Interchange Metro Station, Nyaymurti Ranade Path, Shivajinagar, Pune - 411005. | Tel.: 020-26051074
e-mail: tenders.pmrp@mahametro.org | Website: www.punemetrorail.org

Tender Notice No.: P2-DDC-05/2026 (NCB) Date: 13/11/2026

Name of Work: Detailed Design Consultancy Services for Depot of Phase 2 and Augmentation of Existing Depots of Phase 1 for Pune Metro Rail Project.

Interested bidders may visit e-Tender portal of Govt. of Maharashtra i.e. **https://mahatenders.gov.in** OR PMRP website **www.punemetrorail.org** to view this tender notice (NIT) and can download the Tender documents and obtain further details regarding the Tender from e-tender portal of Govt. of Maharashtra **https://mahatenders.gov.in** from **16:00 Hrs. on 16/11/2026 to 16:00 Hrs. on 15/12/2026.**

Additional General Manager (Procurement & Contracts)
Pune Metro Rail Project,
Maharashtra Metro Rail Corporation Ltd.

Pune Metro : City's Transport Solution

ग्रेटर नौएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
प्लाट सं. 01, नालेज पार्क-IV, ग्रेटर नौएडा, गौतमबुद्ध नगर, उत्तर प्रदेश-201308
वेबसाइटः www.greaternoidaauthority.in ई-मेलः authority@gnida.in

पत्रांकः ग्रे.नो./(कार्मिक)/2026/599 दिनांकः 12.11.2026

ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

प्रभारी (निविदा सेल), ग्रेटर नोएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण द्वारा मुख्य कार्यपालक अधिकारी, ग्रेटर नोएडा की ओर से ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या– ग्रे.नो./(कार्मिक) 2026/599, दिनांक 12.11.2026 के माध्यम से उल्लेखित क्रम सं. 01 में अंकित कार्य की ई–निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। ई–निविदा की समस्त नियम व शर्तें ग्रेटर नोएडा प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइटः **www.greaternoidaauthority.in** पर ई–निविदा लिंक एवं ई–पोर्टल **https://etender.up.nic.in** पर उपलब्ध है। किसी परिवर्तन, संशोधन व अतिरिक्त सूचनाओं के लिए उक्त वेबसाइट देखते रहें।

क्र. सं.	कार्य का नाम/वर्क सर्किल	अनुमानित लागत
1.	Selection of Project Management Unit to support GNIDA	To be Quoted by Bidder

उक्त कार्य की निविदा दिनांक **13.11.2026 से 23.11.2026 को 17:00 बजे तक** अपलोड किया जा सकता है एवं प्राप्त ई–निविदाओं की प्री–क्वालिफिकेशन बिड दिनांक **25.11.2026 को 11:00 बजे** खोली जायेगी।

विशेष कार्याधिकारी (कार्मिक)

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APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General Public is hereby informed that an unidentified Male namely **Unknown S/o:** Unknown **R/o** Unknown, was found Dead on 04.11.2026, Near Wine Shop, Shastri Park, Delhi. In this regard **DD No. 65A, Dated 04.11.2026,** has been lodged at **Police Station Shastri Park, North-East Distt., Delhi.** Identification of unidentified dead body of male is as under:

Sex: Male, **Age:** Approx 55 Yrs, **Height:** Approx 5'0", **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Identification Mark:** Om Tattoo on Right Hand, **Wearing:** White Printed Shirt, Sweater Yellow & Grey Stripes, Blue Upper & Dark Blue Lower. The dead body of deceased has been preserved for 72 hours in GTB Hospital Mortuary, Delhi for identification.

If any one having any information or clue about this male deceased may kindly be informed undersigned.

SHO,
Police Station Shastri Park,
North-East Distt., Delhi-110053
Ph.: 9548873497

DP/16328/NE/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General Public is hereby informed that one person **Namely: Unknown S/o: Unknown R/o:** Unknown **Sex:** Male, **Age:** 16 Years, **Height:** 4'8", **Face:** Round, **Build:** Medium, **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Wearing:** Blue colour underwear, wear red colour calava in right hand & yellow colour thread in neck. Was found on **Dated: 05.11.2026** Ganda Nala Near Jagatpur Wazirabad Metro Station Delhi. The dead body has been preserved at Subzi Mandi Mortury. In this regard **DD No. 45A, Dated: 05.11.2026,** has been registered at **P.S.: Wazirabad, Delhi.**

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out information about identity of this person but no clue has come to light so far. If any person having any information or clue about this person may kindly inform to the following.

SHO
PS: Wazirabad, Delhi
Ph. 9654964500, 8750870131

DP/16349/N/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING

Karan Nischal

General public is hereby informed that a male namely **Karan Nischal, S/o Jugal Kishore Nishcal, R/o H No. 1/5617, 3rd Floor, Gali No.13, Balbir Nagar, Shahadra, Delhi. has been missing since 05.11.2026 at about 03:45 PM form her home**. In this regard **FIR No. 269/26, U/s 140 (3) BNS, Dated 09.11.2026** has been lodged at Police Station Shahadra, Delhi. The description of missing male is as under:

Name: Karan Nischal, Age: 36 Years, Height: 5'6", Complexion: Shallow, Face: Long, Built: Stong, Wearing: Dark Blue T-Shirt and Cream Color Pant and Sleepers on Feet.

If anyone has any information about this missing male please inform P.S. Shahadra, Delhi.

Web: http://cbi.nic.in, E-mail: cic@cbi.gov.in
Ph.: 011-24368638/24368641, Fax: 011-24368639

SHO
Police Station Shahadra, Delhi
Ph: 8800496955, 7065036027

DP/16282/SHD/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED

PINKI

General Public is hereby informed that one Girl **Namely: Pinki D/o Ganesh, R/o:** SK Jha Ka Makan, Gali No. 01, Sannoth Extension Colony, Village Sannoth, Delhi **Sex:** Female, **Age:** 16 Years **Height:** 5'3", **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Built:** Normal, **Face** Round, **Wearing:** Black colour Suit-Salwar and Sandal in feet has been missing/kidnapped from her house, Delhi since 01.11.2026. In this regard **FIR No. 614/2026, U/s 137(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, Dated: 04.11.2026,** has been registered at **P.S.: Narela Industrial Area, Delhi.**

Sincere efforts have been made by local Police to trace out the missing/kidnapped Girl but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone have any information about this the missing/kidnapped girl, please inform to the following.

E-mail: cic@cbi.gov.in
Website: http://cbi.nic.in
Fax: 011-24368639
Ph: 011-24368638, 24368641

SHO
P.S: Narela Industrial Area, Delhi
Ph. : 9205671121, 7065036324

DP/16333/ON/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING WOMAN

General public is here by informed that this woman (depicted in the Photo) **Namely:** Aarti **W/o:** Vipin Katariya **R/o:** RZF-1/126B, 2nd Floor, Street No. 1, Near Church, Mahaveer Enclave, Part-1, Palam Village, New Delhi **Age:** 27 Years, **Height:** 5 feet 2 inch, **Face:** Long, **Complexion:** Fair, **Built:** Normal, **Wearing:** NA, has been missing since **21.02.2025** at **about 07:30 pm** from her home under area of **P.S. Palam Village, New Delhi.**

In this regard a **FIR No. 606/2025, dated 15.10.2025** has been lodged at **P.S. Palam Village, New Delhi.**

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out information about this woman but no clue has come to light so far.

Any person having any information or clue about this woman kindly inform to the following.

SHO
P.S.- Palam Village, New Delhi
Ph. 011-27892866, 011-27892844, 8750871210

E-Mail: cic@cbi.gov.in
Website: http://cbi.nic.in
Fax: 011-24368639
Ph: 011-24368638, 24368641

DP/16396/DW/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General Public is hereby informed that an unidentified Male namely **Unknown S/o:** Unknown **R/o** Unknown, was found Dead on 21.10.2026, from Footpath Near Surghat, Wazirabad, Delhi. In this regard **DD No. 58A, Dated 21.10.2026, U/S 194 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023,** has been lodged at **Police Station Wazirabad, North Distt., Delhi.** Identification of unidentified dead body of male is as under:

Sex: Male, **Age:** Approx. 45 Yrs, **Height:** 5'7", **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Face:** Long, **Built:** Normal, **Wearing:** Brown T-Shirt, Black Lower. The dead body of deceased has been preserved for 72 hours in Subzi Mandi Mortuary, Delhi for identification.

If any one having any information or clue about this male deceased may kindly be informed undersigned.

SHO,
Police Station Wazirabad,
North Distt., Delhi-110084
Ph.: 8750870131, 9999777520

DP/16408/N/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING

General public is hereby informed that a Male namely **Rohit, S/o: Vinod Kumar Soni, R/o: H.No. B-154, Vikas Kunj, near New Sainik International School, Delhi has been missing since 06.11.2026 at about 12:00 PM from Holy Convent School, Vikas Nagar, Delhi.** In this regard **FIR No. 776/2026, U/s: 140(3) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, Dated: 07.11.2026,** has been registered at P.S. **Ranhola, Delhi.** The description of missing Male is as under:

Name: Rohit, Age: 30 Years, Height: 5'4", Complexion: Wheatish, Face: Long, Wearing: Mehroon Colour T-Shirt, Grey Colour Pant and Slippers in Feet.

If anyone have any information about this missing Male please inform P.S. **Ranhola, Delhi. (Mentally Abnormal)**

Web: http://cbi.nic.in, Email: cic@cbi.gov.in
Ph.: 011-24368638/24368641, Fax: 011-24368639

SHO
Police Station Ranhola, Delhi
Ph: 8750205454, 7065036128

DP/16368/OD/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that an unidentified dead body of male **Namely:** Unknown **S/o:** Unknown **R/o:** Unknown. **Age:** 45 Years, **Height:** 5'3', **Complexion:** Shallow, **Built:** Normal, **Face:** Oval. **Wearing:** White & Pink colour Shirt and Blue colour Pant, who was found dead in under **Pandit Deep Chand Flyover near Britania Chowk, Lawarence Road, Delhi**. In this regard a **DD No. 72A Dt. 10.11.2026**, has been registered at **PS: Keshav Puram, Delhi**.

Any person having any information or clue about the deceased may kindly inform to the undersigned on the following address or telephone nos.

Sd/- SHO
PS: Keshav Puram, Delhi
Tel.: 8750870223, 9968056370

DP/16393/NW/2026
(UIDB)

TIMES BUSINESS

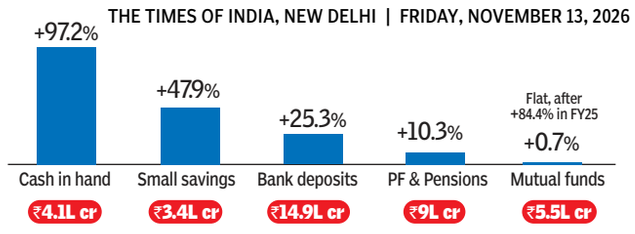
THE TIMES OF INDIA, NEW DELHI | FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 13, 2026

THE THRIFT SHIFT

Households put **₹43.2 lakh crore** into financial assets in 2025-26, **12.8% more than a year earlier.** But the money moved to the familiar segments: cash, small savings and bank deposits grew fastest, while mutual fund flows stalled. **Borrowing rose faster still, pulling net financial savings down to 6.3%** of GDP

WHERE THE MONEY WENT

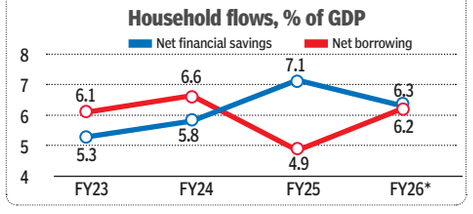
Change in household flows into each category, FY26 over FY25



Note: 'Cash in hand' is the increase in currency held by households (RBI estimate)

NET SAVINGS VS BORROWING

Household flows, % of GDP



THE LEDGER'S OTHER SIDE

- Total borrowing rose 36.7% to ₹21.5L cr; **loans from NBFCs nearly doubled to ₹4.8L cr**
- **SHARES:** Individual investors turned net sellers in the NSE cash market in FY26, **the first time in six years**
- **DEBT:** Household debt reached **45.5% of GDP by Sept 2025,** led by non-housing retail loans

Gross **financial savings still rose to 12.5% of GDP in FY26 from 12% in FY25;** households are setting aside more, but borrowing faster

Source: RBI Bulletin (Oct 2026), RBI Financial Stability Report (June 2026), NSE Market Pulse | *FY26 data preliminary

RBI may hike rates by up to 50 bps in FY27: Economists

See Pressure From Food Inflation, Higher Commodity Prices

Shiva.Rajora@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: Economists expect the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to raise key policy rates after the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) meeting in early Dec to check rising inflation. Following its first policy rate hike in over three years in Oct, they expect the MPC to raise the repo rate by another 25-50 basis points during the current financial year (100 basis points equal a percentage point).

An increase in repo rates, the rate at which banks borrow from RBI overnight, will translate into a rise in EMIs on home and other loans, while helping depositors earn more.

Dipti Deshpande, principal economist of Crisil Ratings said inflation is expected to average 5.3% in 2026-27, with risks tilted on the upside as food inflation continues to surprise on the upside. "The implications for MPC are clear and (I) expect RBI to retain its tightening bias and see scope for another 25bps hike in Dec review meeting," she said.

SBI said the odds have decisively shifted towards a 25-basis points (bps) rate hike in Dec instead of 50 bps projected earlier, driven by four key factors: A more stable rupee, revival in capital flows, softer oil price outlook and easing US Treasury yields. "Importantly, expectations of three-to-four successive rate hikes, which had gained traction earlier, now appear to be an outlier. We expect the Dec hike to be followed by a more data-dependent policy approach."

CareEdge Ratings economist Rajani Sinha also expects a 25bps rate hike in Dec. Echoing similar views, ICRA chief economist Aditi Nayar said with the CPI inflation set to remain above 6% and GDP growth likely to ease only slightly in Q2, a further 25 bps rate hike in Dec appears almost certain. "Thereafter, the trajectory of crude oil prices, which have cooled in the recent sessions, will be critical in shaping the need for and extent of additional rate tightening in 2027," she said.

"(RBI's) Oct policy stance indicates its preference for addressing emerging inflationary pressures and anchoring inflation expectations, with a scope of 25bps hike in Dec review meeting," she said.

Kotak Mahindra Bank chief economist Upasna Bhardwaj, however, said with inflation expected to remain elevated above 6%, amid adverse base effect from GST, higher food prices and partial pass through of higher commodity prices, RBI is expected to hike rates by 50 bps in 2026-27, with further upside risks likely if food inflation flares up significantly or benign oil prices reverse trajectory.

Elara Capital economist Garima Kapoor expects an increase of another 50 bps over next six-to-nine months as inflation is unlikely to cool off immediately, as pass through of previous hikes continues. HDFC Bank principal economist Sakshi Gupta also expects a cumulative 50 bps hike in coming months, with RBI expected to deliver a 25 bps rate hike at both its Dec and Feb meetings.

EXPERT VOICES

"The implications for MPC are clear and expect RBI to retain its tightening bias and see scope for another 25bps hike in Dec review meeting" —CRISIL RATINGS

"(RBI's) Oct policy stance indicates its preference for addressing emerging inflationary pressures and anchoring inflation expectations, with a scope of 25bps hike in Dec" —KNIGHT FRANK INDIA

"We expect Dec hike to be followed by a more data-dependent policy approach" —SBI

Federal Bank, BoB raise rates on select deposits

Mumbai: Banks have raised rates on select fixed deposits in Nov, with Federal Bank increasing the senior citizen premium to 0.60 percentage points from 0.50 and Bank of Baroda hiking rates by 10 bps on its 555-day scheme.
Federal Bank now offers senior citizens 7.40% on callable deposits and 7.50% on non-callable deposits of Rs 1 crore and above. For a 35-month tenure, effective annualised yields are 8.18% and 8.30%, respectively. The revised rates apply from Nov 12 to select deposits below Rs 3 crore.
Bank of Baroda's bob Golden Goal scheme now offers 6.85% to general depositors, 7.35% to senior citizens and 7.45% to super senior citizens. TNN

Norwest raises $4bn fund, to expand India investments

Mumbai: US-based Norwest has raised a record $4 billion fund, its largest in 65 years, to expand investments in India, particularly in manufacturing, industrial services and healthcare. It currently deploys $250-350 million annually in the country. Norwest 18 takes the firm's capital under management to $18 billion and will fund venture and growth equity investments across technology, healthcare and consumer sectors in the US, India and Israel. The firm has maintained steady investments across market cycles for two decades, said Niren Shah, managing director and head of Norwest India. "Norwest is currently deploying around $250-350 million annually in India, which is higher than the earlier levels of investment. Norwest remains very bullish on India's long-term prospects," he said. TNN

Ola Electric loss narrows in July-Sept, revenue dips 41%

Bengaluru: Ola Electric's net loss narrowed year-on-year to Rs 362 crore in the Sept quarter, helped by lower expenses, as the electric two-wheeler maker shifts to dealers and winds down its company-run stores. Total income fell 40.7% to Rs 448 crore from Rs 756 crore a year earlier. Compared with the June quarter, the loss widened from Rs 336 crore, while total income declined from Rs 484 crore. Total expenses fell to Rs 639 crore from Rs 893 crore a year earlier. Finance costs declined to Rs 63 crore from Rs 109 crore. A revision in the estimated useful lives of certain assets reduced depreciation expenses by Rs 38 crore during the quarter. TNN

Six states witness retail inflation crossing 7%

▶ From P 1

In as many as six states, retail inflation crossed the 7% mark, with southern states — Tamil Nadu and Telangana (7.3%), Andhra Pradesh (7.25%) and Karnataka (7.1%) leading the way. Rural inflation (6.6%) tended to be higher given the higher weight of food items in the basket, as compared to the urban areas (5.4%).

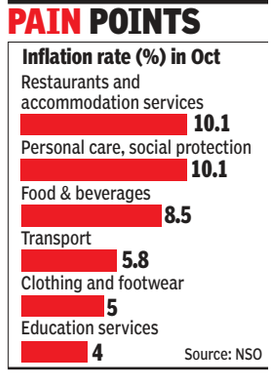
ICRA chief economist Aditi Nayar expects food inflation to remain elevated in Nov, with upward pressure emanating from milk, sugar and onion prices, along with a deficient monsoon and inadequate replenishment of reservoir levels, which have heightened concerns regarding the rabi crop.

Bank of Baroda chief economist Madan Sabnavis said core inflation is also expected to rise in months ahead as FMCG companies have started raising prices, along with an increase in the cost of mobiles, TVs, vehicles and healthcare.

NSO data showed that the impact of higher oil prices due to the prolonged conflict in West Asia, despite softening crude prices in recent days, is showing up in sectors such as transport (5.8%) and restaurants (10.1%) which are seeing steady acceleration in costs.

PAIN POINTS

Inflation rate (%) in Oct



Source: NSO

Make India your address, a safe place: Goyal to investors

Visakhapatnam: Commerce and Industry minister Piyush Goyal on Thursday sought investments from global investors, urging industries to focus on quality and sustainability. Addressing the CII Partnership Summit 2026 here, he said India is a safe destination for investments, amid the current global uncertainties.

Calling upon investors, he said "make India your address" for the next factory, design centre, and global capability centres . The minister also urged trading partners to explore business opportunities in India as the country provides huge prospects in multiple sectors. "....Invest in factories, hotels, and data centres because India is a safe destination," he said.

The minister said in last four-and-a-half years, India has finalised nine Free Trade Agreements covering 38 developed countries that represent $60 trillion of global GDP. He said with the ongoing engagements (on trade pacts), the total is likely to increase to $85 trillion -- roughly three-fourths of the global GDP of $115 trillion. "This opens vast opportunities for Indian businesses, products, services, talent and the country's 2.5 lakh startups," he said.

He further said India will have one of the "best" trade deals with the US in every respect, adding, India has negotiated a very good set of outcomes with the US in the pact.

Goyal asked Indian industry to stay ahead on sustainability, skilling and global quality standards. When asked about a timeline for the pact, he said the agreement is under discussion and there are many factors which determine these outcomes. AGENCIES

Will keep options open on tariffs: USTR

Washington: USTR Jamieson Greer said on Thursday that he is going to keep options open on tariffs and he looks forward to working with Congress when Democrats take control of the Senate and House of Representatives in Jan. "We're going to keep taking trade actions as necessary. ... I think we've seen nuanced language from some members up there about tariffs that make sense and tariffs that could be helpful. So I think there's room to work with them," he told CNBC. REUTERS

Kia to invest $2bn in 2nd Andhra plant

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: A $2 billion investment by Kia and its suppliers will fund the carmaker's second plant in Andhra Pradesh, increasing its annual production capacity in India by nearly 47%.

Kia announced the investment after signing a memorandum of understanding with the state govt. The new plant in Anantapur is expected to start production in early 2030 and add capacity for 2 lakh vehicles a year. Kia's existing plant, also in Anantapur, can make 4.3 lakh vehicles annually. The second facility will take that figure to 6.3 lakh.

The new plant and its suppliers will occupy a combined 465 acres. Kia expects the project to create about 12,000 direct and indirect jobs. The company put the combined investment by Kia and its suppliers across the two plants at up to $5 billion, including the $2.9 billion initially invested in the first facility.

Kia's new facility will make combustion-engine and electric models. Like the existing facility, it will handle stamping, welding, painting and final assembly. Kia's current production line-up in Anantapur includes the Seltos, Sonet and Syros, as well as the Carens and Carens Clavis. The company already makes electric versions of the Syros and Carens Clavis there.

OpenAI lets biz to get AI requests processed in India

Aabhas.Sharma
@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: OpenAI on Thursday said eligible businesses can now have some of their AI requests processed on servers in India. The option could help banks, payments firms and other companies that need to keep certain data within the country when using AI. OpenAI already offered eligible customers the option to store data in India. The change is that the model can now process supported requests here too. If a company asks the model to summarise an internal document, for instance, the computing needed to read the document and generate the summary can take place in India.

The service initially covers OpenAI's GPT-6 Luna model and is available to businesses and developers that use the company's API to build AI into their own software. To use it, customers need to set up a new project and select India as the location for both data storage and processing. The rollout is limited to direct API customers.

Soota backs healthcare biz with fresh funds

Earmarks ₹500cr For Happiest Health To Push Growth, Focus On Digital Initiatives

Shilpa.Phadnis
@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: At 83, Ashok Soota remains upbeat about his healthcare venture, backing it with fresh funds to accelerate growth. He has earmarked Rs 500 crore from the proceeds of the sale of his stake in Happiest Minds to ITC Infotech for technology investments at Happiest Health over the next five years. About half of this amount will go towards its digital health business, Happiest Digital Health, the company's fifth business unit, which will begin with a portfolio of 11 digital applications to be rolled out over the next 18 months.

Soota said a substantial part of the Rs 1,330 crore proceeds from the sale of his 22.1% stake in Happiest Minds to ITC Infotech would be channelled into healthcare initiatives, including Happiest Health and nonprofit entity SKAN Research Trust. He had previously committed Rs 200 crore to SKAN, which focuses on ageing and neurological research.

"Investment will come from the proceeds of the ITC Infotech transaction. Even after the merger, I will remain in the single largest individual shareholder in the merged entity. My technology connection will continue. It's a very important part of the business."

Digital health is a fast-growing segment of healthcare, expected to reach $1.8 trillion globally by 2033, growing at 25% annually, he said. The move is also aimed at overcoming the geographical limitations of physical healthcare providers.

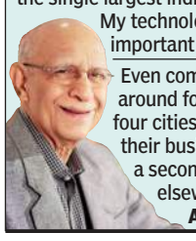
"Even companies that have been around for 30 years are present in only two, three or four cities. Some of the largest players derive 44% of their business from one city and another 40% from a second city, with only a small presence elsewhere. So nobody can reach out too far," Soota said.

He said the digital health business would draw on the medical expertise developed within Happiest Health, with doctors guiding the design and clinical content of individual applications. Happiest Minds is developing the technology, including small language models (SLMs), while medical inputs will come from specialists.

The company is placing particular emphasis on diabetes management through DiaBeater, a doctor-led, AI-assisted application that uses glucose-monitoring technology. India has more than 100 million people living with diabetes, making continuous care a significant opportunity, Soota said. Dr Kashinath, who heads the endocrinology practice at Happiest Health and has 28 years of experience, including at the UK's NHS, is guiding the medical framework for the application.

Other planned offerings include Pediatric Expert and Cardio Edge. The company is also launching ColonE, a gut microbiome test that uses next-generation sequencing to analyse microbial DNA from a stool sample. The process generates about 5GB of data, which is used to prepare a report that nutritionists draw on to guide dietary and lifestyle changes. ColonE is a wellness offering, not a diagnostic test.

"Investment will come from the proceeds of the ITC Infotech transaction. Even after the merger, I will remain the single largest individual shareholder in the merged entity. My technology connection will continue. It's a very important part of the business"



"Even companies (healthcare) that have been around for 30 years are present in only two, three or four cities. Some of the largest players derive 44% of their business from one city and another 40% from a second city, with only a small presence elsewhere. So nobody can reach out too far."
Ashok Soota | CHAIRMAN, HAPPIEST HEALTH

Niti: PLI schemes got ₹2.4L cr, 76% of target investment

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: The production linked incentive (PLI) schemes have facilitated investments worth Rs 2.4 lakh crore till March 2026, which is 76% of the total Rs 3.2 lakh crore target, along with boosting exports by Rs 15.2 lakh crore and generating nearly 14 lakh jobs, a latest study by Niti Aayog assessing the impact of the schemes said Thursday.

"Sector-wise assessment of the PLI schemes indicates that nearly 70% of the targeted segments are broadly on track, with particularly strong outcomes emerging in electronics, telecom and pharmaceutical drugs," the report said.

Speaking at the event, Niti Aayog CEO Anurag Jain said real manufacturing GVA increased from Rs 34.8 lakh crore in 2022-23 to Rs 47.5 lakh crore in 2025-26, registering a CAGR of 10.9% over this period. "Sustaining this momentum is essential for strengthening India's manufacturing sector," Jain added.

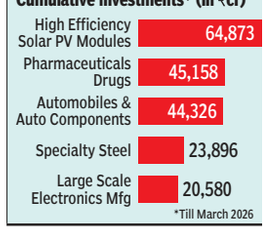
He also added that the department is in discussion with ministries to tweak the PLI schemes to address gaps in domestic mfg and reduce India's continued dependence on imports. "On the whole, we still have dependence on imports. We are trying to tweak the PLIs," Jain added.

Niti Aayog vice chairman Ashok Lahiri said manufacturing has long been recognised as an engine of employment, innovation and productivity-led growth. "For India, as it advances towards the vision of Viksit Bharat @2047, strengthening manufacturing capabilities will be central to sustaining high, inclusive and broad-based growth," Lahiri said.

SECTORS IN FOCUS

Top 5 sectors with investments received

Cumulative Investments* (in ₹cr)



*Till March 2026

Zee Ent eyes ₹600-cr share repurchase

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Mumbai: Zee Entertainment Enterprises is launching a Rs 600-crore share repurchase programme, a move that will increase the stake of the broadcaster's promoters, the Subhash Chandra family, who currently own 3.99% in the company.

Zee will buy back 6.86% of its equity capital at Rs 91 per share, a premium of about 23% to its closing price of Rs 74 on the BSE on Thursday, when the company announced the scheme after trading hours. The company said its promoters will not participate in the buyback.

With the promoter group staying out, its stake will rise after the buyback as the total number of outstanding shares declines. Non-promoters, comprising institutional and public shareholders, own 96% of the company.

Chairman R Gopalan said the board believes the company's intrinsic value is not adequately reflected in the current market valuation and that the buyback underscores confidence in Zee's long-term growth prospects. Zee has a market capitalisation of Rs 6,800 crore, making the proposed Rs 600-crore buyback equivalent to 9% of market value.

Smartphone sales fall 20% by volume

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New Delhi: Offline smartphone sales fell 18–20% by volume during the Diwali season, according to the All India Mobile Retailers Association (AIMRA), even as sales value stayed flat. The slowdown was visible earlier throughout the festive season. Counterpoint Research estimated that smartphone sales volumes fell 20% year-on-year across the first two waves of festive sales through late Oct, covering Navratri and Dussehra.

Days after Diwali, two Indian smartphone brands are raising prices by up to Rs 3,000. Ai+ Smartphone has already pushed two models past the Rs 10,000 mark, while Lava will raise prices from Nov 15. Both companies cited higher memory costs.

The hikes come as the entry-level market is shrinking sharply. Shipments of smartphones priced below Rs 10,000 fell 65% year-on-year in the first half of 2026, according to Counterpoint. The segment accounted for just 4% of overall shipments in April–June, down from 18% in July–Sept 2025. The pressure extended to costlier phones in the Sept quarter, when shipments below Rs 20,000 fell 47% year-on-year, compared with a 20% decline for the overall market.

Ai+ raised prices by Rs 1,000 to Rs 3,000 on select variants on Nov 11. The 4GB RAM and 64GB storage versions of its Pulse 2 and Pulse 2 FE went from Rs 8,999 to Rs 10,999, an increase of about 22%. The company brought forward the hike by four days, citing higher memory and other component costs for fresh stock.

Lava said ongoing memory shortages had prompted a price increase of up to Rs 3,000 across its smartphone portfolio from Nov 15. It said festive prices would remain available online and in stores until the revision takes effect.

Counterpoint said rising DRAM and NAND memory costs had already triggered several rounds of handset price hikes, leaving brands less room for deep festive discounts. Higher prices have led some shoppers to delay upgrades and made financing and trade-in offers more important for those still looking to buy.

FAILING TO CONNECT

18–20% fall | Offline smartphone sales during the Diwali season

20% fall | Smartphone sales year-on-year in the first two festive waves, till Oct 28

65% fall | Shipments of phones under Rs 10,000 year-on-year in Jan–June 2026

Source: AIMRA; Counterpoint Research

India at centre of global tech strategy: Costco

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Hyderabad: US retail giant Costco has put India at the centre of its global technology strategy as it works towards a target of $500 billion in revenue by 2033, global chief information and digital officer Javier Polit said during his first visit to the country in the role.

The $300 billion retailer opened its first-ever global capability centre (GCC) in Hyderabad (became operational around Feb-March this year) after evaluating multiple international locations on talent depth, geopolitical factors and ecosystem maturity. "This is the very first GCC that Costco has in our young 50 years," Polit told **TOI**. He said India stood out because of its large technology workforce, more than 2,000 existing GCCs and a strong pipeline of engineering graduates. The decision, he said, was "purposeful, strategic and intentional".

With Costco seeking to make its digital landscape "as agile as that of a tech company" over the next decade, Polit added that the GCC in India will also support modernisation of its legacy systems in addition to driving key tech and digital initiatives.

He said Costco may also consider expanding its technology footprint beyond Hyderabad and could look at a second facility in India in the future. The company's global technology organisation has about 3,000 employees, with around 2,500 based at its headquarters in Issaquah, Washington. Dallas is its next-largest technology location, with a few hundred employees.

Polit stressed that the India GCC is not being built as a low-end delivery unit. The team is already working on strategic programmes across North America, Europe and Asia, on artificial intelligence, data analytics, cybersecurity, SAP, warehouse management systems, supply chain digitisation and robotics.

"We don't look at this team in India as just a satellite team. They contribute and work on all the same strategic initiatives that our central team in the US does."

TIMES GLOBAL

THE TIMES OF INDIA, NEW DELHI | FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 13, 2026

DUA LIPA TO BECOME FIRST FEMALE BRIT HEADLINER AT COACHELLA; 100,000 FANS EXPECTED TO ATTEND FEST IN APRIL IN CALIFORNIA

LOVE'S LIKE THE MEASLES - ALL THE WORSE WHEN IT COMES LATE IN LIFE — DOUGLAS JERROLD

DAYS AFTER RUSSELL BRAND IS SENTENCED TO JAIL FOR RAPE, META DISABLES HIS FACEBOOK, INSTA ACCOUNTS

'Spy' at heart of Nvidia scandal is in Beijing

Her Engagements In China, Purpose And Schedule Of Travelling To Its Capital Remain Unknown

The suspected Chinese spy at the centre of Nvidia scandal has returned to her home country, people familiar with the matter said. Megaspeed International founder Alice Huang is currently living in Beijing with the knowledge of security officials, one of the people said, asking to remain anonymous. It wasn't clear when or why she travelled to the capital, nor what she may be engaged in, the people said.

Alice Huang's whereabouts have been the topic of intense speculation since Nvidia's founder Jensen Huang admitted to an extra-marital affair and the company's board began an investigation into allegations she's a Chinese spy. Known also as Huang Le, the former scribe, who became a power broker renting advanced chips to the nation's top firms, was the catalyst for a controversy that roiled markets and led to the ouster of Jensen Huang. Beijing has denied that the woman was a spy. China's foreign ministry didn't immediately respond to a request for comment.

AFP/File

A screengrab shows Alice Huang (R) Jensen Huang in Taipei last year

Alice Huang first came into the CEO's orbit after founding Megaspeed, the largest buyer of Nvidia's chips in Southeast Asia — a major route for smuggling the firm's advanced hardware into China. She oversaw the incredible ascent of a fledgling neocloud, which rose to become one of Nvidia's most important partners in the regional data centre boom. Attempts to reach her were unsuccessful Thursday.

Online posts and publicly available information have provided the broad contours of Megaspeed's rise, and the critical role she played in that.

She founded Megaspeed in 2023 following a career in private equity and television. The company was spun off from one of China's largest video game enterprises, 7Road Holdings Ltd., just months after former US President Joe Biden imposed sweeping restrictions on shipments of advanced AI chips to China. 7Road first sold its Singapore subsidiary to a British Virgin Islands entity called Huang Le Ltd., and Huang Le assumed control.

In Nov 2023, Huang Le Ltd. sold Megaspeed to a Singapore shell company. Days after the sale, the firm was designated an official Nvidia Cloud Partner — a highly coveted status that granted it preferred chip access from a company that plays kingmaker to the industry.

Trade records show that Megaspeed has since imported goods worth more than a thousand times its cash balance in 2023. Its imports of Nvidia products have topped $4.6 billion. At multiple facilities in Southeast Asia, the company rents Nvidia chips to Alibaba Group Holding Ltd., itself a recent subject of US national security concerns.

S'pore bars Alice from entry

Singapore said it barred Alice from re-entering the country in Feb and gave her a "stern warning" after finding insufficient evidence to prosecute her. Alice "provided information which she knew to be inaccurate" to Singaporean authorities to downplay her role in the company during a probe into its operations, the ministry of home affairs said Thursday. It said she wasn't investigated for espionage.

Alice was a Hong Kong resident and wasn't based in Singapore. Her passport was returned on Feb 26 and she left Singapore that day, the ministry said. "Singapore does not condone companies using their association with Singapore to circumvent or violate other countries' export controls through fraud," the ministry said.

The Singaporean authorities, which had been looking into whether Megaspeed violated local laws, briefly detained Alice in 2025, inviting her in for questioning and restricting her from leaving the country. Megaspeed said the island nation's probe hasn't produced any adverse findings for the firm. Singapore returned her passport later, a source said.

Alice entered Taiwan 8 times

Alice visited Taiwan a total of eight times in 2024 and 2025 while had a relationship with Jensen, a Taiwanese govt minister said Thursday. Taiwan, a key player in the global semiconductor industry, sits at the centre of strategic competition between US and China, which claims the self-ruled island as part of its territory. Alice used a Hong Kong passport to enter Taiwan "under a standard business visitor status" and there were "no special flags" about her at the time, mainland affairs council minister Chiu Chui-cheng told lawmakers.

US using spy claims to justify tech 'blockade': China

Beijing accused US Thursday of using spurious spying claims as a pretext to impose a technological "blockade" on China. "China's technological progress is driven by independent innovation. US should stop fabricating such 'spy' narratives for imposing a technological blockade," foreign ministry spokeswoman Mao Ning said. AGENCIES

▶Continued from P1

India remains ahead of Syria and Mexico. whose nationals accounted for around 5.9 lakh citizenships in OECD countries each during the five-year period 2020–2024.

Interestingly, while China was the sixth largest source country whose nationals acquired OECD member country citizenship, the numbers fell by nearly 12% to 3.4 lakh in 2020-24 as compared to the previous five-year period. OECD comprises 38 member countries – notably US, UK, European nations, Australia, Canada, Japan and South Korea.

According to additional data shared with **TOI**, during 2020-2024, OECD member countries embraced nearly 87 lakh new citizens – Indians constitute around 10% of its new citizens. In the previous five-year period, nearly 65 lakh individuals acquired citizenship of an OECD member country – once again the composition of Indians was 10%.

OECD also shared year-on-year India-specific data with **TOI**, showing that 2.3 lakh Indians acquired citizenship of OECD member countries in 2024, mainly in Canada (87,320), US (48,820) and Australia (28,969). In 2023, the overall India-figure was marginally lower at nearly 2.2 lakh, with the same three countries accounting for most of the citizenship acquisitions.

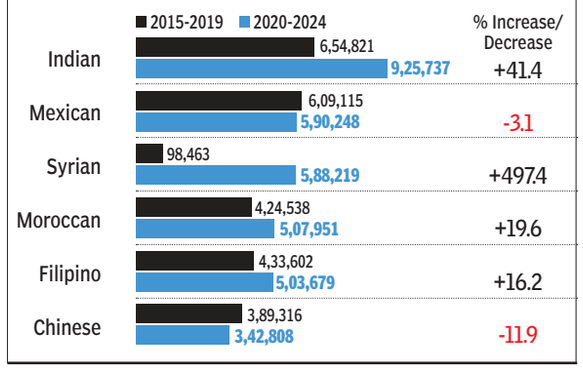
The latest figures underline the growing permanence of Indian migration to advanced economies. While immigration flows measure the number of people moving to another country, citizenship acquisitions offer an indication of how many immigrants have progressed to acquiring the nationality of their destination country.

Indians also continued to move to OECD member countries for work and study, although the pace of migration slowed. India remained the largest origin country of new migrants to OECD member countries in 2024. However, the number of Indian-origin migrants moving to OECD member countries fell by 19% in 2024, from 6.1 lakh in 2023 to 4.9 lakh in 2024.

"Migration remains high, and immigrants now account for 16% of employment across the OECD," Mathias Cormann, OECD secretary-general said. "With ageing populations and slower productivity growth, countries cannot afford to waste the skills migrants bring. That means helping migrants move into jobs where they can contribute most, and giving immigrant entrepreneurs better access to finance, networks and business support," he added.

One in five STEM graduates across OECD member countries is foreign-born, and immigrants are over-represented among researchers and founders of innovative firms. Yet immigrants are also more likely to work in lower-productivity sectors, with their skills often underutilised, states OECD. The report finds that immigrant's contribution to productivity depends on how effectively countries make use of their skills – many countries have expanded programmes to attract highly skilled workers. The gap between Indian and Chinese students studying in OECD member countries narrowed, with 8.3 lakh Indian students and 8.5 lakh Chinese students studying in these countries.

OECD countries took nearly 87L new citizens during 2020-2024



Trump pulls Vance off Iran talks to focus on corruption

Washington: President Donald Trump said Thursday US does not need a deal with Iran and directed V-P JD Vance, who has played a role in efforts to resolve the war, to focus "his complete and total attention" on alleged crime and corruption in Democratic-run cities and states.

Trump's directive came a day after the Wall Street Journal reported that Vance was considering face-to-face peace talks with a hard-line Iranian security official and a week after the vice president blamed the costly war with Iran for Republicans' midterm elections drubbing. "We don't need a deal with Iran. Those days have long since passed. We've got their money, Hundreds of Billions of Dollars, and we've got their Strait!" Trump wrote on social media, referring to the Strait of Hormuz. Vance's office did not immediately respond to a request for comment. REUTERS

Huang's 2nd affair fallout shakes up US

Chidanand Rajghatta | TNN

Washington: A second alleged extra-marital affair brought down Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang Thursday after the company board initially appeared to stand by him following glowing testimonials from President Donald Trump, who repeatedly vouched for his character despite reports of his being entrapped by a Chinese spy.

The Nvidia board's Nov 8 statement had struck a reassuring note, expressing confidence in Huang and asserting there was no reason to believe that Nvidia's national security or corporate secrets had been compromised, while announcing an independent investigation into the matter. Four days later the confidence evaporated after the second alleged affair, which company insiders were apparently aware of, was leaked to the NYT.

Beyond the turmoil at Nvidia, where Huang's two adult children, Madison and Spencer, have director-level roles, there is now considerable embarrassment for President Trump, who invested political capital vouching for Huang's character. He called him an "honourable man" and a "great guy who… has done an amazing job for our country." Hours after Huang quit, Trump did not address the scandal but said in a post on Truth Social, "NOW THAT Nvidia CEO JENSEN HUANG, who has done a fantastic job, has resigned, there is only one man to take his place - TIM COOK of Apple. A Legend replaces a Legend!"

But the fallout from the scandal goes beyond the Nvidia boardroom and the tech world. It is already shaking up Washington's political establishment, drawing in Trump's cabinet secretaries, some of whom were at odds with each other, as intelligence reports emerged over the past year about Huang's affair with the alleged Chinese spy. Democrats are also champing at the bit to begin investigations and hearings into the matter.

According to several accounts, it was secretary of state Marco Rubio, who is also the US national security adviser, who supervised a classified intelligence memorandum warning the administration about Huang's relationship with an alleged Chinese spy. Rubio is also reported to have personally briefed Trump aboard Air Force One in May, before Huang joined the presidential delegation in Alaska for the onward flight to China.

The controversy has also drawn in commerce secretary Howard Lutnick and treasury secretary Scott Bessent. According to a report in Axios, Bessent raised the question of the administration's failure to place Megaspeed, allegedly a front company Alice Huang worked for, on the commerce department's Entity List, which would restrict its access to American technology. Lutnick, who, like Huang, has argued that excessive restrictions risk sacrificing commercial opportunities and provoking a trade war, reportedly muttered that he needed to check with Trump.

Trump himself has been careful about ratcheting up temperature on the affair given an upcoming meeting next week with China's President Xi Jinping at the Apec summit in Shenzhen, and Nvidia's criticality to not just American tech primacy but also to the US stock market, a Trump obsession which he seems to believe is an indicator of economic health.

Would be an honour to hire Jensen: Musk

Elon Musk said it would be an honour to hire Jensen Huang, who resigned as Nvidia CEO. Musk, CEO of Tesla Inc., and Huang have known each other for at least a decade, and both men joined US President Trump's high-profile visit to China earlier this year. Musk previously expressed his admiration for Huang and said he expected to continue ordering chips from Nvidia. Nvidia is a key supplier of graphics processing units to Tesla, which uses them to train AI models for autonomous driving and robotics. BLOOMBERG

Putin suggests no compromise in meeting with US envoys

Vladimir Putin indicated Thursday that Russia will not compromise on its hardline demands to end the Ukraine offensive, but offered a short-term ceasefire in a key frontline city during a Kremlin meeting with US envoys. The Russian president said he would not water down his demands to control parts of Ukraine that Russia claims to have annexed and ruled out agreeing to foreign peacekeeping troops in Ukraine — a deployment that he said would be a "continuation of war".

Washington's envoys, Jared Kushner and Steve Witkoff, were in Moscow after two days of peace talks in Abu Dhabi. Putin's comments appeared to douse hopes that a peace deal could be within reach, after Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky said there was a "window of opportunity" to achieve "a result" before 2027.

The Americans, meanwhile, urged Putin to allow European representatives to sit at the table for the next round of talks. Moscow has successfully managed to reframe the discussions on the war as part of a wider discussion about European security. But Kyiv and European leaders have urged against a new "Yalta" — a reference to the WWII-era deal to carve the continent into spheres of influence after the war — and said Russia must stop hostilities first. Witkoff and Kushner are to travel to Dublin now for talks with Zelensky. AFP

State was 'safe' for GOP but Colom refused to budge

▶Continued from P1

What followed was nearly a century of segregation, poll taxes, literacy tests, lynchings and violent resistance to Black political participation as Mississippi became synonymous with some of America's ugliest racial chapters.

There is an Indian connection to this history that goes beyond Nair's movie, which explored the unlikely relationship between Mina (Sarita Chowdhury), the daughter of Indian immigrants expelled from Idi Amin's Uganda, and Demetrius, an African American carpet cleaner played by Denzel Washington early in his career.

In 1935, Howard Thurman, the African American theologian and civil rights intellectual who grew up in the segregated South, travelled to India with a delegation and met Mahatma Gandhi in Feb 1936. Their discussions about racial oppression, freedom and non-violence helped transmit Gandhian ideas into the American civil rights movement. Thurman subsequently influenced Martin Luther King Jr, who drew deeply from the Gandhian philosophy of non-violent resistance. Even more strikingly, Indian freedom fighter and social reformer Kamaladevi Chattopadhyay spent 18 months travelling across America between 1939 and 1941. On a journey through the segregated south, she encountered the indignity of racial segregation on an American train in next door Louisiana, where a conductor challenged her presence in a whites-only carriage. Refusing to move, she recognised a kinship between the struggles of African Americans and Indians against systems of racial and imperial domination. Her observations, later recorded in 'America: The Land of Superlatives, offer a remarkable Indian perspective on the American south.

Mississippi was the first state to send a Black person to Congress, Hiram Revels (L), who joined the Senate in 1870. He was followed by Blanche Bruce in 1875, who was born in slavery in 1841

Reuters

Scott Colom will be sworn into office in Jan, 146 years after Bruce left office. And because both Revels and Bruce were chosen by state lawmakers, Colom is the first Black senator in the state's history to be chosen by voters

Colom is very much in that Gandhian mould. A civil rights lawyer, municipal judge, and three-term district attorney, he was given no chance in the election considering Trump had won the state by 23% in 2024 and Hyde-Smith had won her previous election by seven points. Virtually every poll had classified her seat as safely Republican. But he refused to budge. In fact, such was Hyde-Smith's hubris that she declined repeated invitations to debate Colom, sneering that he would not be able to fill a room if she was not present.

Trump himself may have sensed some trouble though when polls showed the race narrowing in the final days, making his first visit to Mississippi in seven years to campaign for her. "I'm here because Cindy's doing great, but I just got to make sure. I can't take a chance," he said.

On Wednesday, Colom took his chance and drove Hyde-Smith out of the Senate with a stunning victory that was built on kitchen table issues rather than bloviating about ballrooms. A seventh-generation Mississippian, his campaign masterstroke was a 30-second ad built around Hyde-Smith's response to complaints about soaring beef prices: consumers, she suggested, had plenty of other proteins to choose from. Colom's ad, echoing the "let-them-eat-cake" smackdown, featured incredulous Mississippians delivering the devastating rejoinder: rather than choose another protein, they would choose another senator.

On Thursday, Democrats were dancing in the aisles even as MAGA minions were panicking at the prospect of Colom becoming a "national threat" to GOP as one Fox News commentator put it — bigger than Democratic Congresswoman Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez. Colom himself offered a characteristically restrained response to suggestions that he could become a national political star: Mississippi first; no masala please.

Martin Luther King Jr's historic 1963 'I Have a Dream' speech also refers to Mississippi. Some excerpts:

"I have a dream that one day on the red hills of Georgia, the sons of former slaves and the sons of former slave owners will be able to sit down together at the table of brotherhood

"I have a dream that one day even the state of Mississippi, a state sweltering with the heat of injustice, sweltering with the heat of oppression will be transformed into an oasis of freedom and justice

"I have a dream that my four little children will one day live in a nation where they will not be judged by the color of their skin but by the content of their character. I have a dream today

"I have a dream that one day down in Alabama… little Black boys and Black girls will be able to join hands with little white boys and white girls as sisters and brothers. I have a dream today…

Hegseth and staff rebuked by guard

A soldier guarding the Tomb of the Unknown Soldier issued a verbal reprimand to a group of advisers and staffers with defence secretary Pete Hegseth following a Veterans Day ceremony at Arlington National Cemetery. Video shows Hegseth taking photos on empty steps in front of the tomb with his wife, chief of staff, deputy chief of staff and a senior adviser. As the group broke from taking photos, a loud laugh could be heard, and the soldier guarding the tomb shouted that "all visitors will maintain an atmosphere of silence and respect at all times." AP

DAILY PLANET

AP

WHEN THEY MET: Iceland's PM Kristrun Frostadottir and French President Emmanuel Macron during a round table meeting of the European Political Community (EPC), in Dublin, Thursday

Two French guards collapse as Macron welcomes Slovak prez at Elysee Palace

Two members of France's elite Republican Guard collapsed almost simultaneously outside the Elysee Palace as President Emmanuel Macron welcomed his Slovak counterpart, according to televised images and a presidential source. As is customary for the arrival of foreign heads of state, the Republican Guards formed an honour guard in full ceremonial dress with sabres for the arrival of Slovak President Peter Pellegrini late Wednesday. One guard can be seen swaying before crashing to the ground, falling against a pillar at the Elysee Palace. Aides and Macron immediately rushed towards the stricken guard. Le Parisien daily said that a second guard collapsed off camera. A French presidential source, who asked not to be named, told AFP that both guards had suffered from "fainting attacks". The Republican Guard, part of the French gendarmerie, are responsible for guards of honour in France which often involve standing for long periods in heavy clothing while holding their sword upwards vertically.

A Romanov sapphire bracelet sells for $4.9m

A Romanov sapphire weighing nearly 198 carats on a diamond-covered bracelet sold for more than 4.1 million Swiss francs ($4.9 million) at auction, vastly higher than the expected price range, Sotheby's said. The cushion-shaped sapphire attributed to onetime ownership of Russia's imperial family was billed as a very rare stone,

Cartier mounted the sapphire on a bracelet it is seen on today

and had been expected to fetch between $1m and $2m at the Geneva auction Wednesday. The buyer wasn't identified. The 197.80-carat Ceylon sapphire likely came from the Mughal empirea and made its way into Russia's imperial jewels in the 19th century.

NYC bldg collapse kills 8, injures 17

Eight people were killed and at least 17 others were injured when a three-storey apartment building in Brooklyn collapsed, NYC mayor Zohran Mamdani said.

Emergency crews Thursday morning were searching for people trapped in the debris after working through the night. Three firefighters were among the injured, according to a city official. The building — located at 1321 Flatbush Avenue, near the intersection with Bedford Avenue in central Brooklyn — collapsed shortly after 4pm Wednesday, bringing down part of the structure and trapping people inside the rubble, fire commissioner Lillian Bonsignore said. After the incident, the city issued a stop work order for the adjoining lot where a nine-storey building with a cellar had been proposed, according to city building records. The order cited unsafe construction operations that resulted in the collapse of the neighbouring building.

AFP

First responders search for victims in the rubble in Brooklyn

Seven of the people treated by emergency workers as of Wednesday night were children, Bonsignore said. She declined to disclose their ages or say whether any of the people killed were children. Officials don't yet know how many people were inside the building when it collapsed or how many remain unaccounted for. The adjoining building remains partly intact. BLOOMBERG

1 dead in shooting near White House

Washington: A gunman killed a man inside a busy gym during morning workouts Thursday before fleeing and shooting four more people, shocking a popular capital neighbourhood and attracting a swarm of police officers who ascended to the roof of the building to find him.

He fatally shot himself while holed up in his penthouse apartment, where he had been speaking by phone with police negotiators, said Jeffery Carroll, interim chief with the metropolitan police department. He was identified as a medical doctor locked in a dispute with building management over mold and moisture problems in his seventh-floor unit, court records show. Mayor Muriel Bowser said she was "devastated" at the loss of life. The shootings occurred around 8am in Logan Circle, about a mile (1.6km) north of the White House.

Reuters

Law enforcement officers at the site of a shooting in Washington

Much of the block on 15th Street Northwest was cordoned off as police urged people to avoid the area, which includes the VIDA Fitness center, St. Luke's Episcopal Church, residences and a Whole Foods store. Schools were locked down.

Law enforcement SWAT teams and other officers had their guns drawn on the roof of an apartment building and on the ground below. Carroll said one man died at VIDA and another victim was in critical condition. Authorities have preliminarily identified the shooter as Matt Lambert, according to two law enforcement officials. AP

TIMES SPORT

THE TIMES OF INDIA, NEW DELHI | FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 13, 2026

VICTOR WEMBANYAMA SCORES 32 POINTS TO LEAD SPURS TO 10TH STRAIGHT NBA WIN

MIRRA ANDREEVA STUNS ARYNA SABALENKA IN STRAIGHT SETS TO ENTER WTA FINALS SEMIS

TIME FOR SOME MODIFICATIONS

As Some Regulars Leave To Prep For The Test Series, Shreyas Iyer Must Juggle Lineup Options On ODI Captaincy Debut Today...

Hindol.Basu@timesofindia.com

BCCI

IN THE SADDLE: Shreyas Iyer with coach Gautam Gambhir during a training session. India need a win to seal the One-day series

IND VS NZ 4th ODI

With the Test series beginning on Nov 19, both India and New Zealand are having to juggle their resources, leaving their ODI combinations considerably different for the final two matches of the five-match series.

Friday's fourth ODI at the Bay Oval in Mount Maunganui will see Shreyas Iyer take over the India captaincy, while New Zealand turn to a clutch of fresh faces as both teams look to find the right balance between immediate 50-over commitment and preparation for the longer format.

The scheduling leaves the teams with little room for manoeuvring. The fifth and final ODI is on Nov 15, giving the players just three days before the opening Test in Wellington. Both camps have therefore split their resources, with several established players and members of the support staff moving to the Test set-up. The changes also present an opportunity to examine the depth of the ODI squads heading into the 2027 World Cup.

India, who lead the five-match series 2-0 after the third ODI was washed out, will be looking to seal the contest. But the absence of regular skipper Shubman Gill, KL Rahul and Anshul Kamboj means the visitors will wear a different look. Iyer, who was Gill's deputy in the first three matches, will captain the side for the first time in ODIs.

The batting order is likely to see some reshuffling. With Gill unavailable, it will be interesting to see who opens alongside Rohit Sharma. The options on that front are Ishan Kishan and Ruturaj Gaikwad, who has batted in the middle order in his last five ODI innings.

Virat Kohli and Iyer provide the experience, while the availability of Tilak Varma gives India another option in the middle order. The team management will be keen to see how these combinations work, particularly with Kishan also expected to take over the wicketkeeping responsibilities in Rahul's absence.

Iyer, meanwhile, has a personal challenge to address. He has struggled to get going in the series, with the extra bounce and seam movement bringing his vulnerability against the short ball into focus. A change of conditions could offer some relief.

Will Siraj get an opportunity?

India's bowling combination will also be worth watching. With Kamboj having moved to the Test camp, Mohammed Siraj could get an opportunity to play in only his second international match since the tour of Sri Lanka in Aug. Arshdeep Singh, Gurnoor Brar and Auqib Nabi will shore up India's pace department. Also, Kuldeep Yadav remains available if India decide to go in with a frontline spinner. The decision will depend partly on the surface, which is expected to be more conducive to batting than the ones in the first two matches.

New Zealand, on the other hand, have made several changes to their squad. Test captain Tom Latham, Daryl Mitchell, Glenn Phillips, Nathan Smith and Henry Nicholls have left for red-ball preparations, with Finn Allen, Mitch Hay, Dean Foxcroft, Nick Kelly and Brett Randell coming in. The hosts will have to rebuild parts of their batting order and find the right combination.

The hosts will also hope the conditions allow their batters more freedom. The first two ODIs were played on seam-friendly surfaces, where the movement and bounce made run-scoring difficult. The weather forecast for Friday is clear, with no rain in the immediate lead-up to the match.

FACE-OFF

NZ vs IND

TV TIME: 7.30 AM

SONY SPORTS

SONYLIV

HEAD TO HEAD

NZ	IND
52	65

LAST FIVE MATCHES

NZ	NR	L	L	L	W
IND	NR	W	W	L	W

VENUE: MOUNT MAUNGANUI

WEATHER 19°C

ODDS

NZ	IND
8/1	1/10

22 Runs needed by Virat Kohli (1,978 runs at an average of 56.51 in 38 innings) to become the first batter to reach the 2,000-run milestone against NZ in ODIs. —**Stats:** Rajesh Kumar

2 India have won two of the three ODIs they have played against New Zealand in Mount Maunganui. India notched up victories by 90 runs (Jan 26, 2019) and seven wickets (Jan 28, 2019) while New Zealand's lone win at the venue came by five wickets on Feb 11, 2020.

26.40 Shreyas Iyer's batting average in ODIs this year, having scored 264 runs in 11 innings. His only half-century is a 66 against England at Cardiff on July 16. Shreyas Iyer's lone overseas ODI century in 38 innings is the 103 he scored against New Zealand in Hamilton on Feb 5, 2020.

'India's pace attack works well as a unit'

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AFP

Impressed by the way India's young pacers have operated in tandem, New Zealand wicketkeeper-batter **Tim Seifert** has credited their variety and discipline for making the Indian attack a formidable unit in the ongoing ODI series.

India's seamers have played a key role in their 2-0 lead, bowling New Zealand out for 185 and 134 in the first two matches. Seifert, on Thursday, said the different skills of Arshdeep Singh, Anshul Kamboj, Gurnoor Brar and Auqib Nabi had complemented each other effectively.

"They all bring something different. Having Arshdeep as a left-armer is crucial as well. They have different qualities but they work well as a unit," Seifert said, complimenting the attack's ability to maintain discipline on surfaces that have offered a "good amount of assistance" to seamers. "To their credit, they didn't miss much on those wickets in the first two games. Their consistency in hitting the right areas has made run-scoring difficult," he said.

Seifert was equally impressed by how India's relatively inexperienced bowlers have adapted to the New Zealand conditions. "They've come to New Zealand and adapted to these wickets quickly. Hats off to them. At this level, you've to adapt to the conditions and the players you are up against, whether it's Australia, England or India," the opening batter said.

PANT CLEARS FITNESS TESTS, ON WAY TO JOIN TEAM FOR TWO TESTS IN NZ

New Delhi: Wicketkeeper-batter Rishabh Pant has passed a fitness test and left to join the national team in New Zealand for the upcoming two-Test series. **TOI** had earlier reported that Pant had been declared fit and was only awaiting the results of simulation tests. The 29-year-old, who last played for India in Aug, was sidelined with a left-side strain. He was named in India's squad last month pending the fitness clearance. On Thursday, Pant posted a picture of an airplane wing in an Instagram story, with emojis indicating he was flying to New Zealand. Pant will be available for selection for the first Test. TNN

Raichandani's 93 takes India to final; to face Pak

ACC

Al Amerat (Oman): Skipper Lakshya Raichandani struck 93 as India beat Afghanistan by eight wickets in the semifinal on Thursday to set up a final clash against Pakistan in the under-19 Asia Cup here. Once pacer Ishan Sood-led Indian bowlers restricted Afghanistan to 227/8, victory for India was always a formality.

Raichandani's 90-ball innings (13x4, 1x6) ensured that India reached the target in just 36.5 overs.

U-19 ASIA CUP

Earlier, Pakistan defeated Bangladesh by nine wickets to book their berth in the summit clash. Pakistan, incidentally, have earlier beaten India in the group stages of this event. The final will be held on Nov 14.

Raichandani was hardly troubled by Afghanistan bowlers, who have actually done quite well in this tournament. The right-hander never really looked in a rush, made runs at a strike-rate over 100. His first fifty came off just 39 balls. Raichandani added 117 runs in 17 overs with opening partner Aaryavir Sehwag (51) and 77 with VK Vineeth (57*) for the second wicket.

Earlier, Sood took three wickets (3/43) and the spinners spun a web around opposition batters in the middle overs. For Afghanistan, Noman Salarzai and Shah Faisal Rahimi made 51 each but they struggled for momentum. PTI

BRIEF SCORES: India U-19 230/2 (Raichandani 93, Vineeth 57*, Sehwag 51, Sohail 1-56) beat Afghanistan U-19 227/8 (Sarafzai 51, Rahimi 51, Sood 3-43) by 8 wickets.

'Thought my chance would come in red-ball cricket first'

AP

BIG BREAK: Auqib Nabi bowls during the first ODI

Surprised By ODI Selection, Nabi Is Now Eager To Showcase His Skills On The Biggest Stage...

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Red-ball cricket has been his calling card but it was the white ball that eventually brought Auqib Nabi his India breakthrough. Having built his reputation through domestic performances in the longer format, the Jammu & Kashmir medium-pacer believed Test cricket would be his route into the national side. Instead, the selectors had a different plan, taking the 30-year-old by surprise.

"I wasn't expecting a white-ball call-up, to be honest. I thought my opportunity would come in red-ball cricket, in the Test format. But I see this (playing ODI cricket for India) as a great chance to showcase my skills," Nabi said ahead of the fourth ODI between India and New Zealand.

After a difficult ODI debut against the West Indies in Sept, where he conceded 84 runs without success on a flat Guwahati surface, Nabi has found conditions more to his liking in New Zealand. He has taken two wickets so far in his first four ODIs, both coming in India's rain-affected victory in Wellington.

In this short stint with the national team so far, there has also been a learning curve for Nabi. Bowling in New Zealand for the first time, he is focusing more on getting seam movement rather than conventional swing. "This is my first time bowling in New Zealand, so the conditions are a little different. You have to rely more on seam movement because top-level batters can play swing well. That was the feedback from Rohit *bhai*, Virat *bhai* and Shubman. If you bowl a scrambled-seam delivery or hit the deck hard, there is a greater chance of taking wickets here," he said.

'Conditions similar to J&K'

Interestingly, Nabi does not find the conditions entirely unfamiliar. The weather and surfaces in New Zealand, he believes, have similarities with those back home in Jammu & Kashmir. "The weather is quite similar because we experience comparable conditions back home as well. The main difference is the level of opposition. International cricket is different from domestic cricket, but the wickets are quite similar," he said.

The soft-spoken Nabi may not be blessed with express pace, but is confident that other attributes in his game can help him succeed at the highest level. "Of course, having extra pace is always an advantage. But I back my skills. I have performed well with them in domestic cricket, and I believe those strengths will help me at this level too," he said.

Cricket Australia boss Boon backs Cummins' leadership

Melbourne: Cricket Australia (CA) chairman David Boon has backed Test captain Pat Cummins and said his job is not under threat over the allegations in Usman Khawaja's book about his role in the 2018 ball-tampering affair.

Boon said Cricket Australia (CA) had full confidence in Cummins' leadership as a player of integrity. "We absolutely support Pat," Boon told the *Australian* on Thursday. "He's been an exemplary captain, he's led the team with integrity and led very successfully."

SANDPAPERGATE SCANDAL 2018

Cummins has yet to respond to Khawaja's allegations but posted on X that he would be happy to speak to the media on Friday. "I've taken some time to try and better understand the long list and full extent of Uzzy's allegations so I can respond properly," he wrote.

White-ball captain Mitchell Marsh, who was in the Test team in 2018, meanwhile declined to comment in Perth on Thursday, saying it was not time for him to share his story. But he acknowledged that there was still a lot of people "hurting" over the scandal.

"I respect (Khawaja) for telling his story and for writing his book, and I don't sit here coming from a place of judgment on any of that," Marsh said ahead of an ODI against England. "Everyone's got their story. Some will be willing to share it and others might not, purely on the basis of the fact that they've moved on. It's really important that at some stage we do."

Meanwhile, former Australia batting coach Graeme Hick dismissed Khawaja's account as "absolutely false". "In regard to any discussions around the ball-tampering in Port Elizabeth or Cape Town that took place, I will say in true honesty that I did not hear or know anything," he told the *Sydney Morning Herald*.

Oz to unleash new pace talent Beardman

Australia will unveil their new pace bowling hope Mahli Beardman in the first of three ODIs against England in Perth on Friday, with skipper Mitchell Marsh calling him "an amazing talent".

Ness backs idea of moving IPL up to Jan

New Delhi: Punjab Kings co-owner Ness Wadia has endorsed KKR co-owner Juhi Chawla's idea of starting the IPL in Jan, provided there is scope for a change of schedule. Chawla wants the IPL to kick off earlier than the usual March-end start.

Anderson signs up for Surrey at 45

London: England great James Anderson will play county cricket at age 45 after signing a season-long deal with Surrey on Thursday, weeks after ending his 25-year stint at Lancashire. "I still feel like I have a lot to offer," Anderson said. AGENCIES

Debutant Saqib takes 7 as SL collapse in Pindi

Rawalpindi: Rain and bad light hit the first Test between Pakistan and Sri Lanka after pacer Saqib Khan took seven wickets on debut to lead the home team's fightback on Thursday. Saqib grabbed an impressive 7-130 on an overcast morning to spark a Sri Lankan collapse which saw the tourists slumping from their overnight 404-4 to 446 all out.

PAK VS SL 1st TEST

Pakistan, who conceded a first innings lead of 12 runs, were 57-1 when bad light and then rain stopped play 45 minutes into the second session.

Opener Azan Awais and Mohammad Taha were the unbeaten batters with 22 and 24 respectively, with the home team now leading by 45 runs with nine wickets intact. Pakistan had lost opener Tayyab Arif just before lunch.

With more rain forecast for Friday, the Test is heading for a draw, leaving the series result on the second and final match, also in Rawalpindi from Nov 17.

BRIEF SCORES: Pakistan 434/9 decl and 57/1 vs Sri Lanka 446 (D de Silva 167, Kusal 119, S Khan 7-130). AGENCIES

Ambekar, Gunjan strike gold

Bag Boxing Honours In Historic First

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olympics.com

Ambekar and Gunjan

Kolkata: Indian boxing enjoyed a golden day at the Youth Olympic Games as Lairenlakpam Ambekar Meetei became the country's first-ever Youth Olympic boxing champion and Gunjan became the first Indian woman boxer to win a gold medal at the Games in Dakar on Thursday.

YOUTH OLYMPICS

While Ambekar edged Ireland's Kristian Jubani 3-2 in a dramatic men's 50kg final, Gunjan sealed the women's 48kg title with a dominant 5-0 victory over Algeria's Bouthaina Bensalah.

Until now, Shiva Thapa was the only Indian boxer to have reached a Youth Olympic final, winning silver at the inaugural edition in Singapore in 2010. Sixteen years later, Ambekar not only emulated that achievement but went one step further by clinching gold.

Manipur's Ambekar's final did not begin according to script, with the Irish boxer taking the opening round on all five judges' scorecards. But the Indian gradually increased the tempo in the second round, forcing a standing eight count on Jubani that swung the momentum firmly in his favour.

The Manipur boxer then carried that momentum into the third and final round, landing a crunching right hand that appeared to drain the Irishman's reserves. His strong finish proved enough to convince three of the five judges. While two judges scored the bout for Jubani, including one by a 30-27 margin, the remaining three awarded it 29-28 to Ambekar, sealing a dramatic 3-2 split-decision victory.

The title capped a memorable campaign for the youngster, who had entered the Games on the back of a silver-medal finish at this year's World Boxing Futures Cup.

Ambekar had earlier defeated Senegal's Cheikh Ibrahima Fall Faye, and Namibia's Abraham Kaleng.

PT Usha keeps IOA fight alive

Back In Poll Fray As Ice Hockey Nominee

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New Delhi: PT Usha has refused to leave the Indian Olympic Association (IOA) presidential race without waging one last fight. After losing out on a direct entry into the IOA General Assembly by finishing fifth in Monday's contentious Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit (SOM) elections and missing the four women's places, Usha has found an unlikely ally in the Ice Hockey Association of India (IHAI), as its women's representative.

Adopting the National Sports Federation (NSF) route, Usha is the IHAI's women's nominee in the provisional electoral college for the IOA Executive Council (EC) elections on Dec 5, released by electoral officer Sanjay K Srivastava on Thursday. Harjinder Singh is the association's male nominee. The move is a pointed response to those who believed her SOM defeat had ended her bid for a second term as IOA chief.

The SOM setback had triggered a protest from Usha. She lodged four complaints with the electoral officer. In a Nov 9 letter to International Olympic Committee (IOC) president Kirsty Coventry, she sought an independent examination and asked whether govt or external influence had been exerted.

The provisional list has its own flashpoints. At the All India Tennis Association (AITA), interim president Chintan Parikh and Rushmi Chakravarthi figure as representatives, but IOA's current EC member Rohit Rajpal is missing.

Rajpal has objected, alleging Parikh bypassed an AITA executive committee meeting and secured approval through an advisory group. He questioned why Leander Paes was not included and Parikh's name sent instead.

Another issue is at the Indian Weightlifting Federation (IWLF), where its president Sahdev Yadav has nominated himself as male representative and his wife, Sabina Yadav, as the female nominee. Former Athletics Federation of India (AFI) chief Adille Sumariwalla, who withdrew from the SOM contest, is back alongside Jyotirmoyee Sikdar, and remains an aspiring candidate for IOA's top post.

Tennis fed first picks Paes, then drops him

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Pune: The All India Tennis Association (AITA) interim president Chintan Parikh was on Thursday at the receiving end of harsh criticism from federation members after an advisory group replaced initial pick Leander Paes with Parikh himself as a nominee to the IOA electoral college.

IOA ELECTIONS

"There was a meeting of the advisory group for nominations today again. As a last minute development, there is a change in the nominations... all the members (of the advisory group) have unanimously decided to nominate Chintan Parikh as male representative and Rushmi Chakravarthi, from Sportsperson of Outstanding Merit roster, as female representative," Parikh informed the AITA members, a source told **TOI**.

When contacted, Parikh said in a written statement: "Mr Leander Paes was uncertain about his availability (on the day of IOA elections). Today being the last date, urgently the Nominations Advisory Group meeting was called and it was decided unanimously that as it is customary to nominate the president of AITA for the electoral college of IOA." It is understood that Davis Cup captain Rohit Rajpal, who is also a vice-president in the AITA interim committee, had expressed his wish to be nominated citing his experience.

GALLERY

Sen, Srikanth enter quarters at Japan Open

Kumamoto: Kidambi Srikanth and Lakshya Sen advanced into the singles quarterfinals at the Kumamoto Masters Japan badminton. Srikanth stunned fifth seed Kodai Naraoka of Japan 21-15, 11-21, 21-18 to set up a clash with Koki Watanabe. Meanwhile, Lakshya defeated Dong Tian Yao of China 21-8, 21-14 to reach the quarterfinals. He will face Japan's Yushi Tanaka. Meanwhile, women's doubles pair of Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand lost 21-14, 21-14 to Rin Iwanaga and Kie Nakanishi in the round of 16.

Pragg, Erigaisi begin fast classical campaign with draws at Total Chess: R Praggnanandhaa and Arjun Erigaisi drew both their games played in the fast classic format at the Total Chess Pilot in Budapest. Meanwhile, Praggnanandhaa's sister Vaishali Rameshbabu started off with a loss to Maxime Vachier-Lagrave before bouncing back with a draw against the same opponent. Pragg and Erigaisi ended the day with two points each, while Vaishali bagged just one.

Gangte scores a hat-trick in U-17 Asian Cup qualifiers: Dallalmoun Gangte scored a hat-trick as India began their AFC U-17 Asian Cup 2027 qualifiers with a 4-2 win over Singapore in Kuala Lumpur. Ristik Maity scored the other goal for India.

FIH threatens to suspend HI: According to a letter reportedly sent by FIH to Hockey India, the world governing body has raised concerns over alleged outside interference in the federation's affairs and warned of possible suspension. The warning follows the Odisha high court's intervention in HI's electoral process, adding to the ongoing governance concerns and potentially putting India's international hockey participation at risk.

Sinner working to put on weight after tonsil operation: Jannik Sinner said he lost a lot of weight after having his tonsils removed and is now working at rebuilding phase as he continues to work towards his return from a knee injury. His knee issue has kept him out since July.

Luiten leads after Rd 1 at season ending World Tour C'ship: Joost Luiten carded a round of 5- under 67 to take the first round lead at the season-ending World Tour Championship golf in Dubai. Meanwhile, Rory McIlroy carded 3-under 69 to lie in third place and two strokes off first-round leader Luiten. AGENCIES

ACTION TODAY

Badminton: Kumamoto Masters: 6:30 am (Fancode); **Cricket:** NZ vs India, 4th ODI 7:30 am (Sony); Aus vs Eng, 1st ODI 9 am (Fancode); Pak vs SL, 1st Test, fifth day 10 am (Veto); **Football:** Nations League 10:30 pm and 1:15 am (Sony); **Golf:** Dubai 12:30 pm (Sony).

CARRY THAT WEIGHT

Pochettino Move Being Finalised As Carrick Becomes The Fall Guy

Manchester: Michael Carrick is the latest in a long line of managers to be sacked by Manchester United as they struggle to recapture former glories, but their problems run far deeper than the dugout. For the first time in 40 years, the 20-time English champions find themselves in the Premier League relegation zone at this stage of the season.

Carrick was handed the job on a permanent basis fewer than six months ago after revitalising the team following the acrimonious Jan departure of Ruben Amorim.

USA head coach Mauricio Pochettino's move is being finalised, with a deal agreed, according to the BBC. He probably faces the task of uniting a deeply divided club on and off the pitch. Pochettino's The Argentina-born coach has reportedly informed the US Soccer Federation of his desire to take over as United manager.

Carrick's role as a player in the glory days under Ferguson meant he retained support among the fanbase despite a string of substandard displays. The anger of the supporters is instead firmly directed towards the club's owners, whom they hold responsible for overseeing United's slide.

The Manchester United Supporters' Trust (MUST), meanwhile, issued a statement following Carrick's dismissal pinning the blame for poor results firmly on the ownership. United last dropped out of the top division in 1974. REUTERS

POCHETTINO'S WAITING TIME
There were four occasions on which Pochettino has been linked with the United job. ●As a successor to Van Gaal in 2016. ●Viewed as long-term replacement for Mourinho in 2018. ●On their shortlist when Erik ten Hag was appointed in April 2022. ●Again, after Ten Hag exit in Oct 2024.

"YOU CAN KEEP CHANGING THE MANAGER AND THINKING THAT'S GOING TO BE THE ANSWER. (IF) YOU'VE NOT GOT LEADERSHIP THAT IS STRONG RIGHT THROUGH THE SPINE OF THE FOOTBALL CLUB YOU WILL FAIL."
— Gary Neville, FORMER UNITED PLAYER

LIST OF UNITED MANAGERS SINCE FERGUSON RETIRED

7 Michael Carrick was their seventh permanent boss since Alex Ferguson retired after guiding the club to their last league title in 2013.

David Moyes | **In charge:** July 1, 2013-April 22, 2014 (10 months) **Trophies won:** 1 (Community Shield)

Louis van Gaal | **In charge:** July 16, 2014-May 23, 2016 (22 months) **Trophies won:** 1 (FA Cup)

Jose Mourinho | **In charge:** May 27, 2016-Dec 18, 2018 (31 months) **Trophies won:** 3 (Europa League, League Cup, Community Shield)

Ole Gunnar Solskjaer | **In charge:** Dec 19, 2018 (On interim basis, made permanent in Mar 2019) - Nov 21, 2021 (35 months) **Trophies won:** 0

Ralf Rangnick (interim) | **In charge:** Dec 3, 2021-May 22, 2022 (6 months) **Trophies won:** 0

Erik ten Hag | **In charge:** May 23, 2022-Oct 28, 2024 (29 months) **Trophies won:** 2 (FA Cup, League Cup)

Ruben Amorim | **In charge:** Nov 11, 2024 - Jan 5, 2026 (14 months) **Trophies won:** 0

Michael Carrick | **In charge:** Jan 13, 2026 - Nov 12, 2026 (10 months) **Trophies won:** 0

Caretaker and interim managers for a month or less: **Ryan Giggs** 2014 (1 month); **Michael Carrick** 2021 (12 days); **Ruud van Nistelrooy** 2024 (13 days); **Darren Fletcher:** 2026 (9 days)

US pulls out team from U-17 WC in Qatar for security reasons

Geneva: The United States soccer body pulled its team from the Under-17 World Cup in Qatar for security reasons, FIFA confirmed on Thursday. Qatar and the Gulf region have been on high security alert since the United States military attacks on Iran started in Feb, though an F1 race is scheduled in Doha this month. The 48-nation tournament kicks off in Doha next Wednesday.

'FC Andorra keeper uncertain of return after De Miguel tragedy'

Madrid: FC Andorra goalkeeper Jesus Owono is yet to decide whether he will return to competition, the club's manager Carles Manso said, following the tragic death of Tenerife forward Jesus de Miguel on Nov 3. "We will give him space so that he feels completely free to make any decision, whether he wants to return, when, or if he does not want to return," Manso said.

Five-star New Zealand hammer India in Auckland

Marcus.Mergulhao @timesofindia.com

On a day Anirudh Thapa captained India for the first time in six years and goalkeeper Vishal Kaith made his first national team appearance since a forgettable outing last June, it was the defence that needed a closer look.

In the absence of the reliable Anwar Ali, India coach Khalid Jamil was forced to pair Bijoy Varghese with Pramveer at centre-back, while Abhishek Singh started on the right. Collectively, the three India defenders have 20 appearances between them.

The All Whites, playing in all black, dominated to carve a 5-0 win in the first international friendly at the Go Media Stadium in Auckland on Thursday. For New Zealand, this was their biggest winning margin over non-Oceania opposition since the 1980s, including a 6-1 win over Malaysia in 1984 and 5-0 victory over Saudi Arabia in 1981. The defeat was India's third big one in a row after home losses against Brazil (0-4) and Uruguay (1-6).

India face All Whites next on Sunday in what will be the first-ever international football match at One New Zealand Stadium in Otautahi Christchurch.

ATP Finals: In-form Alcaraz remains the player to beat

Turin: Alexander Zverev won more of the big titles this year and has the No. 1 ranking. It's **Carlos Alcaraz**, though, who goes to the ATP Finals as the player to beat. That's because Alcaraz, who missed 4 ½ months in the middle of the year due to a right wrist injury, has displayed the best form lately.

While Zverev arrives on a two-match losing streak, Alcaraz comes to Turin on a 10-match winning run after titles in Vienna and Paris and is hungry to raise the trophy at the Finals for the first time after losing to Jannik Sinner in last year's final.

"This is a tournament that I really want to win one day," Alcaraz said after beating Ben Shelton in the Paris Masters final last weekend. The Finals, the season-ending event for the year's top eight men's players, starts on Sunday in Turin.

Vivaan clinches trap silver, Oly quota

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Pune: There was history riding on Vivaan Kapoor as he competed for gold in the men's trap event at the ISSF World Championships in Doha on Thursday. The Jaipur shooter fell short of gold but still made history, winning silver and an Olympic quota place for the Los Angeles Games.

At 24, Vivaan became the fourth Indian to win a World Championships medal in trap and the second, after Dr Karni Singh, to claim silver. Manavjit Singh Sandhu remains the only Indian to have won gold in the event. Zoravar Singh Sandhu's bronze is India's other trap medal at the Worlds.

It was also the first time two Indians reached a trap final at the World Championships. Udaivir Singh Jaijee joined Vivaan in the eight-man final and finished sixth. "I was a little nervous, but I managed to hold my nerve. I didn't put pressure on myself during the shoot-offs because I've had a lot of shoot-off practice with our coach Peter Wilson in training. I followed my routine and tried to do my best," Vivaan told **TOI**.

To me, medal is priceless, for them, it was just gold

MM Somaya

That week we were in our home in Kodagu, a little away from Madikeri town. On Oct 28, by the time I returned from my morning walk, our Bengaluru neighbours called to inform about a break-in at our place. My first thought was about my medals, especially the 1980 Moscow Olympics gold, because those were the only precious items which I felt we had left at home. As my wife drove us to Bengaluru, I spent much of the journey calling my niece and then the police, who put me at ease by telling me not to panic.

As the police worked on collecting forensic evidence, I kept asking my family who had gone in what they could actually see. The medal boxes were there, they said, but the medals were missing. I still hoped they were under the pile of clothes left behind.

My heart sank when I walked into the house. First, at all the strewn clothes, then at the broken cupboard lock. The empty boxes of medals made me feel very sad because I cherished them so much; they carried so many memories and sentiments, and to me, they will always be priceless.

I remember when I came back from Moscow, people often asked about the medal. But over time, fewer people asked to see it. Maybe the importance of Olympic sports had declined as other sports took over, but all that didn't seem to matter at this moment.

My worst fear was never seeing the medals again, losing them forever. And that would have been a huge blow because they were the only prize we received for winning the Olympics at Moscow. I felt a great dread that I would never get them back and that they wouldn't be recovered.

I feels the people who took it away likely didn't know its sporting value. For me, it was priceless, for them, it was gold. It could end up at a pawn shop or worse, just be melted down. That thought gnawed away inside me.

Despite the sinking feeling, I immediately began running other scenarios through my mind — whether I could apply to the International Olympic Committee for a replacement medal. At the same time, there was that smidgen of hope that lingered because the police had given me their assurance.

In the two weeks between the break-in and Wednesday's recovery, I was assailed by a lot of nostalgia. The day we won, Zafar Iqbal and I were taken for a dope test immediately after the medal ceremony. Once back in the Games Village, I was so exhausted that I slept without changing. The medal had stayed around my neck!

I looked back at the youngster in me, who wore an oversized India kit (I was a thin boy) and went out to play.

I thought back with gratitude because that was my first time playing for India. I had never been out of the country, I had never played on artificial turf.

Days with our coach, Balkrishan Singh, and captain V Baskaran came back to me, and how they had faith in me. I wasn't in the initial playing XI and was one of the two substitutes, more like an understudy. We played a few practice matches against local clubs, and both felt I should be in the XI, which I'd never dreamt I would be in.

TOI Exclusive

It's where my career took off. The trust they showed in me meant I probably never sat on the bench for almost nine years that followed.

I also learnt hard lessons. When my parents were around, the Olympic gold never left the bank locker, but over time I started keeping it at home, and sometimes even carried it in my pocket to events. In hindsight, I feel I did an injustice to the medals by keeping them at home. Once the court releases them, they will go straight into the locker!

(Former Indian hockey captain MM Somaya is an 1980 Olympic gold medallist. He spoke to **Manuja Veerappa***).*

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VARIETY
EU PROPOSES TOUGHER RULES FOR INFLUENCERS AND DIGITAL PLATFORMS
P2

Delhi Times

FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 13, 2026
ADVERTORIAL, ENTERTAINMENT INDUSTRY PROMOTIONAL FEATURE

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OF INDIA

BACK BEAT
RUSSELL BRAND'S INSTA GOES DARK AFTER CONVICTION
P4

BALMAIN

swiss watches

Scan to find the nearest retailers

SEDIREA

Also Available At: Tata CliQ Lux and Myntra

BALMAIN

swiss watches

SEDIREA

Scan to find the nearest retailers

Also Available At: Tata CliQ Lux and Myntra

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OF INDIA

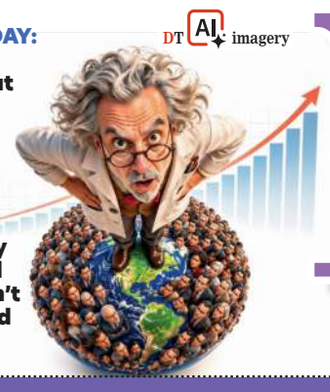
Film body seeks probe after *Pyre* loses 75% screens P1

A TV series featuring football ace Ronaldo? It's happening P4

HOT TAKES

Ariana and Ricky make it red carpet official P4

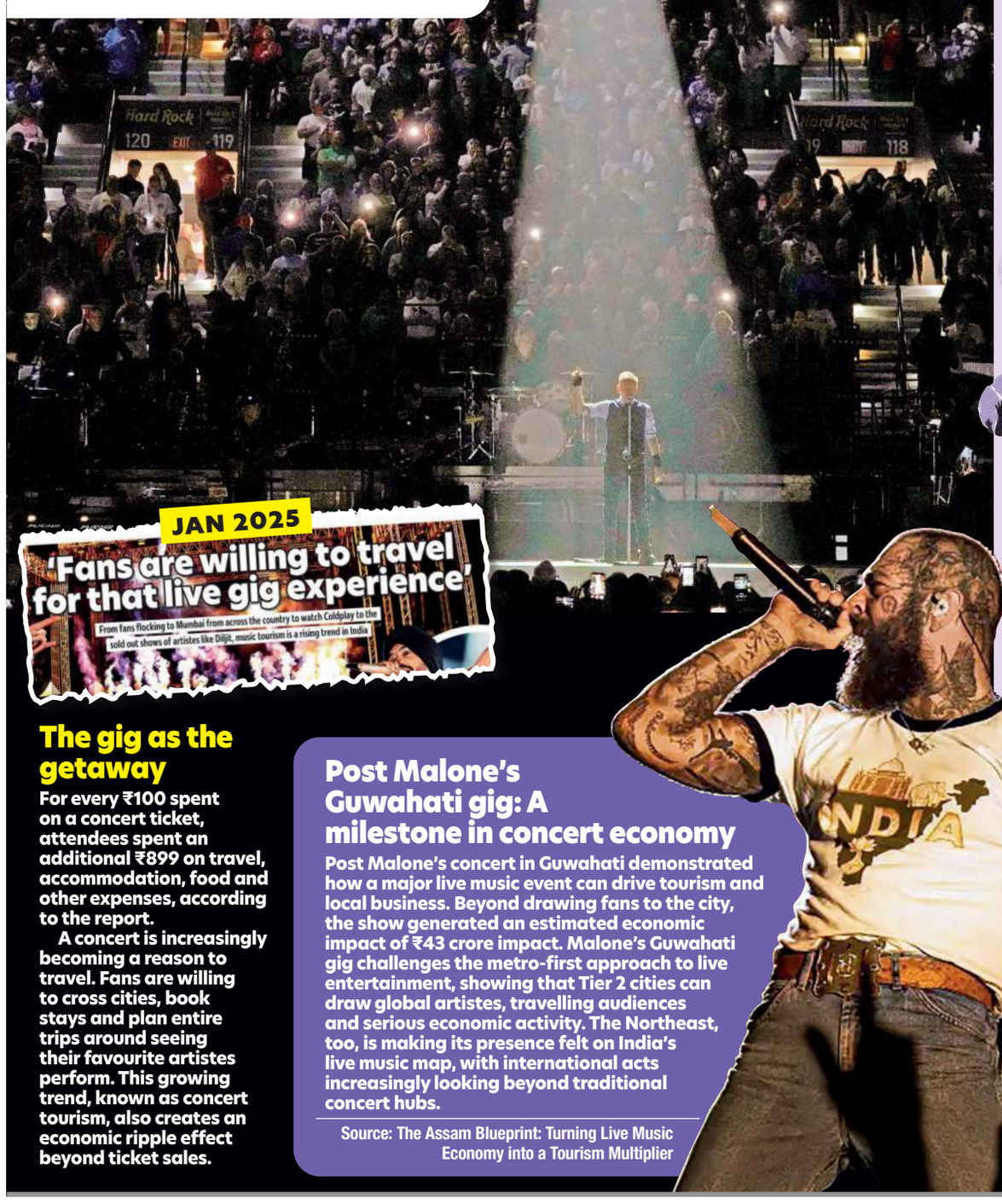
NO DOOMSDAY TODAY: **A 1960 scientific paper predicted that humanity would be 'squeezed to death' by an exploding population on November 13, 2026. Thankfully, the doomsday prophecy was more rhetorical than literal – so don't cancel your weekend plans just yet**



80% make live shows a regular part of their lives

Live music is becoming an emotional experience

India's live entertainment culture is evolving beyond big-ticket concerts, with audiences increasingly seeking connection, discovery and shared experiences. Based on responses from nearly 1,700 concert and festival-goers across 75 cities, a new report finds that eight in 10 respondents attend live shows regularly. While 51% go to concerts because they have followed an artiste for years, only 4% cite FOMO as their motivation. The findings suggest live entertainment is becoming a habit, offering audiences a sense of belonging and emotional connection beyond the screen. TNN



JAN 2025

'Fans are willing to travel for that live gig experience'

From fans flocking to Mumbai from across the country to watch Coldplay to the sold out shows of artistes like Diljit, music tourism is a rising trend in India

The gig as the getaway

For every ₹100 spent on a concert ticket, attendees spent an additional ₹899 on travel, accommodation, food and other expenses, according to the report.

A concert is increasingly becoming a reason to travel. Fans are willing to cross cities, book stays and plan entire trips around seeing their favourite artistes perform. This growing trend, known as concert tourism, also creates an economic ripple effect beyond ticket sales.

Post Malone's Guwahati gig: A milestone in concert economy

Post Malone's concert in Guwahati demonstrated how a major live music event can drive tourism and local business. Beyond drawing fans to the city, the show generated an estimated economic impact of ₹43 crore impact. Malone's Guwahati gig challenges the metro-first approach to live entertainment, showing that Tier 2 cities can draw global artistes, travelling audiences and serious economic activity. The Northeast, too, is making its presence felt on India's live music map, with international acts increasingly looking beyond traditional concert hubs.

Source: The Assam Blueprint: Turning Live Music Economy into a Tourism Multiplier

The big concert numbers

80% of respondents say live shows have become a regular part of their lives

51% attend concerts because they have followed an artiste for years, while only 4% cite FOMO as their motivation to attend a concert

44% attend live shows hoping to feel emotionally healed

66% say hearing an entire crowd sing together gives them the biggest chills

56% have experienced a genuine moment of connection with a stranger at a concert

Source: BookMyShow: OOO: Offline. Outdoors. Out Loud. - Live Season 25/26, Decoded

Anthony Mackie hints at Vision's return in Avengers: Doomsday

Anthony Mackie, best known for portraying Sam Wilson, first as Falcon and later as Captain America, hints at Paul Bettany's return as Vision in *Avengers: Doomsday*

Could Vision be making a comeback in *Avengers: Doomsday?* Anthony Mackie may have let slip a major Marvel secret while discussing the film's shoot. Speaking to *Entertainment Tonight*, the actor described the production as "summer camp", where cast members reunite and catch up. He then added, "I got to hang out with, you know, Paul Bettany, who I love." Bettany, who plays Vision, has not been officially announced as part of the cast, prompting speculation about the character's return. Marvel is yet to confirm his involvement. Agencies

Bettany had hinted at Avengers duties

Adding to the speculation, Bettany had hinted at his involvement in the franchise back in December 2025, saying, "I think I've got some Avengers duties next year." While this could have referred to *Avengers: Secret Wars*, the film's shooting schedule has yet to begin. It is possible that Bettany secretly filmed his scenes for *Doomsday*, with questions also emerging over whether Elizabeth Olsen will reprise her role as Scarlet Witch.

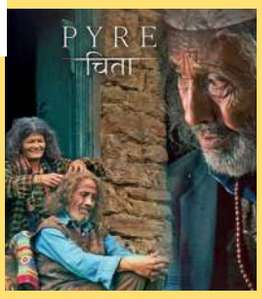
Image generated by AI; for representational purposes only

DELHIITES, STIR SOME CHRISTMAS MAGIC WITH CAKE-MIXING

P3

Buzzstop

FILM BODY SEEKS PROBE AFTER PYRE LOSES 75% SCREENS



The All Indian Cine Workers Association (AICWA) has sought the intervention of Union Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw after filmmaker Vinod Kapri's ***Pyre*** allegedly lost nearly 75% of its screens to accommodate a big-budget release. The film, made on a budget of ₹2.5 crore, reportedly expanded its presence from 80 to around 400 screens. However, Kapri alleges that its shows were cut by nearly 75%. "Everyone in this industry, whether actor, director or producer, began small. No one becomes big overnight. If small films are not given a chance, the big stars and big filmmakers of tomorrow will never be born," AICWA wrote on X in support. TNN

He took more than one Huang turn

Huang was out of line and now he maybe out of Nvidia

After Alice Huang, Jensen's latest unreported relationship has been revealed to be with Kimberly Powell, Nvidia's vice president of healthcare

The plot thickens for Nvidia boss Jensen Huang. Days after facing scrutiny over an extramarital affair with a businesswoman suspected by US intelligence of spying for China, the 63-year-old tech billionaire is facing fresh allegations of another relationship – this time with an executive at his own company.

According to *The New York Times*, Huang had an affair with Kimberly Powell, Nvidia's vice-president of healthcare, who reports to him. The report, citing five people who worked at Nvidia, has added another twist to the scandal.

The big fall out

The fallout could now cost Huang his job. Nvidia's board reportedly met to consider removing the man who co-founded the AI chip giant in 1993. The company's shares plunged more than 8% in after-hours trading on Wednesday, continuing a sell-off that has seen more than $500bn in its stock market value wiped out since Friday.

Elon enters the chat on Huang's future

On his social media platform X, Musk has posted a "100" emoji in response to AI investor Gavin Baker, who said Nvidia's board should wait for the results of an independent investigation before ousting Huang. He also wrote that it "would be an honour" to hire Huang.

'My once in a lifetime'

Anirudh Ravichander and Kaviya Maran tie the knot

After two years of speculation about their relationship, music composer Anirudh Ravichander and Kaviya Maran, CEO of the Hyderabad IPL team, are now married. The couple tied the knot in Greece on November 11 in an intimate ceremony attended by close family and friends. Posting pictures from their big day, the *Jawan* composer wrote, "My once in a lifetime, for a lifetime 11.11 (*sic*)." The couple will be hosting a wedding reception in Chennai on November 21, which is expected to have several notable personalities from across the country in attendance.

Rajinikanth

Former Tamil Nadu CM MK Stalin

A starry affair

Superstar Rajinikanth was in attendance to bless his nephew, and so was Anirudh's close friend and *Jailer 2* director Nelson Dilipkumar. Former Tamil Nadu Chief Minister MK Stalin, who is Kaviya's grandfather, was also present. The couple opted for colour-coordinated pastel outfits for their special day. Anirudh wore an *ivory kurta* and *veshti*, paired with a long jacket, while Kaviya looked elegant in a blush-pink *lehenga*.

Could this be the end of endless scrolling in the EU?

The European Union is stepping up efforts to protect consumers from potentially harmful online practices, proposing stricter regulations targeting influencer marketing, artificial intelligence and addictive digital features. Unveiled on Wednesday, the proposed Digital Fairness Act aims to close gaps in existing consumer protection laws and could save EU consumers up to €13.7 billion ($15.3 billion) annually, reports *AFP*. The measures include influencers to clearly label promotional content as advertisements and allowing users to disable features such as infinite scrolling. They also seek to restrict pay-to-win features in games aimed at minors. Platforms will have to provide clearer information about subscription renewals. The legislation will now undergo negotiations with EU member states and the European Parliament.

iStock

Companies could face fines of up to 6% of their annual turnover in large-scale cases

A case for political aesthetics

POV

The recent US midterm elections have proved that in modern politics, a crisp mandate goes down much smoother with a crisp lapel. America's newest political class is commanding as much column space for its grooming habits as its legislative agendas. Take Michigan Senator-elect Abdul El-Sayed, who casually charms lifestyle vloggers while breaking down a disciplined retinol, sunscreen, and moisturiser regimen. Or Iowa Governor-elect Rob Sand, who delighted the internet when vintage photos surfaced from his past life strutting down a Prada runway. Then there is Texas Senator-elect James Talarico, practically fused to his worn-in cowboy boots from Lucchese – a heritage label whose bespoke pairs require a painstaking, multi-month build. Meanwhile, trailblazing female winners – from Peggy Flanagan, the first Native American woman elected to the US Senate, to historic gubernatorial victors Deb Haaland and Gina Hinojosa – have deployed culturally resonant tailoring and regalia as visual shorthand for both roots and authority.

Half a world away, Indian politicians are fluent in the very same sartorial dialect, dressing to connect with younger, vertical-screen natives. Think of Rahul Gandhi's white T-shirt, cargos, and Swiss-engineered running shoes. Parliamentarians Kangana Ranaut and Mahua Moitra may sit on opposite ends of the ideological spectrum, yet both possess an undeniably sharp eye for style – Ranaut championing regional artistry in handloom saris, and Moitra cutting an unmistakable figure in razor-sharp coordinated ensembles. Even veteran statesman Sonia Gandhi has sparked waves of social media chatter around her personal style –both in the riveting black-and-white headshot on her book cover and the blush-pink handloom sari for a fashion magazine.

In the attention economy, aesthetics are no longer an afterthought to ideology – they are the opening argument. It is a lesson straight out of Aristotle's *Politics*, which noted long ago that leaders must deliberately curate their outward appearance in the public square to project legitimacy and command trust. A politician's wardrobe is evidently strategic theatre – a playbook perfected long before Instagram by the original master of sartorial symbolism, who turned the humble *dhoti* into the most potent political statement of the 20th century.

In Gen Z parlance, it was the ultimate soft launch of a revolution.

@TheCosmeticLane

@lewing99

Rob Sand walking for Prada in 2002

Agree? Disagree? Got a POV idea? **Write to us at:** pov@timesofindia.com

LEISURE

SUDOKU CHALLENGE

Level: Medium

4	6							
3					2	9		
1		2			6			
	2	5					3	
		1		2		6		
	4					7	1	
			9			8		7
		8	3					6
							5	9

HOW TO PLAY

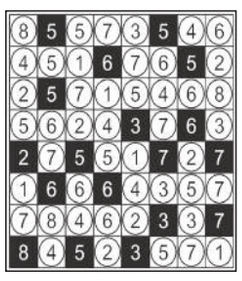
Fill in the grid so that every horizontal row, every vertical column and every 3x3 box contains the digits 1-9, without repeating the numbers in the same row, column or box.You can't change the digits already given in the grid. Every puzzle has one solution.

TIMES HITORI

HOW TO PLAY

1. A number may appear just once in each row or column. Eliminate repeat numbers by darkening cells. (see example)
2. Darkened cells must never be adjacent in a row or column.
3. Unmarked cells must create a single continuous area, undivided by darkened cells.
4. Every time you darken a cell, you can automatically circle its vertical and horizontal neighbours, which means they cannot be eliminated.
5. Any cell "sandwiched" between neighbours of the same value can be circled. (e.g. 6 [4] 6)
6. A "triple" is a special case of sandwich. Circle the centre cells, and darken the ends. (e.g. [6] [6] [6])

2	2	3	6	5	2	9	3
8	2	5	6	1	9	4	3
2	4	1	4	2	9	7	4
3	1	6	2	4	8	5	7
5	5	2	6	8	5	6	3
1	8	3	3	1	7	9	5
2	6	9	5	7	1	3	4
7	9	7	1	5	3	7	6

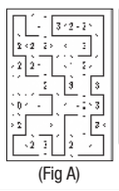


Example

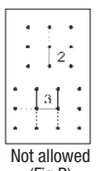
LOOP THE LOOP

RULES

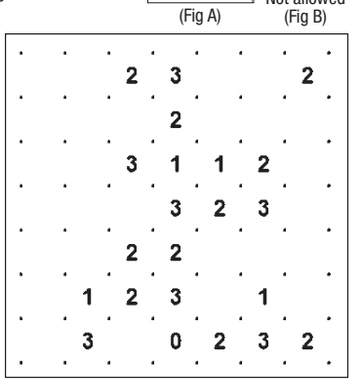
- Connect adjacent dots with vertical or horizontal lines, creating a single loop (Fig A).
- Crossovers or branches are not allowed (As shown by dotted lines in Fig B).
- Numbers in the puzzle indicate the number of lines that should surround it, while empty cells may be surrounded by any number of lines.
- You can't draw lines around zeroes.
- Each puzzle has just one unique solution.



(Fig A)



Not allowed (Fig B)

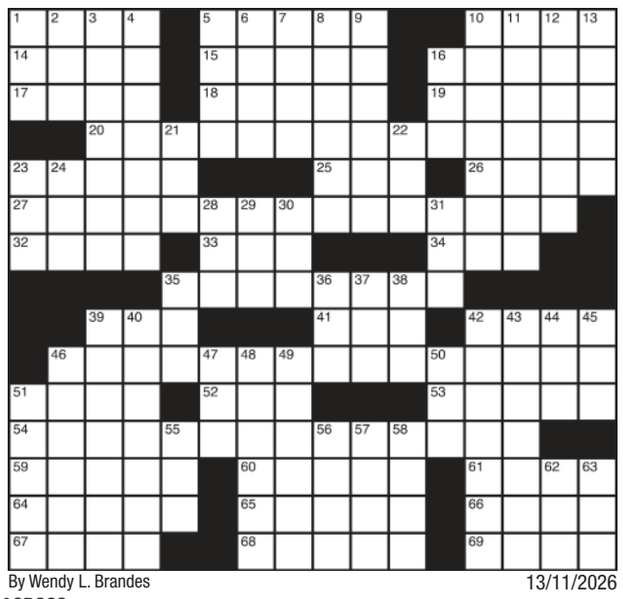


HOW TO BEGIN:

Example (Fig A) - Begin with the zero next to 3. Since no lines can be drawn around zero, mark crosses around it, as shown. Now there is a cross in one space around 3. So we know the three lines of 3 can only be drawn in the remaining three spaces. Next, these lines can only be extended in one direction each. Continue, using the same logic.

Hints: Keep eliminating possibilities by marking crosses in spaces between dots where a line isn't possible, i.e., if you have already completed required lines or where a line extension may create a branch or cause a deadend **(Fig B)**.

THE DAILY CROSSWORD



By Wendy L. Brandes — 13/11/2026

ACROSS

1 Breaks down
5 Virginie-Occidentale et Californie
10 Chilean sea __
14 "Love ya!"
15 Diana Taurasi's jersey number
16 Joined with
17 Bach title
18 Settles
19 Leader of a chipmunk band
20 Concern that one's sneakers are hopelessly out of style?
23 Bakery allure
25 First responder gp.
26 Indication that docs are included
27 Knocked over a bottle of booze?
32 Forest carpet
33 Chitchat
34 Web design lang.
35 Not well-balanced, or an apt title for this puzzle?
39 Phillipa of "Hamilton"
41 Tax return fig.
42 Hit close to home?
46 "Project Runway" timer?
51 See 45-Down
52 Tyke
53 Pirouetting, say
54 Going on and on about one's new cookware?
59 Pont des Arts city
60 Olympic gymnast Strug
61 St. Louis landmark
64 "My Brilliant Friend" novelist Ferrante
65 Etsy business
66 Macaroni art need
67 Curl counts
68 AI __: pasta specification
69 Looks at

Thursday's Puzzle Solved

G	A	G		K	A	R	M	A			N	A	P	S
I	P	A		E	M	B	O	S	S		O	S	H	A
F	I	R	S	T	P	I	T	C	H		T	O	O	L
T	A	B	O	O			H	O	E		A	N	N	E
S	N	O	B		M	A	S	T	E	R	K	E	Y	S
			E	G	O	S			R	U	E	D		
A	M	I		R	E	T	A	G		G	R	O	O	M
C	O	M	P	O	S	E	Y	O	U	R	S	E	L	F
C	O	O	R	S		R	O	N	D	A		S	E	A
		N	A	S	A			O	O	T	D			
S	C	A	L	E	S	D	O	W	N		O	N	T	O
N	O	R	I		K	O	A			A	D	I	E	U
A	N	O	N		M	U	S	I	C	N	O	T	E	S
I	D	L	E		E	L	I	C	I	T		R	U	T
L	O	L	S			A	S	I	D	E		O	P	S

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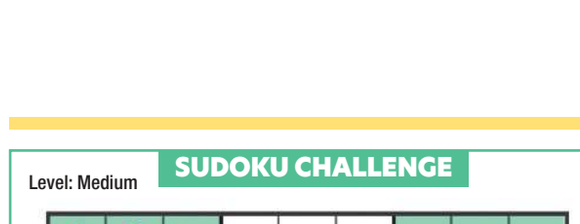
DOWN

1 "I can't believe u"
2 Be behind, in a way
3 Does a pub crawl
4 Crayfish kin
5 Engrave
6 "Don't be like __!"
7 Folk singer Guthrie
8 Protein in some vegan ribs
9 Tahini ingredient
10 Convictions
11 Onsets
12 Knit or purl
13 Some smart TVs
16 Buildup on a menorah, perhaps
21 Miss
22 Research-funding org.
23 Cash provider
24 Hopping pal of Pooh
28 Motivation for a vanity project
29 Big name in sealant
30 "Frankly," in texts
31 In need of salt, say
35 Publisher with a mountain peak logo
36 Put away the groceries?
37 Many moons __
38 A-lister
39 Time commitment for some jrs.
40 Gets
42 Detail in a van Gogh self-portrait
43 Downright
44 Cpl. or sgt.
45 With 51-Across, Wyle drama
46 Closing number
47 Pugsley kin
48 Out of options
49 Rays home, for short
50 Court
51 Three-time Oscar nominee Laurie
55 Intel org.
56 Persia, today
57 Lit __
58 Unit equal to 20 north-south blocks in New York City
62 Pool necessity
63 Guys



SCRAMBLE

Rearrange the letters in the four word jumbles, one letter to each square/ circle, to make four ordinary words

LMEEE

MYERR

ESYLLM

____ ____ is any time you
- Franklin P Jones (8,4)

SOLUTIONS TO GAMES/PUZZLES

TIMES SUDOKU

4	6	9	3	8	1	2	5	7
3	7	4	5	6	2	9	1	8
1	5	2	9	7	6	3	4	8
9	2	5	8	4	7	6	3	1
7	3	6	2	1	9	5	8	4
8	4	1	6	5	3	7	9	2
5	9	3	1	2	8	4	7	6
2	8	7	4	9	5	1	6	3
6	1	8	7	3	4	9	2	5

LOOP THE LOOP

TIMES HITORI

6	5	3	1	4	2	9	7	8
4	9	6	5	7	3	1	8	2
5	1	8	7	2	6	4	3	9
2	3	5	6	9	4	8	1	7
8	2	9	4	1	7	3	5	6
1	6	7	3	8	5	2	9	4
3	8	4	9	5	1	7	6	2
7	4	1	2	6	8	5	3	9
9	7	2	8	3	9	6	4	1

SPELLATHON

tribe

SCRAMBLE

Words: Melee, merry, smelly, bowman
Answer: One thing you will probably remember well is any time you forgive and forget - Franklin P Jones

abet, ARBITER, bait, barter, bate, beat, bete, bite, biter, brat, rarte, RAREBIT, rate, rite, tear, tier, tire,

wrong or at least illuminating the fact that it is wrong and explaining why. Share your opinion, and you'll quickly learn that you're not the only one who holds it.

SCORPIO: You're easy-going and adaptable, so it may come as a surprise to you that some people get edgy when they are required
g they didn't have in mind.
This isn't a good day for borrow-
How can you pull this one off us-
ces that are already yours? You'll
eative, but it can be done.
You can't see the big picture of
ut you'll look at the big picture of
s life and get a feeling. There are
y getting under your skin. You
y are – the ones with their fingers
emotional buttons. Your best reac-
eact.
ur vision is expanding. Go with
sion because you're ready for it.
'll attract other talented people
you exceed the previous

v your curiosities; they lead to
urces of love in your life. The old
od, too, and that's what's great
can never have too much.

DT AI imagery

Sharing her hack to the most succulent Christmas cake, baker Kanika Chopra, founder of Kanique, shares, "While dried fruits benefit from prolonged soaking, nuts can lose their crunch and develop stale or rancid flavours. My recommendation is to soak the dried fruits separately and add fresh nuts closer to baking"

Raisin' the festive spirit with a cake-mixing party

@plate_of_flavors

'Let every family member choose an ingredient to add to the mix'

For many families, the ritual is less about the cake and more about what happens before it reaches the oven. Ghaziabad resident Ishan Bennett Blest, who works at a music studio and has grown up seeing cake mixing as a joyous tradition, shares, "My family prepares dried fruits, peels, currants and raisins at home before taking the mix to a bakery closer to Christmas. Every time anybody visits our home, we feed them the cake and also give them a cake to take home. The basic idea of the tradition is to share love." He adds, "A family friend loved the cakes so much that he wanted to make them too, so we got more fruit, soaked it together, went to the bakery together, and divided the soaked fruit. Usually, you meet a lot of people at the bakery, so that feels like a community event too."

Naturally suited to a gathering, the ritual is seen by chef Tejasvi Chandela, founder of cloud patisserie Dzurt, as a way to unite generations around one table each year. "Christmas cake mixing is one of those traditions where the preparation is just as meaningful as the finished cake. The aromas of dried fruits, citrus, and warm spices, the anticipation of Christmas, and the simple act of coming together around a table make it an experience worth sharing."

She explains that participation does not require baking expertise. "One lovely way to turn this into an annual ritual is to let every family member choose an ingredient to add to the mix. It could be a favourite dried fruit, a particular spice or a little citrus zest. Over time, the recipe becomes something unique to that family, evolving with their tastes and traditions."

Shivika Manchanda

Before the Christmas ovens even warm up, the magic starts in the mixing bowl. Imagine the aroma of spices and citrus zest mingling with cherries, nuts, and dried fruits as they begin their long, festive soak. It's a tradition built for many hands – making this weekend's community cake-mixing gathering the sweetest way to kick off the holiday season.

> **The joy of Christmas need not begin when the cake is served. It can begin right from the very first mix**
>
> – Reetu Uday Kugaji, culinary consultant

'Mixing can be a neighbourhood tradition'

Cake mixing can extend beyond the family table. Chef and culinary consultant Reetu Uday Kugaji suggests taking the ritual into neighbourhoods and communities, where everyone brings something to the mix. "Cake mixing shouldn't be confined to hotels. It can become a neighbourhood tradition, where people bring ingredients from their homes and together create the true flavour of Christmas."

Cake mixing is also finding its way into workshops. Sawee in Greater Noida, founded by Suhita Chakrabarty with Harshita Harjai, is planning a cake-mixing session. "We want the cake-mixing workshop to be a hands-on experience rather than just a demonstration. Participants will prepare their own soaking mix with ingredients such as candied orange peels, almonds, raisins, figs, dried cranberries, and black currants. The idea is to get everyone involved in the process and let them take home their own prepared mix in a jar. We are also looking at adding gingerbread cookie decoration to the session," says Suhita.

Lokesh Kashyap

For those looking to soak in the Christmas spirit ahead of the season, cake-mixing sessions are also being hosted at hotels

'Spices are your playing field'

The mix offers plenty of room for personalisation. Baker Palack Khanna, founder of The H&J Co in Gurgaon, suggests, "Dry fruits, especially raisins, should be soaked well so they become nice and juicy, as they take up a lot of the liquid. If you can get your hands on sultana raisins, that would be ideal. Spices are your playing field, but cinnamon and cloves are good to have. Hearty spices work best. Ginger is another favourite of ours to use."

This flexibility can make a mixing session more personal. Baker Sheena Singhania, founder of Project Cake says, "The dry fruits are carefully chopped, soaked, and lovingly mixed by hand, allowing all those beautiful flavours to come together. The soaking process requires lots of hands and what's better than doing it with friends and family? Loud music, some drinks and working together to create something beautiful is a nice way to round up the year."

iStock

'Cake mixing is as much about the experience as it is about the cake itself'

For many Delhiites, the holiday season doesn't begin until they've rolled up their sleeves and dived into a boozy, spice-laden batch of dried fruits and nuts." Cake mixing is as much about the experience as it is about the cake itself. It is a wonderfully sensory activity, from the aroma of spices and dried fruits to the textures, colours and the simple joy of getting your hands into the mix," says Drishtee Sikka, co-founder of Ello' Bakehouse in Okhla, who sees the appeal in its sensory and participatory nature. The communal aspect, she says, is what makes it special. "Everyone contributes something, everyone gets involved, and somewhere between the mixing, tasting and conversations, strangers become part of a shared experience."

With home cake-mixing gatherings planned a month before Christmas, bakers note that ingredient choices and timing will shape the final cake. Baker Kanika Chopra, founder of Kanique, Model Town, says, "Adding too much spirit doesn't necessarily mean a better-soaked fruit mix. Excessive liquid can make the fruits mushy and affect the cake batter, so add just enough to coat and moisten the fruits. Ideally, the ratio should be 3:7, with nuts making up 30% and dried fruits 70%."

Pics: Ranjit Kumar

An evening of words and ideas

In the city for a literary gathering, Dr Shriram Nene discusses health and mindful living

SNAPSHOTS

Amitabh Kant and Ranjeeta Kant

Dependra Pathak and Dr Ravi Malik

Papa CJ

Dr Shriram Nene was in the city recently for a literary gathering, where he joined guests for conversations around health and fitness. Stressing the importance of making good health a priority, Dr Nene said, "Good health should not be a privilege, a luxury or something we think about only when we become ill. It should be a fundamental priority for every individual and every family"

Delhi Times Weekend Planner

Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat Sun

Want your event to be featured? Email us at tims.delhitimes@timesofindia.com

If you're into books

@safhadelhi

21ST CENTURY INDIAN CONTEMPORARY WRITERS
(A meetup by Safha Literary Club)
Where: Kathika Cultural Centre, Old Delhi
When: Sun
Time: 3pm - 5pm

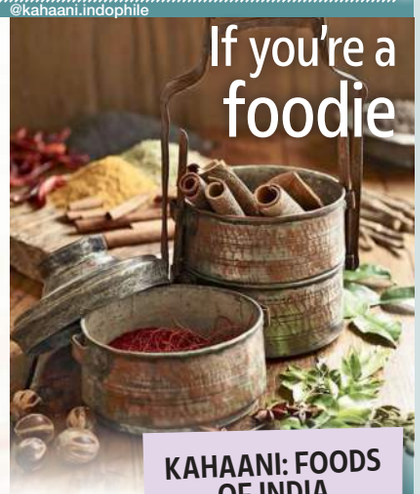
BRUNCH WITH BIBLIOPHILES
Where: Irani Mehfil Cafe, Mandi House
When: Sat
Time: Noon - 2pm

SILENT BOOK CLUB
(A meetup with Rachna Kalra)
Where: Serenity Amphitheatre, Sunder Nursery
When: Sun
Time: 11am - 1pm

@windwordbyrachna

@kahaani.indophile

If you're a foodie



CAKE MIXING CEREMONY
Where: Spectra, The Leela Ambience Gurgaon
When: Sun
Time: 10am

GRAND CAKE MIXING CEREMONY
Where: The LaLit, Barakhamba Road
When: Sat
Time: 3pm

KAHAANI: FOODS OF INDIA
(A regional food festival by Indophile)
Where: Travancore Palace
When: Fri - Sun
Time: Noon onwards

THE MERRY MIX
Where: Le Meridien Gurgaon
When: Sat
Time: 4.30pm - 6.30pm

URDU KI KAHAANI
(A supper table by Luchee Food Story)
Where: CR Park
When: Sat
Time: Noon onwards

If you're into art & handloom

@ngma_delhi

TAKSHANAM
Where: National Gallery of Modern Art, Jaipur House
When: Fri - Sat
Time: 11am - 6pm

INDIA WEAVES: HANDLOOM EXPO
Where: Aga Khan Hall
When: Fri - Sun
Time: 10am - 8pm

THE GRAND HANDLOOM FAIR
Where: Dastkar, Andheria Mod
When: Sat - Nov 23
Time: 11am - 8pm

CYANOTYPE WORKSHOP
Where: Delhi Art Centre, Lado Sarai
When: Sun
Time: Noon - 2pm

@radhabhatt

@delhi_art_centre

If you're into experiences

MASSAKALI & THE EMPRESS
(A walk by Darwesh Taleweavers to witness Kabootarbazi)
Where: Turkman Gate
When: Sun
Time: 10am onw

MYTHS, ARCHAEOLOGICAL SEARCH & A HISTORY OF EMPIRES
(A walk by DelhiByFoot)
Meeting Point: Purana Qila Ticket Counter
When: Sun
Time: 9am

ANANT UTSAV
(A folk, tribal arts festival by SPIC MACAY)
Where: Sunder Nursery
When: Fri - Sun
Time: 11am onwards

INTERNATIONAL TRADE FAIR
Where: Bharat Mandapam
When: Sat - Nov 27
Time: 11am onw

@spicmacayofficial

The Forest & the Self
(A performance by Vipul Rikhi)
Where: KNMA, Saket
When: Sat
Time: 7pm

Kamakshi Khanna Live
Where: The Piano Man, Eldeco Centre
When: Sun
Time: 8.30pm

Tribute to Indian Rock Legends
Where: Depot 48, GK2
When: Sat
Time: 8pm

Notes From My World
(Bharatanatyam performance by Rajeshwari Aravind)
Where: India Habitat Centre
When: Fri
Time: 7pm

Sarang The Peacock
(A docu screening and panel by wildlife conservationists)
Where: Museo Camera, Gurgaon
When: Sun
Time: 5pm - 7pm

Let's Draw: Digital Art Exhibition
Where: Alliance Française de Delhi
When: Sat - Nov 27
Time: 11am - 7pm

Espresso Brewing
(Experience by Trove)
Where: Lizzu, Lodhi Colony
When: Sun
Time: 4pm - 6pm

Resin Art
Where: Chalk Board, HKV
When: Fri - Sun
Time: Noon onwards

Gaurav Gupta Live
Where: Laugh Casa, Noida
When: Sun
Time: 6.30pm, 9pm slots

The Bazaar
Where: Sunder Nursery
When: Sun
Time: 8am - 1pm

Artisanal Market
(A market by Handpicked by Puneeta Chaddha Khanna)
Where: Horizon Plaza, Gurgaon
When: Sat
Time: 11am - 5pm

K-Food Universe 2026
Where: Pacific Mall, Tagore Garden
When: Fri - Nov 20
Time: 11am onwards

CIMA Art Mela 2026
(An art fair for the first-time buyers)
Where: Visual Arts Gallery, India Habitat Centre
When: Fri - Tue
Time: 10am - 8pm

Urdu Drama Festival
(By Urdu Academy)
Where: Shri Ram Centre of Performing Arts, Mandi House
When: Fri - Nov 18
Time: Daywise

Memory Lanes
(A walk by Jibin George followed by breakfast)
Where: Chor Bizarre
When: Sun
Time: 8am

India-Russia Art Exhibit
Where: Russian House
When: Fri - Nov 20
Time: Daywise

Disclaimer: Make it a point to check with the organisers for any changes regarding the events.

Acting is behaving truthfully under imaginary circumstances - Sanford Meisner

'Many young actors are disconnected from what Indian audiences want'

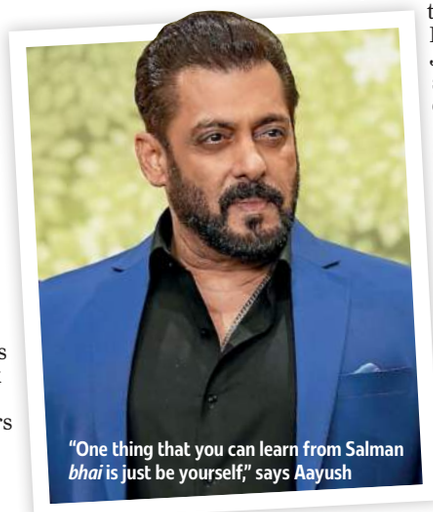
AAYUSH SHARMA

Onkar Kulkarni

Aayush Sharma believes that building a lasting connection with audiences is not necessarily difficult for today's actors, but understanding the audience is where many of them are falling short. The *Loveyatri* (2018) actor, who is married to Salman Khan's sister Arpita Khan, also had a ringside view of the superstar's enduring popularity.

Citing Salman Khan, Shah Rukh Khan and Sanjay Dutt as examples of stars who have built an enduring bond with people, Aayush says a sense of individuality and a deeper understanding of India are key to achieving that connect. "I think it's not difficult; I think it's just disconnect. A lot of young actors are disconnected from what India is and what Indian audiences want out of them. More than the audiences trying to accept you, I think you need to know your audience really well. All the senior actors have a great connect with their audience," he says.

Pointing out how established stars have developed distinct identities that audiences instantly recognise, he adds, "Even when it comes to fashion, they are individuals. Sanjay Dutt sir's style, Salman *bhai*'s style and Shah Rukh sir's looks have been iconic. They first became distinct individuals, and that connected with the audiences. They know India really well."



"One thing that you can learn from Salman *bhai* is just be yourself," says Aayush

'WE ARE SLOWLY LOSING THE CONNECT WITH INDIA'

He further adds, "With the advent of social media, while we are exposed to things happening in America, Paris and London, we are slowly losing the connect with India. From a city like Mumbai, Delhi or Hyderabad, when you go to a place like Banaras or Jaipur, you suddenly encounter different people, different mindsets and different ways of approaching things. In today's day and age, with the advent of social media, most actors are treading very close to being influencers rather than actors. They are not really people's people and they are not people's stars. I think it's just difficult for actors to comprehend what India is."

'YOU CANNOT EMULATE SALMAN KHAN'

Having watched Salman Khan closely, Aayush says the superstar's confidence and individuality are qualities one can admire, but not necessarily imitate. He says, "He can inspire people, but you cannot emulate him because he's so individual in what he does, and he does it so right. If you try doing that, it just falls flat. One thing that you can learn from him is just be yourself."

> In today's day and age, with the advent of social media, most actors are treading very close to being influencers rather than actors. They are not really people's people, and they are not people's stars

Brand's Insta account taken down after rape conviction

We disabled your account
You no longer have access to russellbrand
Account disabled on November 11, 2026
Why this happened
Your account, or activity on it, doesn't follow our Community Standards.

Meta has removed **Russell Brand**'s Instagram account days after the comedian was convicted of rape and sexual assault and sentenced to 10 years and six months in prison by London's Southwark Crown Court. Screenshots posted on Brand's X account showed a notice saying Instagram had disabled the page for violating its Community Standards. A Meta spokesperson confirmed to *TMZ* that the account had been removed for breaching its policies. Brand's X account remains active. In a post accompanying the screenshots, he criticised Meta and thanked Elon Musk. TNN

Background

A jury found Brand guilty on November 5 after a four-week trial involving offences against four women between 2004 and 2009. He was sentenced on November 9 and will remain on the sex offenders' register for life. Brand has denied the allegations. Police say he is also being investigated over further rape allegations made by two other women.

Meta's Account Integrity policy allows the company to restrict or disable accounts that engage in off-platform activity that can lead to harm on its platforms. This covers accounts belonging to people convicted of sex offences against children or adults >>

@ananddeverakonda

Trippin!

RASHMIKA MANDANNA & VIJAY DEVERAKONDA marked their festive season with a **JAPANESE** getaway alongside Vijay's family

UP TO DATE

WHAT'S #TRENDING AND WHY

Ronaldo kicks off a new role off the pitch

Image generated by AI

Cristiano Ronaldo has taken a new step in his career with a move into television drama. The Al-Nassr forward, who recently announced his retirement from international football, shared the news on Instagram alongside British producer and director Matthew Vaughn, "Great news, production has just begun on my first TV series, *Day 1s*. More to come."

The football drama is set in the world of British football and follows the high-stakes business of player management. According to *Deadline*, actor Damian Lewis plays fictional football agent Stanley Dalton. Ronaldo is attached as an executive producer and is also expected to appear in the series. Former footballer Thierry Henry and rapper Dave are among the other names associated with the project. No release date has been announced yet.

Grande entrance, plus one

Ariana Grande and her boyfriend, former backup dancer Ricky Alvarez, made their red carpet debut together at the *Focker-in-Law* premiere in New York City on Wednesday. The pair posed arm in arm and shared smiles, with Grande in a striped dress with floral details and Alvarez in a black blazer and jeans. They first dated from 2015 to 2016 and rekindled their relationship this year, making it Instagram official in August.

Elordi's next role is a killer

Jacob Elordi is set to star as convicted killer Gary Gilmore in a new adaptation of *The Executioner's Song*, based on Norman Mailer's Pulitzer Prize-winning book, reported *Deadline*. Elordi will also produce the film, which follows Gilmore's case after he was convicted of killing two men in Utah. He insisted that his death sentence be carried out, becoming the first person executed in the US after a ten-year pause in executions. Lawrence Schiller, who directed the 1982 adaptation, will executive produce the new film. A director and release date have not yet been announced.